PIONEER FAMILY HISTORY SERIES

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The Covenant Path From Many Lands

The Conversion of the Pioneer Ancestors of

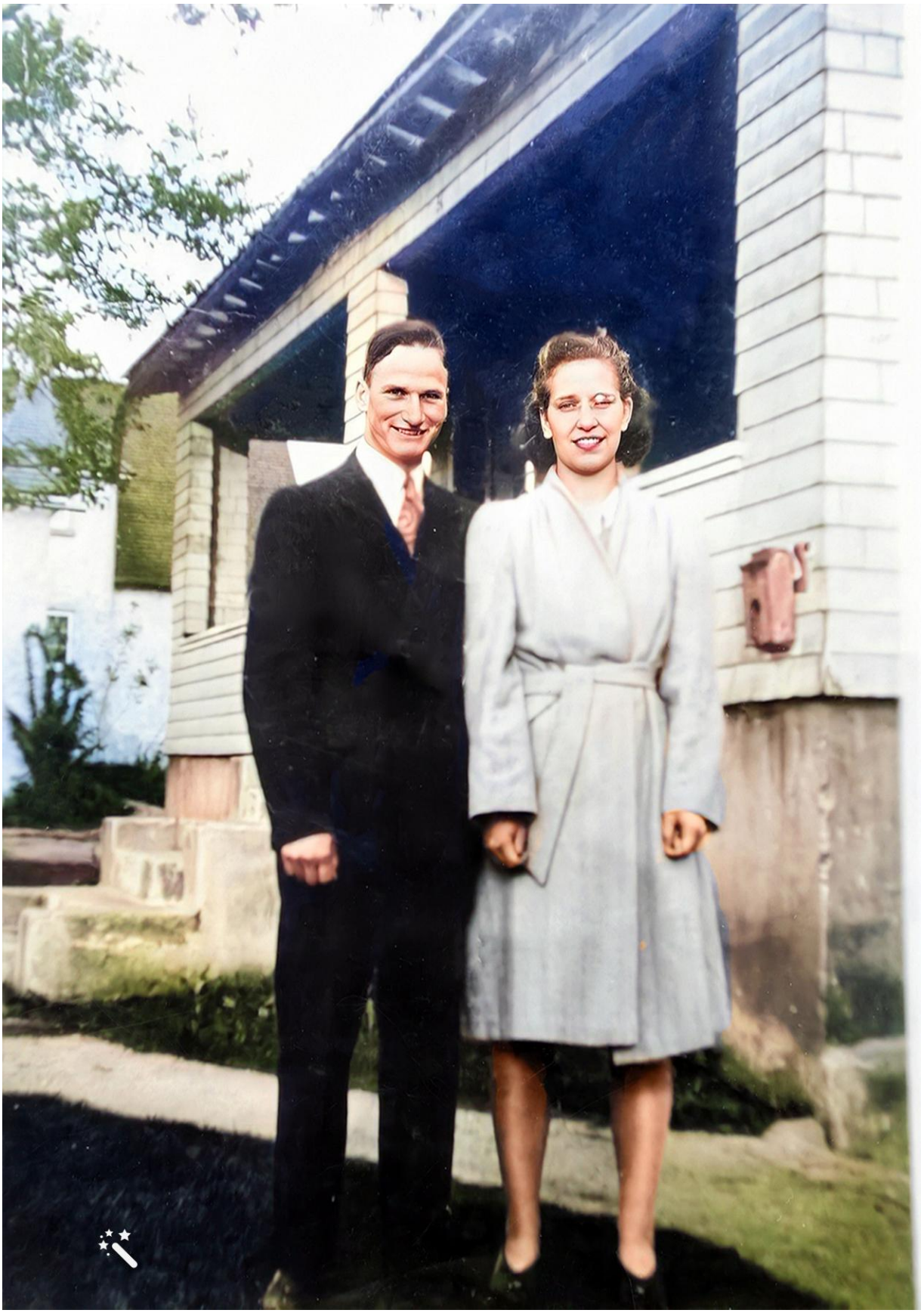
Don and Myrle Bingham

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Twelve Families • Six Countries • Five Decades of Conversion

1833 – 1889

Prepared for the Bingham Family Reunion • 2026
By Keith Hendricks



How to Use This Book

What This Book Is

This volume gathers the conversion stories and how the Covenant Path began for the twelve pioneer ancestors of Don Robert Bingham (1921–1995) and Myrle Nelson Bingham (1923–1997). Each story traces a family's conversion to The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints, their sacrifice in leaving behind everything familiar, and their journey to the valleys of Utah. Together, these twelve families form the foundation of the Bingham family's covenant heritage. These stories were collected from research available on FamilySearch, additional independent research and the use of new artificial intelligence tools. If there are inaccuracies, they are unintentional. Some of the statements are what appear to be reasonable inferences based on available records. The key sources used for each story are noted at the end.

How the Stories Are Ordered

The stories are arranged chronologically by the date of the first baptism in each family — the moment the covenant path began. Erastus Bingham and Lucinda Gates open the volume, baptized in Vermont in November 1833. Anna Barbara Briener closes it, baptized in Switzerland in October 1873. The forty years between those two baptisms span a continent and three oceans.

How the Families Connect

Each story is self-contained, but the families are deeply interconnected. The Bingham and Aldous families both settled at Bingham's Fort in Ogden. The Wilson and Wiggins families joined their lines through marriage in 1862. George and Eliza Stratford appear alongside their son Edwin and his wife Marianna Crabb as companion stories. A family overview and timeline follow this page.

Using This Book

This book is designed for duplex (two-sided) printing. Each story begins on a right-hand page. A colored cover page precedes each story; its blank verso is left intentionally open for artwork, photographs, or family drawings. Source citations appear at the end of each story. Page numbers in the Table of Contents should be confirmed after printing, as pagination depends on your printer settings.

Tribute

More than anything, this book is a tribute to the lives and family of Don and Myrle Bingham. It is my honor to be associated with this family. - *Keith L. Hendricks*

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Ancestral Lines of Don and Myrle Bingham

Don Robert Bingham (1921–1995) and Myrle Nelson Bingham (1923–1997) were the amazing parents of seven children. The twelve families in this volume represent ancestral lines who joined the Church of Jesus Christ of LaterDay Saints from both the Bingham and Nelson sides of the family, spanning England, Denmark, Switzerland, and the early American frontier.

Children of Don and Myrle Bingham

- **Calvin R Bingham** (1946–Living)
- **James W Bingham** (1948–2016)
- **Catherine Bingham** (1950–Living)
- **Maurine Bingham** (1952–Living)
- **Jerald Don Bingham** (1954–1969)
- **Carol Bingham** (1962–Living)
- **Allen N Bingham** (1966–Living)

The Twelve Ancestral Families in This Volume

Numbers in brackets correspond to the story order in this volume.

[1] Erastus Bingham & Lucinda Gates	*Vermont • 1833*
[2] Lewis Dunbar Wilson & Nancy Ann Waggoner	*Ohio • 1836*
[3] Ebenezer Fairchild Wiggins & Eleanor Moore	*Illinois • 1841*
[4] Edward Farley Jr. & Mary Ann Moore	*Illinois • 1847*
[4] Edward Farley Jr. & Mary Ann Moore	*Illinois • 1847*
[5] John & Jane Hastings	*England • 1849*
[6] Robert & Mary Ann Aldous	*England • 1849*
[7] George Stratford & Eliza Barwell	*England • 1851*
[8] Marianna Crabb & Edwin Stratford	*England • 1851*
[9] Jens Nielsen & Ane Margrethe Pedersdatter	*Denmark • 1855*
[10] Hans Andersen & Maren Jensen	*Denmark • 1861*
[11] Anna Barbara Briener & Anna Barbara Keller	*Switzerland • 1873*
[12] Julius Friedrich Hinrich Stender	*Germany • 1889*

Timeline of Conversions and Crossings

Forty years, six countries, three oceans — the journey of twelve families to the covenant.

1833	Erastus Bingham & Lucinda Gates baptized — St. Johnsbury, Vermont	[1]
1836	Lewis Dunbar Wilson & Nancy Ann Waggoner baptized — Richland County, Ohio	[2]
1841	Ebenezer & Eleanor Wiggins baptized — Nauvoo, Illinois	
1847	Edward Farley Jr. & Mary Ann Moore baptized — Pilot Grove, Illinois	[3]
1849 Apr	Jane Hastings baptized — Countesthorpe, Leicestershire	[4]
1849 Dec	Robert Aldous baptized — Fenstanton, Huntingdonshire	[5]
1851 Apr	Eliza Barwell Stratford baptized — Maldon, Essex	[6]
1851 May	Marianna Crabb & Edwin Stratford baptized — Maldon, Essex	[7]
1852 Sep	Wiggins family arrives Salt Lake Valley — Henry W. Miller Company	
1853 Sep	Wilson family arrives — Daniel A. Miller / John W. Cooley Company	[2]
1853 Sep	Aldous family arrives Salt Lake Valley — Claudius V. Spencer Company	[5]
1854	Bingham's Fort, Ogden — Aldous family settles; Bingham family anchors it	[1][5]
1855 Apr	Jens Nielsen & Ane Margrethe Pedersdatter baptized — Melby, Denmark	[8]
1856 Feb	Edwin Stratford & Marianna Crabb emigrate — ship Caravan	[7]
1860	Nielsen family departs Denmark — ship William Tapscott	[8]
1860 Nov	Nielsen family arrives Salt Lake Valley — William Budge Company	[8]
1861 Mar	Hans Andersen & Maren Jensen baptized — Hasmark, Fyn, Denmark	[9]
1861 Apr	George & Eliza Barwell Stratford cross Atlantic — ship Underwriter	[6]
1861 Jun	George Stratford dies at Florence, Nebraska — threshold of the plains	[6]
1861 Sep	Eliza Barwell Stratford & daughters arrive Salt Lake Valley	[6]
1861 Sep	Edwin Stratford & Marianna Crabb arrive Salt Lake Valley	[7]
1863 Apr	Hans Andersen & Maren Jensen depart Denmark — ship John J. Boyd	[9]
1863 Sep	Andersen family arrives Salt Lake Valley — John R. Young Company	[9]
1873 Oct	Anna Barbara Briener baptized — Zürich Canton, Switzerland	[10]
1884 May	Anna Barbara Briener emigrates — ship Arizona, Liverpool to New York	[10]
1889	Julius Friedrich Hinrich Stender converts to the LDS Church — Logan, Utah	[11]
1890 Feb	Julius Stender marries Anna Barbara Keller (Annebäbbi) — Logan Utah Temple	[11]

Story 1 of 12

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From Vermont Testimony to Bingham's Fort

Erastus Bingham and Lucinda Gates

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Vermont and New Hampshire • Vermont to the Great Salt Lake Valley • 1833–1882

Baptized: 11 November 1833

St. Johnsbury, Vermont



Erastus Bingham and Lucinda Gates

Vermont and New Hampshire • Vermont to the Great Salt Lake Valley • 1833–1882

Vermont Roots and a New Faith

In the early decades of the nineteenth century, Erastus Bingham and Lucinda Gates had built a comfortable, hardworking life together in New England. Erastus was born on **12 March 1798** in Concord, Essex County, Vermont, the son of Elisha Warner Bingham and Sarah Perry. He grew up working the thin Vermont soil, laboring on the family farm from an early age. Lucinda was born on **19 September 1797** in Acworth, Cheshire County, New Hampshire, a daughter of the Gates family whose New England roots stretched back generations to Stephen Gates of Hingham, Massachusetts. The two married on **20 March 1820** in St. Johnsbury, Vermont, and set immediately to work establishing a prosperous farm in Concord, Essex County, where they raised their large, close-knit family.

Their lives shifted entirely in the spring of 1833, when Elder John F. Boynton traveled through Vermont carrying word of a restored gospel and a living prophet. Erastus had no formal religious affiliation at the time. Boynton's message arrested him. He read the Book of Mormon, prayed over it, and received what he described as a powerful testimony of its truthfulness. The family spent months studying and preparing. Then, on **11 November 1833**, Erastus and Lucinda, along with their daughter Mary and sons Erastus Jr. and Thomas, were baptized into The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints in St. Johnsbury, Vermont, by Elder Evans. Their son Sanford followed one week later, baptized on **18 November 1833** at the same location.

The Missionaries Who Brought the Gospel

Elder John F. Boynton — spelled "Boyington" in some family journals — was the missionary who first preached the restored gospel to Erastus in the spring of 1833. He had already served missions in Pennsylvania and Maine and was known as a powerful and persuasive elder. Though the baptisms were performed by Elder Evans in November, family records credit Boynton with introducing the Book of Mormon and setting Erastus on the path to conversion. In February 1835, Boynton was ordained as one of the original members of the Quorum of the Twelve Apostles.

In the fall of 1835 — just two years after the Binghams' baptism — the newly called Quorum of the Twelve Apostles traveled as missionaries through the New England states. All twelve stayed one night at the Erastus Bingham home in Vermont and held a council meeting there. Brigham Young later reminded Erastus in Nauvoo that it was the

only Apostolic council meeting ever held entirely at a private member's home in Vermont.

> *Knowing their lives would never be the same, Erastus gathered his family and prepared for the gathering. He purchased a small brown leather notebook — known as the Sally Bingham Album — in which he and loved ones penned parting thoughts and sentiments. They knew that joining the Saints meant leaving their New England home behind forever.*

Driven Across the Wilderness: Missouri and Illinois

Embracing the spirit of gathering, in September 1836 the Binghams sold their Concord farm and packed up their children. Alongside the Farr and Snow families, they traveled hundreds of miles to Kirtland, Ohio. For a brief few months, Kirtland was their sanctuary — they lived among the Saints, witnessed the spiritual outpouring surrounding the newly dedicated Kirtland Temple, and gathered the provisions necessary to build a permanent Zion further west.

They arrived at Shoal Creek, about 2.5 miles outside of Far West, Missouri, on **4 November 1836**. Shoal Creek was the same waterway where Haun's Mill stood about 16 miles away. Because the Binghams were clustered close to the main body of the Church at the headquarters of Far West, they were spared the isolated massacre that struck the Saints at Haun's Mill on **30 October 1838**.

Following the Battle of Crooked River and Governor Boggs' subsequent Extermination Order, Far West was surrounded by thousands of state militia troops. The Binghams lived through the terrifying days of the siege — watching Latter-day Saint men forced into the town square at bayonet point, stripped of their weapons, and compelled to sign over their lands to the state.

As the Prophet Joseph Smith and other leaders lay trapped in Liberty Jail, the remaining leadership organized the mass evacuation of nearly 10,000 people in the dead of winter. Erastus was chosen to serve on a critical Committee of Removal alongside prominent leaders like Elias Smith and Stephen Markham. The committee was legally tasked with staying behind in hostile territory to oversee the sale and disposal of property that the fleeing Saints had to abandon — dangerous work, as marauding mobs constantly tried to steal or illegally occupy Mormon property. Erastus worked through the freezing winter months to ensure the poorest families had the means to leave. Only when his committee responsibilities were fulfilled did he finally pack up Lucinda and their children, leaving Far West in late March 1839. They sought refuge across the Mississippi River in Quincy, Illinois, and settled in Hancock County,

where Erastus rented a farm between Carthage and La Harpe. For six years they rebuilt their lives from scratch.

Then in 1844 came the martyrdom of Joseph Smith and his brother Hyrum at Carthage Jail — the epicenter of anti-Mormon hostility, just miles from their farm. Seeking safety and desperate to help finish the Nauvoo Temple, Erastus bought 160 acres just outside Nauvoo in the spring of 1845, building a new home for Lucinda and the family.

The Sacrifices at Council Bluffs

By early 1846, the Saints were forced to evacuate Illinois. Erastus and Lucinda abandoned yet another home, crossing the frozen Mississippi River. Erastus was appointed a Captain of 120, guiding a large company of wagons through the mud and slush of Iowa toward Council Bluffs.

While encamped there, the U.S. government called upon the Saints to provide 500 volunteers for the Mexican-American War. In an extraordinary act of sacrifice and loyalty, Erastus and Lucinda watched three of their immediate family members enlist in the Mormon Battalion: their son Erastus Jr., their son Thomas, and their son-in-law Elijah Norman Freeman — husband of their eldest daughter, Mary. All three enlisted on **16 July 1846** under Colonel James Allen. Erastus Sr. was left behind to care for the grieving families of these volunteers.

> *Elijah Norman Freeman never made it home. He died on 28 November 1846 and was buried on the banks of the Rio Grande. He was 24 years old.*

Elijah Norman Freeman never made it home. Assigned to the sick detachment at Santa Fe and sent back to winter at Pueblo, Colorado, he fell gravely ill and died on **28 November 1846**, buried four miles south of Socorro, New Mexico, on the banks of the Rio Grande. He was 24 years old. Mary, his wife and Erastus's eldest daughter, was left a widow with a young child.

Erastus Jr. and Thomas survived the Battalion march, both assigned to the sick detachment at Pueblo. They arrived in the Salt Lake Valley on **29 July 1847** — just days after Brigham Young's Vanguard Company. Food and resources at Council Bluffs were dangerously scarce. When local Native Americans friendly to the Saints invited them to share a winter camping ground called Swift Water near the Missouri River, Erastus Bingham stood up on his wagon wheel, looked out over the weary camp, and boldly declared his intention to follow the counsel of leadership. He announced that he and his family would accept the invitation and stay until spring, successfully persuading the rest of the camp to join them. Their cooperation with the indigenous tribes that brutal winter likely saved many lives.

The Trek to the Great Salt Lake Valley

In the spring of 1847, Erastus made a supply run into Missouri, securing enough provisions to last his family for 18 months. On **17 June 1847**, the family officially began their final trek across the Great Plains with the Daniel Spencer / Ira Eldredge Company — roughly 177 individuals and 76 wagons departing from the Elkhorn River outfitting post west of Winter Quarters. Erastus was appointed a Captain of 12, utilizing his years of trail experience to keep the wagons moving efficiently.

The journey was grueling, punctuated by sudden plains storms, heavy dust, and the constant threat of illness. Yet Lucinda and her daughters found a way to buoy the spirits of the camp. Journals report that in the evenings around the campfires they took a leading role in singing songs of praise, faith, and encouragement — their voices across the prairie giving the weary pioneers the fortitude to face the next day's miles.

After overcoming early autumn snowfalls and rugged mountain passes, Erastus and Lucinda rolled their wagons into the Great Salt Lake Valley between **19 and 22 September 1847**. They had survived thousands of miles of travel, multiple expulsions, the brutal winter at Council Bluffs, and the fracturing of their family by war and death.

Bishop of the North Ward: Building a New Zion

The family settled in the community that would become Ogden in Weber County, where Erastus immediately threw himself into the work of building a permanent frontier civilization. His decades of experience as a farmer, a community organizer, and a Church leader were recognized quickly. He was called to serve as **Bishop of the North Ward** — a position of central leadership in the growing pioneer community.

In **August 1851**, when Brigham Young ordered the Saints to fortify their settlements, Church leaders selected a site for a defensive enclosure on a portion of the Bingham family farm. The fort was built on that land and given the name **Bingham's Fort** — named, as the community records specifically note, "in honor of the Bishop Erastus Bingham of the North Ward." It was not merely a coincidence of geography: Erastus was the man whose land anchored the settlement, whose ecclesiastical leadership presided over it, and whose name it carried. Three years later, the Aldous family — recently arrived from Fenstanton, England — would settle at this same fort, joining the Weber County community that Erastus had helped build from the ground up. The ties between the two families deepened further when Angelina Theresa Aldous, daughter of Robert and Mary Ann Aldous, married **Brigham Heber Bingham** on **24 December 1862**, formally uniting the Aldous and Bingham lines in the valley where both families had made their homes.

Lucinda and Erastus spent the remainder of their lives in Ogden, watching the frontier community they had helped create grow into a permanent city. Lucinda died on **3**

January 1874, and was buried at the Ogden City Cemetery. Erastus outlived her by more than eight years, continuing his work in the community until his death on **2 May 1882**. He was 84 years old. He was laid to rest alongside Lucinda at the Ogden City Cemetery — two New Englanders who had left Vermont and New Hampshire nearly half a century before and built something lasting in the mountains of the West.

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A Note on Elder Boynton

John F. Boynton, the missionary who first brought the gospel to Erastus in 1833, was ordained an Apostle in February 1835. His story did not end in glory. In December 1837, embroiled in the financial collapse of the Kirtland Safety Society and accusations of misconduct, he was excommunicated from the Church. He never returned to the faith. He went on to become a noted geologist and inventor and died in Syracuse, New York, in October 1890 at age 79 — outliving Erastus Bingham himself by eight years. The seed he planted in Vermont in 1833 bore fruit he never came back to see.

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A Note on the Mormon Battalion

The FamilySearch profile for Erastus Bingham Sr. (KWJ4-KJ3) carries a researcher note entered May 2026 stating explicitly that Erastus Sr. did ***not*** serve in the Mormon Battalion — that only his two sons, Erastus Jr. and Thomas, and his son-in-law Elijah Norman Freeman did so. This is the position reflected in this account. However, the Mormon Battalion historic site in Old Town, San Diego, California lists a name understood by some researchers to be Erastus Bingham Sr., and this discrepancy remains unresolved on his FamilySearch Collaborate page. Researchers wishing to investigate further should consult B.H. Roberts, *The Mormon Battalion: Its History and Achievements* (Deseret News, 1919), and the primary military muster rolls, which list Erastus Bingham Jr. and Thomas Bingham in Company B.

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Source Citations

Erastus Bingham Sr. — Vital Records: FamilySearch profile KWJ4-KJ3, familysearch.org/en/tree/person/details/KWJ4-KJ3. Born 12 March 1798, Concord, Essex County, Vermont; died 2 May 1882, Ogden, Weber, Utah. 79 sources, High Quality. Vermont Vital Records, 1760–1954 (FamilySearch); 1820 United States Federal Census, Concord, Essex, Vermont.

Lucinda Gates — Vital Records: FamilySearch profile KWJ4-KJ9, familysearch.org/en/tree/person/details/KWJ4-KJ9. Born 19 September 1797, Acworth, Cheshire County, New Hampshire; died 3 January 1874, Ogden, Weber, Utah Territory; buried Ogden City Cemetery. 109 sources, High Quality. Family lineage: Charles Otis Gates, *Stephen Gates of Hingham & Lancaster, Massachusetts, and His Descendants* (1898). Burial: Find a Grave.

Marriage — 20 March 1820, St. Johnsbury, Vermont: Image of marriage record, Erastus Bingham & Lucinda Gates, attached to FamilySearch profile KWJ4-KJ3. Vermont Town Clerk Vital Records (FamilySearch DGS 5459895).

Baptism Dates, Location, and Officiant: Erastus, Lucinda, Mary, Erastus Jr., and Thomas baptized 11 November 1833; Sanford baptized 18 November 1833 — all in St. Johnsbury, Vermont, by Elder Evans. — Russell/Bitton/Thomas/Jensen family blog (Feb. 2013); Church History Biographical Database, history.churchofjesuschrist.org.

Elder John F. Boynton — Biography: Born 20 September 1811, Bradford, Massachusetts. Ordained Apostle 15 February 1835. Excommunicated December 1837. Died 20 October 1890, Syracuse, New York. — Andrew Jenson, *Latter-day Saint Biographical Encyclopedia*, Vol. 1, p. 91; Joseph Smith Papers (josephsmithpapers.org).

Apostolic Council Meeting at Bingham Home, 1835: Russell/Bitton/Thomas/Jensen family history blog; confirmed in Neil D. Bingham, "Life History of Erastus Bingham, Sr.," in *Descendants of Erastus Bingham and Lucinda Gates*.

Sally Bingham Album: Historical family artifact; digitized in Erastus Bingham Sr. Memories Collection, FamilySearch (KWJ4-KJ3).

Kirtland Departure (September 1836): Rhea Farr Wiggins, "Biography of Mary Bingham Freeman Snow Farr," Erastus Bingham Sr. Memories Collection (KWJ4-KJ3).

Shoal Creek / Far West Arrival (4 November 1836): "Brief History of Erastus Bingham," family history manuscript; Memories Collection (KWJ4-KJ3).

Far West Committee of Removal: "Far West Committee Minutes," 29 January 1839, LDS Church Archives; published in *History of the Church*, Vol. 3, pp. 251–254.

Nauvoo Land Purchase (spring 1845): "Erastus Bingham Sr. Nauvoo Land Record.pdf," Memories Collection (KWJ4-KJ3).

Mormon Battalion — Erastus Jr., Thomas, and Elijah Freeman: Enlisted 16 July 1846, Company B. Elijah Norman Freeman died 28 November 1846, near Socorro, New Mexico. Erastus Jr. and Thomas arrived Salt Lake Valley 29 July 1847. — B.H. Roberts, *The Mormon Battalion: Its History and Achievements* (Deseret News, 1919); Erastus Bingham pension application, 1859 (BYU MSS SC 972).

Swift Water / Council Bluffs Winter: Neil D. Bingham, "Life History of Erastus Bingham, Sr.," in *Descendants of Erastus Bingham and Lucinda Gates*. Includes the wagon wheel account.

Daniel Spencer / Ira Eldredge Company (1847): 177 individuals and 76 wagons; departed Elkhorn River, 17 June 1847; arrived Salt Lake Valley 19–22 September 1847. — Church History Biographical Database, history.churchofjesuschrist.org.

Lucinda and Daughters Singing on the Plains: Journal of Erastus Bingham, quoted in Neil D. Bingham, "Life History of Erastus Bingham, Sr."

Bingham's Fort — August 1851, Built on Bingham Farm: "History of Bingham's Fort," Chapter 7 (Andrew Jenson), digitized in Memories Collection (KWJ4-KJ3): "The fort was given the name of Bingham's Fort in honor of the Bishop Erastus Bingham of the North Ward." Also: "Settlement of Lynne, Utah," Memories Collection (KWJ4-KJ3). Angelina Theresa Aldous married Brigham Heber Bingham, 24 December 1862: *Pioneers and Prominent Men of Utah*, p. 711; genealogy.aldous.net.

Lucinda Gates Bingham — Death and Burial: Death 3 January 1874, Ogden, Weber, Utah Territory. Burial: Ogden City Cemetery. FamilySearch profile KWJ4-KJ9; Find a Grave.

Erastus Bingham Sr. — Death and Burial: Death 2 May 1882, Ogden, Weber, Utah. Burial: Ogden City Cemetery. FamilySearch profile KWJ4-KJ3.

Story 2 of 12

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A Prophet's Bodyguard, a Mother's Last Sacrifice

Lewis Dunbar Wilson and Nancy Ann Waggoner

— ✦ —

Vermont, Ohio, Missouri, Illinois, Iowa, and Utah • 1805–1856

Baptized: 23 May 1836

Richland County, Ohio



A Prophet's Bodyguard, a Mother's Last Sacrifice

Lewis Dunbar Wilson and Nancy Ann Waggoner

Vermont, Ohio, Missouri, Illinois, Iowa, and Utah • 1805–1856

Vermont Roots and the Journey West

The story of Lewis Dunbar Wilson and Nancy Ann Waggoner begins in the rugged, forested hills of northwestern Vermont. Lewis was born on **2 June 1805** in Milton, Chittenden County, the fifth child of Bradley Barlow Wilson Sr. and Mary "Polly" Gill. The Wilson family was tight-knit and deeply rooted in the demanding agrarian traditions of early New England, but as farmland along the eastern seaboard grew scarce, the family looked to the western frontier. In the early 1830s, Lewis joined his parents and siblings in a coordinated family migration to Richland County, Ohio, where he established himself as a skilled cooper and farmer.

It was there that he met Nancy Ann Waggoner, born **10 July 1810**, the daughter of David Waggoner and Esarua Thurna Barrett. The Waggoners were hardworking frontier settlers, and Nancy Ann had grown up knowing what it meant to build a life from raw ground. She and Lewis married on **11 June 1830** in Richland County, and over the following two decades she would anchor a household that was rarely still for long, ultimately bearing ten children. She faced the profound joys and deep sorrows of early motherhood on the frontier, knowing from the beginning that the wilderness gave nothing without a fight.

The Missionaries Who Brought the Gospel

In the spring of 1836, missionaries representing the newly organized Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints arrived in Richland County. Among them were **George Albert Smith** and **Lyman Smith** — who had served a joint mission to the eastern United States the previous year and were now preaching in Ohio. George Albert Smith was a cousin to the Prophet Joseph Smith, a young man of nineteen who would later be ordained an Apostle and serve as First Counselor in the First Presidency under Brigham Young.

Their message struck a deep chord within the Wilson and Waggoner households. On **23 May 1836**, Lewis and Nancy Ann were baptized into the Church. They did not come to the water alone — Lewis's brother Bradley Barlow Wilson Jr. and several members of the extended Waggoner and Wilson families were converted during the same missionary sweep, transforming their kin network into a unified body of believers from a single season's preaching. From that spring day in Ohio forward, the lives of Lewis Dunbar

Wilson and Nancy Ann Waggoner were permanently bound to the gathering command and the turbulent, historic destiny of the early Latter-day Saints.

The Fires of Missouri

Driven by the call to gather with the main body of the Saints, Lewis moved his family to Kirtland, Ohio, in 1837, where he attended the newly dedicated Kirtland Temple. But the Kirtland community was fracturing under economic strain and internal conflict, and the family soon followed the Church westward to Missouri.

By the autumn of 1838, Lewis and Nancy Ann had settled their young family in Caldwell County, Missouri. Their peace was brief. Lewis's own diary records the sequence with spare precision: *"On the 30 of August 1838, we started for the land of Zion. On the 21st of October, we landed on land of our own. I built a cabin."* Governor Lilburn Boggs issued his infamous Extermination Order that November, and within weeks the family was driven from their home. Lewis wrote that they were mobbed and driven from their homes and started for Nauvoo, arriving there in late November 1839.

Before leaving Missouri, Lewis had already been ordained a member of the high council. In October 1839, at the corner stake of Zion conference, he was formally sustained as one of the first members of the **Nauvoo High Council** — a calling named in Doctrine and Covenants Section 124, verse 132. He was ordained to the office by the Patriarch Hyrum Smith.

Nauvoo: Bodyguard and Builder

In Nauvoo, Lewis threw himself into building the rising city on the Mississippi. As a skilled cooper and farmer, his labor was immediately useful. His standing in the community grew with his position on the High Council, and at some point he was assigned to serve as one of the **personal bodyguards of the Prophet Joseph Smith**. The Prophet gave him a sword in recognition of his service — a family treasure that Lewis Dunbar Jr. kept for the rest of his life.

In the summer of 1843, when Joseph Smith was illegally arrested in Dixon, Illinois, by Missouri agents seeking to extradite him on treason charges, the news triggered a massive rescue response from Nauvoo. Lewis was among the group of men who rode to intercept the arresting officers and return the Prophet safely to Nauvoo. His bravery in that effort was explicitly recognized and led directly to his formal assignment as one of the Prophet's bodyguards.

Lewis Dunbar Jr., born **21 September 1840** in Nauvoo, grew up in the thick of all this history. As a small boy he sat on the Prophet's knee while Joseph told stories. He later recalled hearing the noise and confusion at the time of the martyrdom, and described the day a mob chased Joseph Smith into his father's home — his mother hiding the

Prophet under the bed while Lewis Sr. went outside with a gun to hold the crowd back. This son, Lewis Dunbar Wilson Jr., is the direct link in the family line that descends to the present day: he would walk across the plains as a twelve-year-old boy, grow up in Ogden, and eventually become the father of Catharine Rozella Wilson.

> *The Prophet gave Lewis a sword in recognition of his service as bodyguard — a family treasure that Lewis Dunbar Jr. kept for the rest of his life.*

The year 1844 brought unimaginable grief to the city. Following the martyrdom of Joseph and Hyrum Smith in June, Lewis remained fiercely loyal to the Quorum of the Twelve Apostles under Brigham Young, continuing his duties on the High Council and laboring on the Nauvoo Temple. He and Nancy Ann received their endowments in the temple in December 1845, and on **19 January 1846**, they were sealed together in the house of the Lord — binding their marriage covenant before the final exodus from Illinois began.

Exile and the Loss of Nancy Ann

When the Saints were forced out of Nauvoo in early 1846, Lewis and Nancy Ann left with the first company, crossing the frozen Mississippi River into Iowa. The journey was punishing. Lewis wrote: *"We had a dreadful, tedious journey of about two months. We passed through more rain and mud than I had ever seen in my life before."* They reached Garden Grove, Iowa, by **7 February 1846** and settled there for several years.

During this period, Lewis largely disappeared from standard civil records — a pattern the family attributes to the legal risks he faced as a former bodyguard to the Prophet, with anti-Mormon litigation still pursuing the Prophet's close associates after the martyrdom. He is absent from the 1850 U.S. Federal Census, effectively operating under his middle name "Dunbar Wilson" during the Iowa years. Church records for this period note his circumstances with a single word: *Poverty*.

In May 1851, the family set out from Garden Grove for Council Bluffs, a journey of 160 miles that Lewis described as the hardest traveling he had endured since Missouri. They settled on Michito Creek, planted corn and potatoes, and began building a house. Then, on **19 July 1851**, Nancy Ann gave birth to a son she and Lewis named Samuel. Lewis's diary records what followed without softening: *"When I returned, I found my wife very ill, after giving birth to a son July 19, 1851, who was named Samuel. His Dear Mother only lived ten hours after his birth."*

> *Nancy Ann Waggoner was forty years old. She had survived the militia raids of Missouri, the frigid crossing into Iowa, and years of grinding*

poverty — only to fall at the last. She did not live to see the valley. She is buried in Iowa soil.

Nancy Ann had been a member of the Church for fifteen years. She had attended every ordinance of the gospel offered in her day and had performed temple work for her father's family in the Nauvoo Temple before the exodus. She had held her household together through mobs and mud and malnutrition. Left with a motherless household, Lewis married his third wife, **Sarah Elizabeth Waldo**, on **28 September 1851**. For the next two years they gathered the provisions, livestock, and equipment needed for the crossing to Utah.

The 1853 Trek and the Settlement of Ogden

On **8 June 1853**, Dunbar's wagon rolled into formation with the Daniel A. Miller / John W. Cooley Company. He was forty-eight years old. Walking beside the wagon were his oldest son, Lemuel Green Wilson, then twenty, and twelve-year-old **Lewis Dunbar Wilson Jr.** — the direct ancestor in this family line — handling the livestock and oxen over the mountain passes. Inside the wagon or walking in the trail dust were younger children: Almeda (fourteen), David Wagner (eleven), Nancy Melissa (five), and George Miles (three).

On **9 September 1853**, the walls of the Salt Lake Valley rose before them. Their exile was over.

The family did not stay long in Salt Lake City. Church authorities directed them north to Ogden, where experienced settlers were needed. Dunbar's decades of service as a High Council member were immediately recognized, and he was integrated into local leadership. On **12 February 1854**, he married his final wife, **Nancy Ann Sheppard Cossitt**, providing stability for his large, blended household.

He did not have many years left. The decades of hardship — the mobs of Missouri, the fever swamps of Nauvoo, the grinding poverty of Iowa, the crossing of the plains — had spent his body. On **11 March 1856**, Lewis Dunbar Wilson died in Ogden, Weber County, Utah, at the age of fifty. He was laid to rest in the Ogden City Cemetery, leaving behind a profound legacy: a bodyguard to the Prophet, a member of the original Nauvoo High Council, a pioneer builder, and the father of Lewis Dunbar Wilson Jr.

The Family Line Continues: Lewis Jr. and Catherine Wiggins

Lewis Dunbar Wilson Jr. grew up in Ogden, carrying with him the memories of a boyhood spent at the Prophet's knee and a twelve-year-old's crossing of the American plains. On **31 December 1862**, in Ogden, he married **Catherine Wiggins** — daughter of Ebenezer Fairchild Wiggins and Eleanor Moore, themselves pioneers who had crossed the plains in 1852 with the Henry W. Miller Company after years of

displacement in Pottawattamie County, Iowa. Two pioneer families, shaped by the same turbulent decades of the early Restoration, joined their lines in Ogden's young community.

Their daughter, **Catharine Rozella Wilson**, married Brigham Albert Bingham, whose own line descended from Erastus Bingham — the man who had established Bingham's Fort in Weber County and served as Bishop of the North Ward. The Wilson, Wiggins, and Bingham lines, each having crossed the country by separate roads through persecution, poverty, and faith, converged in the same Utah valley and wove themselves into a single family.

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A Note on the Nauvoo Temple Records

During the final frantic week of temple ordinances in early February 1846 — the same period when Lewis and Nancy Ann received their own endowments — Lewis was also sealed to a nineteen-year-old woman named **Martha Minerva Reynolds**. Records show that Martha subsequently traveled west with her own family, lived under her maiden name, and had no shared household or children with Lewis. She appears on the 1850 Federal Census in Iron County, Utah, strictly as Martha M. Reynolds.

Scholars of this period recognize a practice known as "eternity-only" sealings in the final days of the Nauvoo Temple, by which faithful young individuals were sealed into established priesthood family lines for the next life with no expectation of an earthly marriage, cohabitation, or children. The absolute urgency of February 1846 — when thousands of Saints rushed to receive ordinances before abandoning the city forever — and Martha's complete independence from the Wilson household in every subsequent record strongly suggest this was the nature of that sealing. It is noted here for the sake of completeness and transparency, not as evidence of a plural marriage in any conventional sense.

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A Note on the Diary of Lewis Dunbar Wilson

The primary source underlying much of this account is Lewis's own diary: *Lewis D. Wilson, Reminiscence and Diary, 1846–1854*, typescript, Church History Library, MS 9870. This document is cited in the Joseph Smith Papers biography of Lewis Dunbar Wilson and is available at josephsmithpapers.org. The diary is the source for the direct quotations used throughout this account. Where the diary conflicts with secondary sources — for example, the precise date of the Nauvoo sealing (the diary states January 19; a secondary source had stated January 20) — the diary is treated as authoritative.

The diary's account of Nancy Ann's death is particularly important: it makes unmistakably clear that she died of complications following childbirth on July 19, 1851, not from accumulated illness as earlier accounts had suggested.

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Source Citations

Lewis Dunbar Wilson Sr. — Vital Records: FamilySearch profile KWV9-C9X. Born 2 June 1805, Milton, Chittenden County, Vermont; died 11 March 1856, Ogden, Weber County, Utah; buried Ogden City Cemetery. Confirmed: Find A Grave memorial #18934350.

Nancy Ann Waggoner — Vital Records: FamilySearch profile KWV9-C96. Born 10 July 1810; died 19 July 1851, Kanesville (Council Bluffs), Pottawattamie County, Iowa — of complications following childbirth. Buried Iowa soil; exact burial location not recorded.

Marriage — 11 June 1830, Richland County, Ohio: Lewis D. Wilson Reminiscence and Diary, MS 9870, Church History Library; confirmed in Joseph Smith Papers biography of Lewis Dunbar Wilson, josephsmithpapers.org.

Missionaries — George Albert Smith and Lyman Smith, Spring 1836: Joseph Smith Papers, biography of George Albert Smith: "Served mission to eastern U.S. with Lyman Smith, 1835. Served mission to Ohio, 1836." josephsmithpapers.org; Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints, "George A. Smith," Doctrine and Covenants Historical Resources, churchofjesuschrist.org.

Baptism — 23 May 1836: Lewis D. Wilson, Reminiscence and Diary, MS 9870, Church History Library; cited in Joseph Smith Papers biography of Lewis Dunbar Wilson.

Missouri — Arrival, Settlement, and Expulsion: Wilson Diary: "On the 30 of August 1838, we started for the land of Zion. On the 21st of October, we landed on land of our own. I built a cabin." Extermination Order: Governor Lilburn W. Boggs, October 1838.

Nauvoo High Council Call — October 1839: Doctrine and Covenants 124:132. Wilson Diary: "I was chosen in the same revelation the Apostles were chosen D, C, section 121. I was ordained to the high counsel by Hyrum Smith, patriarch." Confirmed: Church of Jesus Christ, "Lewis Dunbar Wilson," D&C Historical Resources, churchofjesuschrist.org.

Bodyguard to the Prophet — Sword and Dixon Rescue: History of Lewis Dunbar Wilson Jr., compiled by Ethel Wilson Harrison: "His father being one of the High Council was given a sword by the Prophet." yanceyfamilygenealogy.org/ldwjrhist.htm. Dixon rescue July 1843: ScriptureCentral, "Lewis Dunbar Wilson," scripturecentral.org: "In July 1843 he joined his brethren in an attempt to rescue the Prophet Joseph Smith from Missourians 'at all hazards and bring him to Nauvoo.' Because of his bravery in the rescue attempt, Lewis was assigned to be a bodyguard of the Prophet."

Lewis Dunbar Wilson Jr. — Childhood Memories of Joseph Smith: History of Lewis Dunbar Wilson Jr., compiled by Ethel Wilson Harrison: "He remembered when a small boy sitting upon the knee of the Prophet Joseph Smith while he was telling stories... He used to tell of one time when the mob chased the Prophet into his father's home and seeing his mother hide the

Prophet under the bed while his father went out with a gun to keep the angry mob away." yanceyfamilygenealogy.org/ldwjrhist.htm.

Nauvoo Temple Endowment and Sealing — 19 January 1846: Wilson Diary: "After I baptized some weeks in the temple, January 19, 1846, Nancy and I were sealed in the house of the Lord." Note: a secondary source had stated January 20; Lewis's own diary gives January 19 and is treated as authoritative. Temple Records Index Bureau, Nauvoo Temple Endowment Register, cited in Joseph Smith Papers biography of Lewis Dunbar Wilson.

Iowa Exile — Journey to Garden Grove and "Poverty": Wilson Diary: "We had a dreadful, tedious journey of about two months. We passed through more rain and mud than I had ever seen in my life before. We reached Garden Grove February 7." Lewis Dunbar Wilson, 1851 Membership Entry, FamilySearch, Early Church Information File, 1830–1900, ark:/61903/1:1:QPZJ-RSJW.

Death of Nancy Ann Waggoner — 19 July 1851: Wilson Diary: "When I returned, I found my wife very ill, after giving birth to a son July 19, 1851, who was named Samuel. His Dear Mother only lived ten hours after his birth." This is the definitive primary source. Earlier accounts attributed her death to accumulated illness; the diary is unambiguous that she died of complications following childbirth.

Martha Minerva Reynolds — Temple Sealing 3 February 1846: Temple sealing recorded 3 February 1846. Martha appears on the 1850 Federal Census in Iron County, Utah, under her maiden name Reynolds, with no connection to the Wilson household. FamilySearch Historical Records — Illinois, Hancock County, Nauvoo Community Project, 1839–1846.

Daniel A. Miller / John W. Cooley Company — 1853 Trek: "Lewis Dunbar Wilson," Mormon Pioneer Overland Travel Database, Church History Department, history.churchofjesuschrist.org/overlandtravel; FamilySearch ark:/61903/1:1:QK9B-CF9G. Departed 8 June 1853; arrived Salt Lake Valley 9 September 1853. Lewis Dunbar Wilson Jr. (born 21 September 1840) was twelve years old at departure.

Settlement in Ogden and Death of Lewis Sr. — 11 March 1856: Death 11 March 1856, Ogden, Weber County, Utah. Burial: Ogden City Cemetery. FamilySearch profile KWV9-C9X; Find A Grave memorial #18934350.

Lewis Dunbar Wilson Jr. Marriage to Catherine Wiggins — 31 December 1862: Lewis Dunbar Wilson Jr. family history, yanceyfamilygenealogy.org/ldwjrhist.htm. Marriage 31 December 1862, Ogden, Utah. Catherine Wiggins (born 13 April 1845, LaHarpe, Hancock County, Illinois), daughter of Ebenezer Fairchild Wiggins (FamilySearch KWV3-MW9) and Eleanor Moore. The Wiggins family crossed the plains with the Henry W. Miller Company in 1852.

Family Line — Wilson to Wiggins to Bingham: FamilySearch lineage: Lewis Dunbar Wilson Sr. [KWV9-C9X] → Lewis Dunbar Wilson Jr. [KWDM-FSM] → Catharine Rozella Wilson [KWCF-5K5] → Brigham Albert Bingham [KWC7-BZN] → Don Robert Bingham [KWCN-VKW] → Carol Hendricks [KWZG-9WC].

Story 3 of 12

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The Illinois Farm Sold to Emma Smith

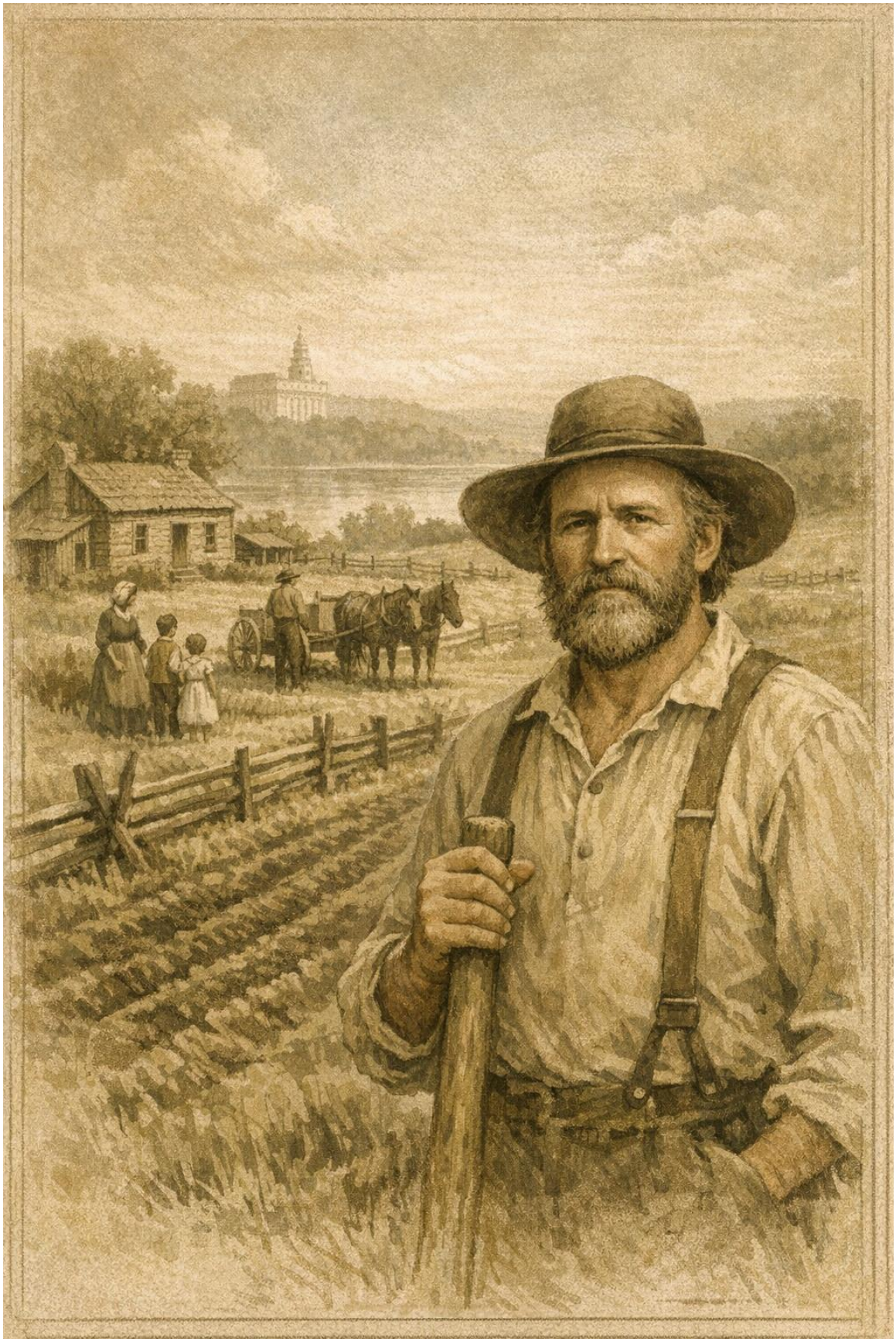
Ebenezer Fairchild Wiggins and Eleanor Moore

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Millersburg, Kentucky • Illinois • Ogden, Utah • 1832–1871

Baptized: January 1841

Nauvoo, Hancock County, Illinois



The Illinois Farm Sold to Emma Smith

Ebenezer Fairchild Wiggins and Eleanor Moore

Millersburg, Kentucky to Hancock County, Illinois to Ogden, Utah • 1832–1871

Illinois Roots: Before the Saints Arrived

Long before Ebenezer Fairchild Wiggins ever heard the name Joseph Smith, he had already built something worth leaving behind. Born on **4 February 1806** in Millersburg, Bourbon County, Kentucky, to Jonas Wiggins and Mary Anne Fairchild, Ebenezer grew up in a family that understood land — how to work it, how to hold it, and how to move on from it when something better called.

The Wiggins family had been moving for generations. Jonas had roots in Wilkes County, North Carolina, and the family migrated through Kentucky — holding land in Muhlenberg County in the western part of the state — before the next generation pushed further north and west. Ebenezer followed that current. Sometime in the late 1820s or early 1830s, he made his way to Hancock County, Illinois, on the western edge of the state where the Mississippi River defined the horizon.

It was there he met Eleanor Moore. They married on **25 October 1832** in Hancock County, and set immediately to work building a life on the Illinois frontier. Over the following years they established themselves in Appanoose Township — the northwest corner of Hancock County, positioned along the great river a few miles north of a small settlement that would soon be renamed Nauvoo. Ebenezer had received 116 acres of Section 30 land from Samuel Wiggins, almost certainly a family conveyance, divided across two parcels along the township line. He added to this in October 1840 through a federal land patent — an additional parcel in the Northwest Quarter of Section 30, Township 7 North, Range 8 West.

Their children arrived steadily: Mary Ann in 1833, Sarah Elender and William James in 1835, Ellenor in 1838, and Eliza in 1840. The family was rooted in the river-bottom prairie, clearing timber, planting crops, and becoming part of the tight-knit community of original Illinois settlers who had staked their futures on the fertile clay ground above the Mississippi bend.

The Coming of the Saints

Their quiet life changed in the spring of 1839. Suddenly, thousands of destitute, exhausted refugees — men, women, and children expelled by state-sponsored violence from Missouri — began pouring across the Mississippi River directly into Hancock County. The local citizens watched in awe as the Saints took over a malaria-ridden bend

in the river called Commerce, renamed it Nauvoo, and began raising a massive, bustling city out of the swamps practically overnight.

Nauvoo grew to dwarf every other settlement in Hancock County within just two years. For Ebenezer and Eleanor, these were not distant newcomers — they were neighbors. The great spiritual expansion of the Restoration was moving outward through the surrounding farmlands, carried by Latter-day Saint elders who preached to anyone willing to listen. Neighbors who had lived alongside the Wiggins family for a decade began joining the new faith.

Intrigued by the sheer conviction of the Saints and the powerful doctrines of a restored gospel, Ebenezer and Eleanor began opening their home to the missionaries. Aligning with the Saints was not without social cost — the local Illinois old-settlers were growing increasingly hostile to the massive, politically powerful Mormon population in their backyard. To join the Church meant turning one's back on long-standing local friendships and risking immediate social ostracization.

Yet, moved by genuine spiritual conviction, Ebenezer and Eleanor chose faith over comfort. In **January 1841**, as the foundations of the Nauvoo Temple were being laid just a few miles to the south, both were baptized into The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints.

The Farm, the Prophet, and Emma Smith

Within months of their baptism, Ebenezer made a transaction that bound his family's fortunes directly to the heart of the Restoration. On **14–15 May 1841**, he entered into an agreement and deed with **Emma Smith** — wife of the Prophet Joseph Smith — conveying his farm in Section 30 for the sum of **$2,700**.

The terms were structured carefully. Emma paid $1,100 upfront — $100 in goods and $1,000 in Nauvoo town lots — with the remaining $1,600 to come in three annual installments of $533.33. The deed was witnessed by R. B. Thompson, Joseph Smith's personal secretary, and acknowledged before Ebenezer Robinson, Justice of the Peace. Eleanor, unable to write, signed with her mark — an X — as she would again when the deed was formally recorded the following day.

Joseph Smith was not named on the deed. He was operating under bankruptcy protection at the time and could not hold property in his own name; Emma served as the legal titleholder for property transactions on his behalf. But the agreement was filed in Joseph's office, and the practical reality was unmistakable: Ebenezer Fairchild Wiggins had sold his family's land directly to the Prophet's household.

The Nauvoo town lots Ebenezer received as partial payment were not held for long. By August and September 1842, he was selling at least one of them back to the Church

trustee for $800, receiving payment in a combination of cash, silver, and — significantly — a wagon and a span of horses and harness. That wagon and team may well have been the same outfit that would eventually carry his family across Iowa and the plains.

> *Ebenezer Fairchild Wiggins had sold his family's land directly to the Prophet's household — and received in partial payment the wagon and horses that would one day carry his children to Utah.*

Within three years of joining the Church, Ebenezer demonstrated his commitment in another way. On **21 July 1844** — just weeks after the martyrdom of Joseph and Hyrum Smith — he entered the baptismal font in the basement of the Nauvoo Temple and was baptized on behalf of his own father, Jonas Wiggins, who had died on 23 July 1832 near Bremen, Muhlenberg, Kentucky. The ordinance was officiated by Ezra Parrish and Hans Christian, and recorded in the Nauvoo Baptismal Records of the Dead, Book D80.

Forced to Flee

The peace of Nauvoo did not last. As neighboring resentment boiled over into open violence following the martyrdom, the Wiggins family found themselves caught in the crosshairs. To the anti-Mormon factions in Hancock County, a native Illinois landowner who had sold his farm to the Prophet's wife and joined the Church was viewed as a traitor. Armed mobs began riding through the outlying settlements, burning barns, destroying crops, and threatening families.

By early 1846, as the main body of the Church organized its retreat across the frozen Mississippi River, Ebenezer and Eleanor faced a stark choice. They could not remain safely in Appanoose Township. The Nauvoo town lots they had received as payment were worthless to anyone who could not stay to defend them. The wagon they had acquired from the Church trustee in 1842 was waiting.

They packed it. In the early months of 1846, with all seven children — the youngest, Catherine, **less than a year old** — Ebenezer and Eleanor crossed the Mississippi River into Iowa Territory. Rebecca had been born in March 1843 and Catherine in April 1845, both in Hancock County, Illinois. Every child in that wagon had been born on the Illinois prairie. Every child was now a refugee.

> *Eleanor crossed a frozen river in winter with seven children, the youngest less than a year old. Every one of them had been born on the Illinois prairie they were leaving behind.*

Six Years on the Iowa Prairie

The family made its way to Pottawattamie County, Iowa, where thousands of other displaced Saints were encamped in the muddy river-bottom settlements. The 1850

Federal Census found them there — Ebenezer listed as a farmer with Eleanor and all seven children recorded in the household. They were among the last of the Nauvoo Saints still waiting to make the crossing to the Rocky Mountains.

The years in Iowa were years of preparation and poverty. Provisions had to be accumulated. Livestock had to be purchased. Wagons had to be maintained and outfitted for a thousand-mile overland journey. The community they lived in was Kanesville — the same settlement, soon to be renamed Council Bluffs, that served as the final outfitting point for the great emigrant companies heading west. It was also, by 1852, emptying fast. The Church had been systematically directing its Iowa-based Saints toward Utah for years. Kanesville had become a ghost town of its former self as company after company departed through the summer seasons. The Wiggins family waited until the very last.

The Henry W. Miller Company

On **8 July 1852**, Ebenezer — now 46 years old — loaded Eleanor and their seven children into formation with the **Henry W. Miller Company**. It was the twentieth and final emigrant company of the 1852 season, departing Kanesville on a wet July morning as the last wagon train to leave that year. There were roughly **229 people and 63 wagons** in the company. The company roster listed Ebenezer (age 46) with Eleanor Moore (42) and their children: Mary Ann (18), Sarah Eleander (16), William James (16), Ellenor (14), Eliza (11), Rebecca (9), and Catherine (7).

The company captain, Henry W. Miller — known to his fellow pioneers as the "Old Pioneer" — was himself a Nauvoo veteran who had helped build the original Mormon settlement on the Missouri River. Under his leadership the company crossed the dusty plains through the summer heat, climbing over rocky passes and fording rushing rivers as the weeks accumulated into miles.

On **10 September 1852**, the wagons rolled through the canyon passes and into the Great Salt Lake Valley. The Wiggins family had made it. They eventually pushed north to settle permanently in Ogden, Weber County, Utah Territory, joining the community of pioneers who were building a new civilization in the shadow of the Wasatch Range.

The Years in Ogden

Ebenezer received his temple endowment on **6 November 1852** — within weeks of arriving in the valley, as though he had been waiting the full six Iowa years for that moment.

The family settled in Ogden and began the work of building pioneer lives in the mountain West. The children grew up, married, and put down roots. Catherine — born in LaHarpe, Hancock County, Illinois, in April 1845, the baby who had crossed the

frozen Mississippi as an infant — grew up in Ogden, was educated there, and taught school there. She became known as an excellent teacher and an expert speller, the kind of woman other teachers invited to their classrooms for spelling contests. Apostle Orson Hyde, she later recalled, was a family friend who visited their home and once brought her the first piece of fruit she ever tasted in Utah.

Ebenezer did not live to see Catherine fully grown. On **5 December 1858**, he died in Ogden at the age of 52, just six years after the wagons had rolled through the canyon passes. He had brought his family from Kentucky to Illinois, from Illinois to Iowa, from Iowa to Utah. Eleanor, then 48, was left to raise the younger children alone in the pioneer settlement. Catherine was thirteen years old.

Eleanor lived for thirteen more years. She watched her children marry and establish themselves in the Ogden valley. She watched the grandchildren arrive. She watched the community take permanent shape around the labors she and Ebenezer had invested in it. She died in **1871** in Ogden, Weber County, Utah, and was buried there — a woman who had crossed a frozen river with a baby in her arms and built a life on the far side of the continent.

Catherine and the Wilson Line

On **31 December 1862** — just four years after her father's death — Catherine Wiggins, aged seventeen, married **Lewis Dunbar Wilson Jr.** in Ogden. Lewis was a Nauvoo-born pioneer, the son of Lewis Dunbar Wilson Sr. and Nancy Ann Waggoner. His father had been a personal bodyguard to the Prophet Joseph Smith and a member of the original Nauvoo High Council. Lewis Jr. himself had walked across the plains at age twelve in 1853 with the Daniel A. Miller / John W. Cooley Company.

Two pioneer families, shaped by the same turbulent decades of the early Restoration, joined their lines in Ogden's young community. Their daughter, **Catharine Rozella Wilson**, would carry both the Wiggins and Wilson legacies forward — marrying into the Bingham line and connecting three pioneer families whose separate crossings of the American continent had brought them, by different roads, to the same valley. The story of Ebenezer and Eleanor Wiggins does not end in Ogden. It continues through Catherine's descendants into the present day.

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A Note on the Farm

The farm Ebenezer sold to Emma Smith in May 1841 sat in Section 30, Township 7 North, Range 8 West — in the Appanoose Township land that Ebenezer had first received from Samuel Wiggins in 1827 and added to through the October 1840 federal

land patent. After the Saints were expelled from Illinois in 1846, the Nauvoo properties changed hands repeatedly. The agreement and deed between Ebenezer and Emma Smith are preserved in the Joseph Smith Papers and in the Hancock County Deed records, respectively — an unusual distinction for a frontier farmer's land transaction, and a measure of how completely the Wiggins family had placed themselves at the center of the Restoration story while it was still unfolding.

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Source Citations

Ebenezer Fairchild Wiggins — Vital Records: FamilySearch profile KWV3-MW9, familysearch.org/en/tree/person/details/KWV3-MW9. Born 4 February 1806, Millersburg, Bourbon County, Kentucky (updated May 2026 per Church History Biographical Database); died 5 December 1858, Ogden, Weber, Utah Territory, age 52. Note: the family also held land in Muhlenberg County, Kentucky — confirmed by 1834 Muhlenberg County deed, Ebenezer and Eleanor selling inherited land from Jonas Wiggins to Lewis Wiggins. Cause of death not located; Utah did not maintain formal death certificates until 1905.

Eleanor Moore — Vital Records: FamilySearch profile KWV3-MWM. Born c. 1810; died 1871, Ogden, Weber County, Utah. Burial: Ogden, Utah. Eleanor Moore age 42 confirmed in 1850 Pottawattamie County, Iowa, Federal Census.

Marriage — 25 October 1832, Hancock County, Illinois: Illinois, Hancock County Marriage Index; Ebenezer F. Wiggins and Eleanor Moore, 25 October 1832. Cited in BYU Center for Family History and Genealogy Research Log, p. 2.

Land Holdings — Section 30, Appanoose Township: Nauvoo and Surrounding Communities Property Transactions Database, 1839–1859, BYU Center for Family History and Genealogy. Transaction 16 January 1827: Samuel Wiggins to Ebenezer F. Wiggins and Eleanor, 116 acres total, Section 30, Township 7 North, Range 8 West. Federal land patent: Bureau of Land Management, General Land Office Records, Patent Accession No. IL3890__.233, Certificate No. 1680, issued 10 October 1840, NW¼ of the NW¼ of Section 30, Township 7 North, Range 8 West (Appanoose Township, Illinois).

Baptism — January 1841: FamilySearch profile KWV3-MW9, Ordinances tab — Baptism and Confirmation completed 1 January 1841 (year-date; exact January date is a standard placeholder). Church History Biographical Database confirms 1841 membership.

Farm Sale to Emma Smith — 14–15 May 1841: Joseph Smith Papers, "Agreement with Ebenezer and Elender Moore Wiggins, 14 May 1841," josephsmithpapers.org. "Deed, Ebenezer and Elender Moore Wiggins to Emma Smith, 15 May 1841," Hancock County Deeds, recorded 30 June 1841, Book I, pp. 329–330, entry #4255. Consideration $2,700; partial payment $1,100 ($100 goods + $1,000 Nauvoo town property); balance $1,600 in three annual notes of $533.33. Witness R. B. Thompson; acknowledged before Ebenezer Robinson, Justice of the Peace. Eleanor signed with mark (X). Also confirmed: Nauvoo and Surrounding Communities Property Transactions Database, BYU.

Nauvoo Town Lot Sale — August–September 1842: Nauvoo and Surrounding Communities Property Transactions Database, BYU. Transaction 30 August 1842: Ebenezer F. Wiggins to Church Trustee, Lot #3, Block #125, Nauvoo Plat, consideration $800. Transaction 17 September 1842: receipt — received cash and bank notes $31.00, silver $119.00, one wagon and span of horses and harness $225.00, one note took up $5.00.

Proxy Baptism for Jonas Wiggins — 21 July 1844: Susan Easton Black and Harvey Bischoff Black, *Annotated Record of Baptisms for the Dead, 1840–1845: Nauvoo, Hancock County, Illinois*, 7 vols. (Provo, UT: BYU Center for Family History and Genealogy, 2002), 6:3794. Source record: Nauvoo Baptismal Records of the Dead, Book D80. Proxy: Ebenezer F. Wiggins. Deceased: Jonas Wiggins, died 23 July 1832, near Bremen, Muhlenberg, Kentucky. Officiators: Ezra Parrish and Hans Christian. Digital copy in FamilySearch Memories, profile KWV3-MW9.

Iowa Staging — 1846–1852: U.S. Census Bureau, 1850 Federal Population Census, Pottawattamie County, Iowa, District No. 21, p. 131 (back), household 1065/1065, "Ebinezer Wiggins" — wife Elender and children Mary, Sarah, William, Elender, Eliza, Rebecca, Cathern. All seven children confirmed born in Hancock County, Illinois. Catherine's birthplace confirmed: Lewis Dunbar Wilson Jr. family history, yanceyfamilygenealogy.org — "born in LaHarpe, Hancock County, Illinois, April 13, 1845."

Henry W. Miller Company — 8 July 1852: Church History Biographical Database, "Henry W. Miller Company (1852)," history.churchofjesuschrist.org. Departed Kanesville, Iowa, 8 July 1852; approximately 229 individuals and 63 wagons; 20th and final company of the 1852 season. Ebenezer Fairchild Wiggins (age 46) listed with Eleanor Moore (42) and seven children. Sources: "20th Company," *Deseret News*, 18 September 1852, p. 2; Presiding Bishopric immigrant location committee minutes, 20 September 1852.

Valley Arrival — 10 September 1852: Church History Biographical Database, Henry W. Miller Company — members arrived Salt Lake Valley 10 September – 2 October 1852. CHDB entry for Ebenezer Fairchild Wiggins gives arrival 10 September 1852.

Temple Endowment — 6 November 1852: FamilySearch profile KWV3-MW9, Ordinances tab — Initiatory and Endowment completed 6 November 1852.

Death of Ebenezer — 5 December 1858: FamilySearch profile KWV3-MW9. Confirmed by Church History Biographical Database and Black and Black, *Annotated Record of Baptisms for the Dead*, 6:3794.

Catherine Wiggins Marriage to Lewis Dunbar Wilson Jr. — 31 December 1862: Lewis Dunbar Wilson Jr. family history, yanceyfamilygenealogy.org/ldwjrhist.htm. Marriage 31 December 1862, Ogden, Utah. Lewis Dunbar Wilson Jr. (FamilySearch KWDM-FSM), son of Lewis Dunbar Wilson Sr. (KWV9-C9X) and Nancy Ann Waggoner (KWV9-C96). Lewis Jr. crossed the plains at age twelve with the Daniel A. Miller / John W. Cooley Company, 1853.

Family Line — Wiggins to Wilson to Bingham: FamilySearch lineage: Ebenezer Fairchild Wiggins [KWV3-MW9] → Catherine Wiggins [KWZJ-KSN] → (married Lewis Dunbar Wilson Jr. [KWDM-FSM]) → Catharine Rozella Wilson [KWCF-5K5] → Brigham Albert Bingham [KWC7-BZN] → Don Robert Bingham [KWCN-VKW] → Carol Hendricks [KWZG-9WC].

Story 4 of 12

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Witnesses of Nauvoo, Builders of Ogden

Edward Farley Jr. and Mary Ann Moore

— ✦ —

Virginia and Illinois • Commerce to the Great Salt Lake Valley • 1821–1884

Baptized: 7 May 1847

Pilot Grove, Hancock County, Illinois



Edward Farley Jr. and Mary Ann Moore

Virginia and Illinois • Commerce to the Great Salt Lake Valley • 1821–1884

The World of Commerce, Hancock County, Illinois

Edward Farley Jr. came from a line that understood land — how to find it on a frontier, how to work it, and how to hold it. Born on **12 November 1797** in Monroe County, Virginia, to Edward Farley Sr. and Lettice McMullen, he grew up in the Greenbrier Valley of western Virginia, where families like his had been carving farms out of the mountain terrain for generations. His father was a frontiersman who understood that opportunity lay west. When Edward Jr. married **Mary Ann Moore** on **20 October 1821** in White County, Illinois — Mary Ann was seventeen, the daughter of Moses Moore and Priscilla Miller of North Carolina, a young woman trained in all the domestic arts and known throughout her life for gracious Southern hospitality — the newlyweds joined Edward's father farming in the Fox River bottom of central Illinois. They were already on the frontier.

Within a few years, Edward's instinct for land pushed the family further north and west. Family tradition records that Edward and his associates purchased large tracts in the remote Mississippi River settlement of Commerce, in the far northwest corner of Hancock County — arriving approximately ten years before the first Latter-day Saint ever saw the place. Federal land patents confirm the story. A White County patent in **1827** documents Edward's earliest Illinois landholdings. By **1838**, he held federal title to parcels in Township 7 North along the river bend that would soon become famous. By **1841**, four federal patents totaling nearly 400 acres in Appanoose Township stood in his name or jointly with local associates. Commerce was a small, swampy settlement on a horseshoe bend of the Mississippi, its potential unproven, its future unguessed. Edward Farley had staked his family's fortunes on it early.

The City That Rose Around Them

In the spring of 1839, everything changed. Suddenly, thousands of destitute, exhausted refugees — men, women, and children expelled by state-sponsored violence from Caldwell County, Missouri — began crossing the Mississippi River directly into Hancock County. The local citizens watched as a battered religious community purchased the swampy Commerce settlement, renamed it Nauvoo, and began raising a city out of the river bottom with extraordinary speed and determination. Within two years Nauvoo had grown to rival Chicago as the largest city in Illinois. The Farley farmland was not distant from this development — it was in the middle of it.

For Edward and Mary Ann and their children, the eight years between 1839 and 1847 constituted an extended, intimate witness to one of the most dramatic episodes in American religious history. Winthrop Farley — their son, born at Commerce on **15 January 1831** — had grown up on this land before anyone called it Nauvoo. The family watched the Nauvoo Temple rise stone by stone along the bluffs above the river. They were present in Hancock County on **27 June 1844** when Joseph and Hyrum Smith were murdered at Carthage Jail — just miles from their farm. They watched as mobs burned barns and threatened outlying families through 1845 and into 1846. And in the early weeks of **February 1846**, in temperatures cold enough to freeze the Mississippi solid, they stood on the east bank and watched a community of twelve thousand people abandon a finished temple and cross the ice into Iowa.

> Edward and Mary Ann Farley did not join the exodus. They remained in Hancock County as the Saints departed — witnesses to the whole arc of Nauvoo, from the first wagons of Missouri refugees in 1839 to the last wagons crossing the ice in 1846.

After the exodus, the Farley family relocated to the Pilot Grove area of Hancock County, east of the abandoned city, joining a scattering of Latter-day Saints who had remained behind to settle their affairs or gather the means to follow. It was in this post-exodus environment — not at the height of Nauvoo's power, but in its long, quiet aftermath — that the conversion finally came.

The Gathering

Despite the fierce anti-Mormon sentiment that had characterized Hancock County through the 1840s, Edward and Mary Ann, along with their son Isaac, were baptized on **7 May 1847**. The precise circumstances — which elder, which waters — await further research in the Pilot Grove branch records held at the FamilySearch Library. What the record confirms is the timing. Within a year of their baptism, Edward and Mary Ann had crossed Iowa and joined the waiting encampment of Saints preparing for the final passage west. By **30 March 1848**, they were at the East Bank of the Missouri River receiving Patriarchal Blessings from Patriarch Isaac Morley — a blessing that could only be given to a confirmed member in good standing. The covenant that had waited eight years to be made was sealed.

The Iowa years — 1848 through 1850 — were years of preparation. Provisions had to be accumulated. Livestock had to be gathered. The substantial Farley landholdings in Nauvoo had to be settled and sold. In **January 1850**, Edward sold the family's Commerce and Nauvoo properties — the accumulation of twenty years of careful acquisition on the Illinois frontier — and turned their resources toward the crossing. When the family finally departed, they went well-equipped. Granddaughter Madeleine

Harrop recorded that the Farley party assembled seventeen wagons of provisions and three hundred head of cattle. They were not poor emigrants.

The Crossing

On **21 May 1850**, the Farley family party — Edward at 52, Mary Ann at 46, their children and married grandchildren and in-laws, their families and farmhands — set out from Illinois. Among the company was their son Winthrop, who had married Angelina Calkins at the home of Squire Taylor on the evening of **20 May** — the night before the trek began. He was nineteen. She was thirty-three. Angelina was a schoolteacher from New York who had joined the Church in **1849** and been baptized in the English River by Brother Roberts. She carried a diary. What she wrote in it became the most vivid primary source for the Farley family's crossing of the plains.

The family joined the **William Snow/Joseph Young Company** at Kanesville, Iowa, on **21 June 1850**. The company crossed with 136 wagons and nearly 500 participants under co-captains William Snow and Joseph Young. The early weeks were defined by death. Cholera moved through the camps with terrifying speed. By the time the company reached Fort Kearney in early July, they had passed 53 graves along the trail.

On **7 July 1850**, Captain William Snow recorded in his journal a Sunday gathering on the bank of the Platte River. Snow baptized several members of the company that day — some for their health, others in renewal of their covenants — and in the evening, he wrote, he "baptised Br. [Edward] Farley [Jr.]" The Platte River, not a branch house or a baptismal font, was the waters of Edward Farley's renewal. He was fifty-two years old.

> Captain William Snow baptized Edward Farley Jr. on the bank of the Platte River on 7 July 1850. He was fifty-two years old. It was the seventh week of the crossing.

Angelina's diary — written in real time, without the smoothing of memory — recorded the frictions and affections of a large family moving across a continent together. At Fort Kearney, Winthrop traded his watch for three cows, a calf-yoke staple, a chain, and fifteen dollars in cash. Mary Ann traded her two-year-old heifer for a cow to put in the team. Orson Hyde passed them on his way to the valley. Six deaths had occurred within their own camp by the end of June. The family had passed, by Angelina's careful count, 155 graves along the trail by late July.

The Farley group — traveling with nine wagons as a sub-unit of the larger company — separated from the main body for several weeks through a conflict among the teamsters. Captain Snow noted in his journal on **13 August 1850**, near Fort Laramie, that he "came up with Br. Grant and Farley that had left us at Salt Creek with nine waggons."

Father and son had held their own party together across the open plains for weeks before rejoining Snow's train.

Near Fort Laramie, Mary Ann spoke of stopping to rest. Angelina, who had started the journey with the fixed intention of reaching the valley and would not be moved from it, recorded that the whole train felt "Mother has too much say so about every thing." Bail[e]y, the teamster who attempted to confront her, "got very angry but did not say much because it was to a woman." Mary Ann Farley pushed on.

On **17 August**, Edward and Winthrop swam the Weber River together to bring in the horses before an expected Indian raid. On **22 August**, Edward hurt his foot on the trail and had to lay by for a day while the other trains passed them. In late August, near the last crossing of the Platte, Angelina was awakened by their dog's furious barking in the night. "Mr. F[arley]," she wrote, "looked out and saw an animal about the size of a yearling calf." He loosed the dogs. They concluded it may have been a bear. The cattle were safe.

On **22 September 1850**, Winthrop and Angelina's portion of the family came through the north part of Salt Lake City and camped on the west side. Angelina wrote: "Teams, men and women completely worn down. I have scarcely life enough to rejoice that I am so near my journey's end." Edward and Mary Ann, traveling with the main body of Snow's company, arrived in the Salt Lake Valley between **1 and 4 October 1850**. The crossing had taken them one hundred days from the Missouri River.

Settlement and Legacy in Ogden

The family moved north from Salt Lake City to Weber County, joining the community taking shape around what would become Ogden. They were among the early settlers of a settlement anchored by Bishop Erastus Bingham of the North Ward — the same Bishop Bingham whose farm land and personal stewardship gave Bingham's Fort its name when it was established in **August 1851** as the fortified settlement for incoming pioneer families. Three years later, the Aldous family — newly arrived from Fenstanton, England, following their own ocean crossing and years in St. Louis — would settle at that same fort and take up the work of building Weber County alongside the families already there.

By **1852**, Edward was recorded in the Ogden City Ward as a head of household and recognized as a pillar of the community. On **22 August 1854**, both Edward and Mary Ann traveled together to Salt Lake City to receive Patriarchal Blessings from Patriarch Isaac Morley — the same man who had blessed them at the East Bank of the Missouri River six years before. Edward's blessing was recorded in Volume 15, Page 22, No. 15. Mary Ann's was No. 17, on the same page, given the same day. On **20 May 1855**,

Edward was ordained a High Priest in Ogden by David Pettegrew and Philip Garner, his ordination recorded in High Priest Book P, page 11.

In Ogden, Edward's knowledge of horses and his skill with his hands made him sought after from the first day. He made shoes for the early pioneer community. His son Winthrop established a blacksmith shop on 24th Street and Adams Avenue in 1850, making wagons, carriages, the first zinc and tin washboards in Utah Territory, and eventually the first threshing machine ever used in the territory — operating it himself before selling it and moving his shop to Main Street with steam power added.

Mary Ann's contribution to pioneer Ogden was equally tangible. She converted wool into yarn and bats for making stockings and quilts, produced her own dyes for various uses, and was proficient in making soap, charcoal, tallow candles, butter, and cheese. She taught others these arts. The granddaughter who recorded her history described her as "a genius in all kinds of home industry" — a woman whose training in the domestic arts of a North Carolina household translated directly into the skills the frontier most needed.

> Mary Ann Moore Farley converted wool into yarn, made her own dyes, soap, charcoal, tallow candles, butter, and cheese, and taught these arts to her neighbors. The woman the teamsters said had "too much say so about everything" was exactly who Ogden needed.

Edward Farley Jr. died on **24 August 1867** in Ogden, Weber County, Utah Territory, at the age of sixty-nine. He had lived long enough to see the frontier settlement he had helped build become a permanent city. He was buried at the Ogden City Cemetery.

Mary Ann Moore Farley outlived her husband by seventeen years, continuing in Ogden among her children and grandchildren. She died on **15 October 1884** in Ogden at the age of eighty-one, and was buried beside Edward at the Ogden City Cemetery. She had arrived in the valley in the autumn of 1850 at the age of forty-six. She had thirty-four more years in Utah. She used all of them.

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A Note on Winthrope and Angelina Calkins Farley

Winthrop Farley was born on **15 January 1831** at Commerce, Hancock County, Illinois — on the same land his father had been farming for two years. He grew up in the household that witnessed the rise and fall of Nauvoo, and he crossed the plains at nineteen the same day he married Angelina Calkins, making of the emigration and the covenant a single act.

In Ogden, Winthrop became one of the community's foundational craftsmen. His blacksmith and machine shop on 24th Street and Adams Avenue, established in 1850, specialized in zinc and tin washboards — the first of their kind in Utah — alongside wagons, carriages, threshing machines, and general tools. He built himself a violin entirely by hand. He moved his main shop to Main Street between 3rd and 4th Streets in 1878 and added steam power. He was known for guaranteeing his work.

Angelina Calkins Farley is the narrator of the family's crossing. Her diary — written daily from the Missouri crossing in June 1850 through the arrival in the Salt Lake Valley on 22 September — is the primary source for the trek narrative in this document. A schoolteacher from New York, she was thirty-three years old when she married Winthrop the night before the journey began and wrote with the precision of an educated observer. Her nineteen pages of daily entries capture the cholera graves, the buffalo herds, the family separations, the exhausted cattle, and the moment she arrived in the valley with "scarcely life enough to rejoice." Angelina Calkins Farley was the family's witness to a crossing that her mother-in-law survived and her husband barely noticed.

Winthrop Farley died on **18 September 1892** in Ogden and was buried at the Ogden City Cemetery. Angelina Calkins Farley died on **21 January 1900** in Ogden and was buried there as well.

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A Note on the Polly Boone Question

The FamilySearch profile for Edward Farley Jr. (KWVH-XRH) carries a spousal relationship to a woman listed as "Polly Boone" (FamilySearch ID L2CC-49T), with a marriage date of 1850, added via GEDCOM import in **January 2016**. This relationship is unsupported by any primary documentation. The "Polly Boone" profile contains zero sources, zero memories, and zero notes. The reason field for the relationship states only "MyTrees GEDCOM Match against FamilySearch."

The origin of this confusion is the common use of "Polly" as a nickname for "Mary" — one of the most widespread naming conventions in nineteenth-century American households. Angelina Calkins Farley's 1850 trail diary, the primary source for the crossing, refers throughout to "Mother Farley" and in several entries to "Polly" in contexts that clearly indicate the same person. Mary Ann Moore Farley was called Polly throughout her life. A researcher encountering this nickname in a secondary source without context created a separate individual and attached that person to Edward's profile.

A research note documenting this error has been posted to the Collaborate tabs of both Edward's profile and the Polly Boone profile. Researchers should treat the Polly Boone relationship as a documented GEDCOM error and rely on primary source documentation identifying Mary Ann Moore as Edward's sole spouse.

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Source Citations

Edward Farley Jr. — Vital Records: FamilySearch profile KWVH-XRH, familysearch.org/en/tree/person/details/KWVH-XRH. Born 12 November 1797, Monroe County, Virginia; died 24 August 1867, Ogden, Weber County, Utah Territory, age 69. Burial: Ogden City Cemetery. Church History Biographical Database, RID PER-2GJ8TRM, history.churchofjesuschrist.org.

Mary Ann Moore — Vital Records: FamilySearch profile KWVH-XR4, familysearch.org/en/tree/person/details/KWVH-XR4. Born 9 October 1803, North Carolina; died 15 October 1884, Ogden, Weber County, Utah, age 81. Burial: Ogden City Cemetery. Parents: Moses Moore and Priscilla Miller, confirmed in Early Church Information File (ECIF), Film 1750675, Image 9726, Patriarchal Blessing card.

Marriage — 20 October 1821: Illinois, County Marriages, 1810–1934, White County; "Edward Farley" and "Mary More," 20 October 1821. FamilySearch ark:/61903/1:1:KF2L-K46. Note: DUP family history by Diane Stokoe gives location as Greenbrier, Virginia; Illinois county marriage record accepted as primary source for location.

Settlement in Commerce, Illinois — circa 1829: LoRene Whitney, Edward Farley and Mary Ann Moore Family History (2002), FamilySearch Memories, KWVH-XRH: "Edward and his brothers bought large tracts of land in Commerce, Illinois and settled there ten years before the first Mormon saints arrived." Corroborated by Diane Stokoe, DUP biography, FamilySearch Memories, KWVH-XRH.

Federal Land Patents — Illinois: Bureau of Land Management, General Land Office Records, glorecords.blm.gov. Five patents: (1) CV-0096-211, White County, 76.61 acres, 15 October 1827, with John Stephens; (2) IL0700_.362, Hancock County, 68.94 acres, 6 August 1838, with Augustin Horton; (3) IL3890_.235, Hancock County, 80.00 acres, 10 October 1840; (4) IL3880_.309, Hancock County, 160.50 acres, 10 October 1840, with William Robinson; (5) IL4130_.183, Hancock County, 80.00 acres, 25 May 1841. Total Hancock County acreage approximately 389 acres. All Hancock County parcels in Appanoose Township (T7R8–9), consistent with the Farley, Edward Nauvoo Property map in FamilySearch Memories, KWVH-XRH.

Baptism — 7 May 1847: LoRene Whitney family history (2002) and Diane Stokoe, DUP biography, both in FamilySearch Memories, KWVH-XRH: baptism of Edward, Mary Ann, and son Isaac, 7 May 1847. Corroborated by ECIF Patriarchal Blessing card (Film 1750675, Image 9509) proving membership before 30 March 1848. Branch record primary source not yet located; FamilySearch Library visit required (Black/Black, Call # 977 K2b).

Patriarchal Blessings — 30 March 1848 and 22 August 1854: Early Church Information File (ECIF), Film 1750675, Images 9508–9509 (Edward) and 9725–9726 (Mary Ann), Church History Biographical Database. Edward's 1848 blessing: Vol. 14, Page 43, No. 54, Isaac Morley, East Bank of Missouri River. Edward's 1854 blessing: Vol. 15, Page 22, No. 15, Isaac Morley, Salt Lake City. Mary Ann's 1854 blessing: Vol. 15, Page 22, No. 17, same date and patriarch.

Rebaptism on the Platte — 7 July 1850: William Snow journal, 1832–1833 and 1850, Pages 3–8, Church History Biographical Database: "Evening baptised Br. [Edward] Farley [Jr.]." Transcript: history.churchofjesuschrist.org/chd/transcript?name=transcript-for-william-snow-journal-1832-1833-and-1850-3-8. Note: this was a renewal of covenant during emigration, a common practice; original conversion baptism occurred 7 May 1847 per family history sources.

Pioneer Trek — William Snow/Joseph Young Company: Church History Biographical Database, William Snow/Joseph Young Company (1850), history.churchofjesuschrist.org. Formed Council Bluffs, Iowa, 21 June 1850; ended Salt Lake City 1–4 October 1850; 486 participants; co-captains Joseph Young and William Snow. Edward Farley Jr. confirmed on roster (RID PER-2GJ8TRM). Winthrop and Angelina's group arrived 22 September 1850.

Trek Narrative — Angelina C. Farley Diaries: Angelina C. Farley diaries, 1847–1888, Page 32, Church History Biographical Database. Transcript: history.churchofjesuschrist.org/chd/transcript?name=transcript-for-angelina-c-farley-diaries-1847-1888-32. Primary source for daily trail conditions, the Farley group's separation from the main company, Mary Ann's character, and the September 22, 1850 arrival. Also quoted in LoRene Whitney family history (2002), FamilySearch Memories, KWVH-XRH.

Sale of Nauvoo Holdings — January 1850: Diane Stokoe, DUP biography, FamilySearch Memories, KWVH-XRH: "The family sold their Nauvoo holdings in January of 1850 and began preparing for their journey to the valley."

Seventeen Wagons and Three Hundred Cattle: Madeleine Harrop granddaughter account, cited in LoRene Whitney family history (2002) and Diane Stokoe, DUP biography, both in FamilySearch Memories, KWVH-XRH.

Ogden Settlement — Bishops' Report and High Priest Ordination: Early Church Information File (ECIF), Film 1750675, Images 9505 and 9507. 1852 Bishops' Report: Edward Farley in Ogden City Ward, head of household. High Priest ordination: 20 May 1855, Ogden, by David Pettegrew and Philip Garner, High Priest Book P, page 11.

Mary Ann's Pioneer Skills: LoRene Whitney family history (2002) and Madeleine Harrop account, FamilySearch Memories, KWVH-XRH. Also quoted in Winthrope and Angelina Calkins Farley family history, compiled by Adleen Farley Knight (granddaughter), FamilySearch Memories, KWVH-XRH.

Bingham's Fort Cross-Reference: "History of Bingham's Fort," Chapter 7 (Andrew Jenson), Erastus Bingham Sr. Memories Collection (KWJ4-KJ3), FamilySearch: "The fort was given the name of Bingham's Fort in honor of the Bishop Erastus Bingham of the North Ward." Fort established August 1851. See also Robert and Mary Ann Aldous family history (this series) for the Aldous family's settlement at Bingham's Fort, 1854.

BYU Nauvoo Community Project: nauvoo.byu.edu/p/Person/99740/Edward-Farley. Research log downloaded and attached to FamilySearch Memories, KWVH-XRH.

Winthrope Farley — Vital Records and Blacksmith Shop: FamilySearch profile KWJH-1KT. Born 15 January 1831, Commerce, Hancock County, Illinois; died 18 September 1892, Ogden; buried Ogden City Cemetery. Blacksmith shop details: Winthrope and Angelina Calkins Farley family history, compiled by Adleen Farley Knight, FamilySearch Memories, KWVH-XRH.

Angelina Calkins Farley — Vital Records: FamilySearch Memories, KWVH-XRH. Born 4 May 1817; died 21 January 1900, Ogden; buried Ogden City Cemetery. Baptized 9 March 1848, English River, by Brother Roberts (Winthrope and Angelina Calkins Farley family history, FamilySearch Memories). Married Winthrop Farley 20 May 1850, Squire Taylor's, Kanesville, Iowa.

Polly Boone — Disputed Relationship: FamilySearch change log, KWVH-XRH: "Polly Boone" (L2CC-49T) added 19 January 2016 by RuthAdkinson via GEDCOM import, marriage date 1850. Profile carries zero sources, zero memories, zero notes; reason field states "MyTrees GEDCOM Match against FamilySearch." Angelina C. Farley diary (1850) references "Polly" throughout the trail in contexts identifying the same person as "Mother Farley," confirming Polly as Mary Ann Moore's common nickname. Research note posted to Collaborate tabs of both profiles.

Story 5 of 12

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The Shoemaker, the Seamer, and the Seven-Year Separation

John and Jane Hastings

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Countesthorpe, Leicestershire • England to Ogden, Utah • 1848–1900

Baptized: 8 April 1849 (Jane)

Countesthorpe, Leicestershire, England



The Shoemaker, the Seamer, and the Seven-Year Separation

John and Jane Hastings

Countesthorpe, Leicestershire • England to Ogden, Utah • 1848–1900

The village of Countesthorpe sat in the flat, clay-bottomed country of Leicestershire, a few miles south of the city of Leicester, where the land spread into broad hedgerowed fields worked by tenant farmers and smallholders who had been there for generations. The local economy in the 1830s and 1840s ran on two trades: framework knitting and shoemaking. Stocking frames rattled in cottage rooms across the village, turning out the hosiery goods that supplied the midland textile markets, and the smell of tanned leather drifted from the cobbling workshops throughout the working day. There was little wealth on Little End Street. There was piece-rate labor, close neighbors, and a social order shaped by reputation and the established Church of England — a form of local security that could prove fragile if a man's good name came into question.

John Hastings had been born in Wistow, Leicestershire, in **1810**, the son of Robert Hastings and Sarah Spencer — parents he would lose before he was thirty. His mother died in 1831; his father in 1836, the very year John married **Abigail Gillam** on **8 August 1836** in Countesthorpe. He worked as a cordwainer — a skilled shoemaker — and the two of them built a household in the working-class life the village offered. Their son Robert was christened on **24 May 1837**, and a second son, William, on **24 March 1839**. Five months after William's birth, on **18 August 1839**, Abigail died. John was thirty years old, a widower with an infant and a two-year-old.

He did not face that alone. The 1841 census shows Abigail's parents — Brain and Sarah Gillam, together with her younger siblings — living alongside John and the two small children on Little End Street. The Gillam family had stepped into the gap. It was a household still shaped by loss, held together by the memory of the woman who had gone.

Four years later, John married **Jane Burdett** on **11 October 1843** in Countesthorpe. Jane had been born on **8 December 1818** in the nearby village of Sapcote, the daughter of **Thomas Burdett** and **Elizabeth Shenton**, one of at least ten children raised in the Burdett household. She was twenty-four. He was thirty-three. She entered a household still carrying the weight of Abigail's memory — two stepsons, their Gillam grandparents still present in the community, and the close-watching eyes of a village street where nothing stayed private for long.

A Shoemaker and a Seamer

By the time of the **1851 census**, the cottage on Little End Street had settled into the rhythm of a working household. John, now forty, continued his trade as a cordwainer. Jane, thirty-two, was listed as a seamer in the hosiery industry — stitching together the finished stockings that the framework knitters of Leicestershire produced for distribution across England. Their own children — Mary Elizabeth (7), John Jr. (5), and baby Ann (1) — shared the cottage with John's older son Robert Hastings (15) and with members of the extended Gillam family. Both cordwaining and seaming were cottage industries, typically performed at home or in small local workshops, and both ran on the piece-rate economy of the Leicestershire trades. The household was crowded, the work constant, and the daily life of husband and wife conducted in close quarters.

A Household Converted

What John could not have anticipated, when he married into the Burdett family in 1843, was that within three years its members would begin turning, one after another, toward a new and unfamiliar faith. The movement began with Jane's older brother **Thomas Burdett**, baptized into the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints on **15 March 1846**. Two months later, on **15 May 1846**, Jane's mother, **Elizabeth Shenton**, followed her son into the water. Jane herself had not yet heard the gospel preached in her own home. But by the spring of 1846, it had already taken root two doors down, in the household of her birth.

The Split Hearth

In the fall of **1848**, Latter-day Saint elders brought the gospel to the Hastings household on Little End Street. The timing was painful. Their son **Thomas**, born in August 1847, was gravely ill. He died in **December 1848** at approximately sixteen months old. Jane buried her toddler in the Countesthorpe churchyard as the year closed.

> *She was baptized at Easter, 1849, walking eight miles through the mud.*
> *— Jane's published obituary, Ogden, December 1900*

On **Easter Sunday, 1849** — most likely **8 April** — Jane Burdett Hastings walked eight miles through the mud to be baptized into the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints. She was not the first in her family to make that choice. Her brother Thomas had been baptized three years earlier; her mother, two years before that. John Hastings stayed home at his cobbler's bench.

She was not entering a large or prosperous congregation. The October 1848 quarterly report of the Leicester Conference, published in the *Millennial Star* of **1 December 1848**, showed a church of only **166 members across four branches**. That same quarter, while eight people were baptized, fifteen were cut off — excommunicated. The group Jane had joined was shrinking under strict internal discipline even as it tried to

grow, and in a village the size of Countesthorpe, membership in it was common knowledge. To be a Latter-day Saint on Little End Street was to become a subject of conversation.

The conversion did not stop with Jane. On **14 July 1851**, her father **Thomas Burdett** was baptized — the third member of the household to join, and a deeper signal still that the faith taking root in the Burdett family was no passing curiosity. By the time John finally relented in 1853, he would not only be resisting his wife. He would be the last holdout against a household that had converted root and branch seven years before.

The man who kept that community alive in Blaby and its surrounding villages was **James Mellor**, a local laborer who presided over the Blaby Branch. Blaby was just over a mile from Countesthorpe. The branch operated not from a chapel but as a circuit of four or five scattered village groups meeting in cottage front rooms, and Mellor walked nearly thirty miles every Sunday to reach them all — sometimes accompanied by his eldest daughter, Louisa. He did this through the same economic depression that threatened every shoemaker and seamer in Leicestershire. The **1847 depression** had driven him from the local trades entirely; he had left his family and taken work on the Yorkshire railways, surviving a near-fatal accident when a chain snapped on a hoist and brought it down on him. When he returned to Leicester, he was imprisoned.

> *"I was taken and confined in prison for six weeks for no crime, only being poor and out of work." — James Mellor, Brief Sketch from His Life*

He also knew exactly what social world Jane and her family were navigating. In his own Brief Sketch, Mellor described his experience of conversion in Leicester: "I thought my friends would receive the gospel. It was so plain and scriptural. I soon found out the contrary. They opposed me and looked at me as if it was something to be shunned." He had walked through that hostility himself before he ever walked into Countesthorpe.

John watched all of this from his workbench. Every Sunday, his wife walked out of the village toward Blaby — to join a congregation that, by 1851, already included her father and her brother. He knew who led those meetings and what kind of man he was. He continued to make shoes for four and a half years.

By the early 1850s, Mellor had moved from the Blaby presidency to preside over the larger Leicester Branch. His final months in England were marked by camp meetings in the Leicester market square, tracts distributed to every surrounding village, and a deliberate urgency: he was preparing to leave England and meant to "leave all both priest and people of all denominations without excuse." He had just successfully converted his own older brother John Mellor, bringing his entire family into the Church.

The pressure on John was not coming from one direction only. On **13 November 1853**, Jane's brother **Richard Burdett** was baptized — the fourth member of the

Burdett family to join. One week later, on **20 November 1853**, **John Hastings** was himself baptized and confirmed by **Elder James Mellor**. Whatever finally moved him, it happened in the same fortnight his brother-in-law made the same choice. By the time John stepped into the water, he was the last adult member of his immediate household — and very nearly the last in his wife's entire family — still standing outside the faith.

The Price of Passage (1854–1861)

The conversion marked the beginning of a new phase in the family's life. Within a year, John had committed to the gathering — the Church's call for its members to leave their homelands and build Zion in the Rocky Mountains. The plan they settled on was the only one they could afford: John would go first, find work in America, and save enough to send for the family. It would take as long as it took.

On **27 November 1854**, John boarded the ship *Clara Wheeler* at Liverpool. He arrived in **New Orleans on 12 January 1855** and traveled north along the Mississippi River toward the Missouri frontier, carrying his cordwaining tools and whatever savings he had managed to set aside in the year since his baptism. He would not see his family again for nearly seven years.

Back on Little End Street, Jane managed. The stepsons were no longer boys — James was in his mid-twenties and Robert approaching adulthood — but the household they provided was limited. By **1857**, Robert had made his own choice plain: he married Elizabeth Dunkley at **St. Margaret's Anglican Church** in Leicester, moved to Leaden Hall Street in the city, and began his own household under the flag of the Church of England. When Robert walked down the aisle at St. Margaret's, his father was working a shoemaker's bench somewhere along the Missouri River, unable to attend his own son's wedding.

Jane had four children of her own to raise. She had worked as a seamer before and could do so again. By the late 1850s, her parents and three of her siblings shared her faith, even if not all of them shared her resolve to cross an ocean. Family reminiscences later emphasized the long separation from John and suggest that for extended periods Jane had little or no word from him. The Life Story preserved by her grandchildren notes only that he was "working at his shoemaker's trade and saving his money."

Then came January 1859.

> *Their daughter Eliza, born 6 May 1851, died on 4 January 1859 in Leicester at the age of seven. John was still in America, and Jane faced the burial without him.*

Eliza was their third child to die. Thomas had died in **December 1848** — before John had joined the Church, before any of the separations had begun. Now Eliza in **January**

1859, while John was gone. Jane had buried two of her children without her husband. The four who remained — Mary Elizabeth (15), John Jr. (13), Ann (9), and Emma (5) — were what the years had left her.

Early in **1861**, a letter arrived from America. John had enough. Come now.

The Wartime Crossing (1861)

Jane and the four children appeared in the **April 1861** British Census — still in Countesthorpe. Within days of that count, they were packing. They left their home in England on **10 April 1861**. They walked away from Little End Street and did not return.

The ship was the *Manchester*, a packet vessel departing Liverpool under the presidency of **Elder Claudius V. Spencer** and the command of Captain Trask. There were **379 Latter-day Saints** aboard. The crossing took **twenty-eight days**. The ship was organized as a floating ecclesiastical ward: passengers rose to a trumpet call at six every morning, assembled for prayer twice daily, and kept constant night watches. The decks were regularly cleaned and fumigated. Voyage summaries report that only two infants died during the crossing — unusually low mortality for an Atlantic passage of this era.

When the *Manchester* dropped anchor in **New York Harbor on 14 May 1861**, Jane and her children stepped onto American soil into a nation at war. **Fort Sumter** had fallen on **14 April 1861** — two days before they sailed from Liverpool. During the twenty-eight-day crossing, news from America had not kept pace with events. They arrived in New York to find the country newly at war and the city already marked by military activity. The family lodged in New York with a mission family named Stone before beginning the journey west.

John met them in **St. Joseph, Missouri** — the outfitting point for the overland crossing. He had been in America for six and a half years. **Emma**, who had been eight months old when he left Countesthorpe in November 1854, was seven years old when she first laid eyes on her father.

Family tradition places them with the **Joseph Horn Company**, traveling by ox-team and wagon, though primary-source confirmation of that assignment appears incomplete. Mary Elizabeth's later account records that the children walked most of the way across the plains. In the evenings, camped along the trail, there was music and dancing. They passed the encampment of **Johnson's Army** and were terrified, not knowing what to expect. Family reminiscences also recall several tense encounters with Native people along the route, though none resulted in physical harm.

On **14 September 1861**, the wagons rolled into **Ogden, Weber County, Utah Territory**. Their first home was an adobe house near 22nd and Wall Avenue, with

planks for doors and no locks on them. Family accounts remember Native visitors entering the house from time to time. The family was together at last.

Gathering to the Valley: Ogden

John continued to make fine shoes. He had been a cordwainer when he first worked Little End Street, a cordwainer when he worked the Missouri frontier, and he was a cordwainer still when he took up his bench in Ogden. The **1880 census** finds him listed simply as a *shoemaker* in the Third Ward of Ogden. He and Jane remained active in the Church throughout their Utah years.

On **4 March 1865**, John received his temple endowment at the **Endowment House** in Salt Lake City and was sealed to Jane on the same day. Sixteen years after her baptism in Leicestershire, the religious commitment that had once divided their household was solemnized in temple ordinances.

On **19 October 1870**, John returned to the Endowment House to be sealed by proxy to **Abigail Gillam** — the wife of his young manhood who had died in Countesthorpe thirty-one years before, leaving him a widower with two infant sons. Whatever the village of Countesthorpe had taken from him — Abigail at twenty-nine, the security of a tradesman's life, the ordinary English future he had been born into — he now held in covenant.

The **1870 census** finds John (62), Jane (55), and their youngest daughter **Emma** (17) living together in Ogden. Emma had been born in May 1853 — the same year John's conversion set the family's emigration plans in motion. She had crossed the Atlantic at age seven, walked most of the way across the plains, and grown up in the adobe house with no locks. In **June 1871**, at approximately eighteen years old, Emma died in Ogden. She had spent her early childhood separated from her father during his years in America, and she died before reaching old age.

John Hastings died on **5 November 1884** in Ogden, Weber County, Utah. The cause was dropsy. His funeral was held on **6 November** at the Third Ward Schoolhouse under the direction of Bishop Farr. The room was filled with mourners and friends of the deceased. Patriarch Lorin Farr testified of his great faithfulness and unswerving integrity, noting that he was ever ready to perform the duties that devolved upon him in the Church. John was seventy-four years old. He was buried at the **Ogden City Cemetery**.

Jane outlived her husband by sixteen years. Her family circle in Ogden had grown wider than the household she had left behind in Countesthorpe. Her brother **Thomas Burdett** had eventually made the same crossing she had, settling in Weber County and living until 1915. Her brother **Henry Burdett**, baptized decades later in 1881, also emigrated and died in Ogden in 1902, a neighbor to the family in their last years. Jane

watched her surviving children marry and establish themselves in the valley. Mary Elizabeth raised eleven children in Ogden. John Jr. married twice and lived until 1921. Ann — Elizabeth Ann, the little girl born in Countesthorpe in October 1849, just months after her mother's Easter baptism — married twice and lived until 1909, dying in Ogden and buried in the same cemetery as her parents.

Jane Burdett Hastings died on **7 December 1900** in Ogden, Weber County, Utah, one day before her eighty-second birthday. Her funeral was held at the Third Ward Meeting House on **9 December 1900**. The newspaper obituary described a woman who had "endured many hardships but was valiant and faithful through it all, teaching her family the Gospel of Jesus Christ." She was buried in Ogden and never returned to Leicestershire.

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A Note on James Mellor

James Mellor was born in Leicester in **1819**, the son of William Mellor — a man deafened by an industrial accident in which a fireball killed his entire team of horses — and Ann Dilks, whose severe eye inflammation left her nearly blind. Family accounts describe a household in which James's father's deafness and his mother's failing sight made written communication especially important. Those circumstances may help explain why he became such a diligent and detailed keeper of diaries — which is why so much of what happened in the Blaby Branch of the 1840s and 1850s can be recovered at all.

He was converted to the Church in Leicester and ordained to the local priesthood, presiding first over the Blaby Branch — the branch that Jane Hastings and her family attended — and later over the Leicester Branch. His own Brief Sketch records what those years cost him: a depression that drove him from the local trades to work the Yorkshire railway tunnels; a near-fatal accident when a chain snapped and a great hoist came down on him — when the shaft was raised, he jumped up uninjured, and the workmen shouted, "Oh you can't kill these darn Mormons!"; and a return to Leicester that ended in six weeks' imprisonment for the crime of being poor and out of work. He survived each of these and returned to his Sunday circuits in Blaby.

Before emigrating, Mellor converted his own older brother John and brought his family into the Church. He held camp meetings in the Leicester market square and distributed tracts through every surrounding village, determined to leave "both priest and people of all denominations without excuse." It was during this final campaign that he baptized

John Hastings on 20 November 1853, the same week his brother-in-law Richard Burdett was also baptized.

Mellor emigrated to America on the ship *Horizon* in **1856**. His wife, Mary Ann, had given birth — with grave difficulty — immediately before the sailing and was thought too ill to travel. Mellor returned to their home in the night, brought her by lorry to the Liverpool docks, and passed her through a ship's porthole into the passenger quarters. When the captain eventually discovered her, he observed simply: "Food for the sharks." Mary Ann's father, who was a good man though not a member of the Church, had wept at their departure and offered them money to stay in England. The gospel, Mellor wrote, meant more to them than anything else.

The *Horizon* carried the company that became the **Martin Handcart Company**. At Iowa City, Elder Savage warned the company that the season was dangerously late — that winter would overtake them before they could cross the mountains — and urged them to remain until spring. The company voted to press on. Savage replied: "Then I will go with you and pray God to help us." The Martin Handcart Company was caught by early blizzards in the Wyoming mountains and suffered catastrophic losses. James Mellor survived.

He settled in Fayette, Utah, and lived until **1903** — exactly fifty years after he had stood in a Leicestershire waterway and baptized a stubborn cordwainer on a November afternoon. His journals and autobiography are preserved at BYU Special Collections (MSS SC 1561) and the Church History Library. Portions are accessible through his FamilySearch Memories profile, **KWN7-G38**.

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A Note on Mary Goodman and the 1881 Endowment House Sealing

Mary Goodman (1813–1890) appears in John Hastings' FamilySearch ordinance record as having been sealed to him at the **Endowment House** on **14 July 1881**. Earlier drafts of this family's history assumed she was Jane Burdett's stepmother — the wife of Jane's widowed father. Subsequent research disproved this. Jane's actual father, Thomas Burdett (1797–1878), remained married to Jane's mother, Elizabeth Shenton, until her death in 1861, and he himself did not die until 1878 in Countesthorpe, having never emigrated. The Mary Goodman connected to this story instead married a different man of the same name — Thomas Burdett (about 1810–1865), Jane's father's first cousin — who died in Leicester, England, in 1865 and never emigrated either.

Mary Goodman was therefore not Jane's stepmother, but the widow of a Burdett cousin once removed. By the time of her 1881 sealing to John, she was a twice-widowed woman of about sixty-eight; John was approximately seventy-one. Neither the 1870 nor 1880 census places her in John's household, she never adopted the Hastings name, and the

couple had no children together. Her two actual husbands — John Cheney and Thomas Burdett — were sealed to her only by proxy after her death, in 1950 and 1972 respectively. The pattern is consistent with the documented early Utah practice of **eternity-only sealings**, in which a widowed member could be sealed to a living, worthy priesthood holder for eternal purposes only, without any expectation of earthly marriage. It is recorded here for completeness and transparency, not as evidence of a conventional plural marriage.

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Jane Burdett Hastings — Vital Records: FamilySearch profile LKVY-2YC. Born 8 December 1818, Countesthorpe (obituary) / Sapcote (census). Parents: Thomas Burdett (KWJW-Y8C) and Elizabeth Shenton (KWJW-Y8H). Died 7 December 1900, Ogden, Weber, Utah. Funeral 9 December 1900, Third Ward Meeting House.

The Burdett Family Conversion — Ordinance Records: FamilySearch Ordinances tabs, confirmed by primary-source ordinance index for each individual: Thomas Burdett II (KWJW-YSD), baptized 15 March 1846; Elizabeth Shenton (KWJW-Y8H), baptized 15 May 1846; Jane Burdett (LKVY-2YC), baptized Easter 1849 (Ordinances tab shows 22 March 1848, believed in error — see below); Thomas Burdett I (KWJW-Y8C), baptized 14 July 1851; Richard Burdett (K8PJ-XSM), baptized 13 November 1853; Mary Ann Burdett (KWJW-TYB), baptized 28 February 1855; Henry Burdett (K2W3-TYW), baptized 13 September 1881.

Baptism of Jane Burdett — Easter Sunday, April 1849: Three independent family documents: (1) History of Jane Burdett Hastings, FamilySearch Memories LKVY-2YC; (2) History of Mary Elizabeth (Lizzie) Hastings, compiled by Alena M. Welker, 1974, FamilySearch Memories KWJW-YSJ; (3) Grandma Jane Hastings Obituary, published Ogden, December 9, 1900 — 'Jane was baptized at Easter, 1849, walking eight miles through the mud.' FamilySearch Ordinances tab shows 22 March 1848 — believed to be a data error given unanimous family-document testimony. Film 87010 (DGS 8087198), Leicester Branch Record of Members, should be consulted to confirm date and officiating elder.

Baptism of John Hastings — 20 November 1853: FamilySearch Collaborate Notes, KWJW-YSJ: 'Was Baptized by James Mellor and confirmed the 20 Nov 1853 by James Mellor.' Parents confirmed as Robert Hastings and Sarah Spencer.

Thomas Burdett I (Jane's father) — Vital Records and Residence: FamilySearch profile KWJW-Y8C. Born 31 December 1797, Mowsley, Leicestershire. Died 27 December 1878, Countesthorpe, Leicestershire. Confirmed resident in England by 1841, 1851, 1861, and 1871 censuses — never emigrated. A Utah death certificate (Thomas Burdett, d. 3 April 1915, Ogden) attached to this profile under a 1915 source entry belongs instead to his son, Thomas Burdett II (KWJW-YSD) — a source-attachment error requiring correction.

Thomas Burdett II (Jane's brother) — Vital Records: FamilySearch profile KWJW-YSD. Born 28 March 1827, Countesthorpe. Died 3 April 1915, Marriott, Weber, Utah. Buried Ogden City Cemetery, Plot A-6-24-5W. Utah Death Certificate confirms parents Thomas Burdett and Elizabeth Chenton/Shenton.

Mary Goodman — Identity, Corrected: FamilySearch profile KWJW-YWM. Born 1813, Leicestershire. First married John Cheney (died 1838). Married Thomas Burdett (M6PB-QVC, Jane's father's first cousin, c.1810–1865) — not Jane's father — 2 August 1846, Leicestershire. This Thomas Burdett died 29 September 1865, Leicester, England (GRO Death Index) — never emigrated. 1851 and 1861 British censuses: Mary Burdett, wife of Thomas Burdett, in this household. Sealing to John Hastings: 14 July 1881, Endowment House (both living). Sealing to Thomas Burdett (posthumous proxy): 12 October 1972, Los Angeles California Temple. Sealing to John Cheney (posthumous proxy): 10 June 1950, Logan Utah Temple.

Pedigree Confirmation — Two Thomas Burdetts: FamilySearch pedigree chart: Richard Burdett and Hannah Robinson had two sons, Samuel Burdett (1760–1804) and Edward Burdett (1774–deceased). Samuel's son was Thomas Burdett I (KWJW-Y8C, 1797–1878), Jane's father. Edward's son was Thomas Burdett (M6PB-QVC, c.1810–1865), Mary Goodman's husband. The two Thomas Burdetts were first cousins.

1841 England Census: FamilySearch, Robert Hastings sources (KZWC-4FG). John Hastings (30), Robert (4), Gillam in-laws — Little End Street, Blaby Union, Leicestershire.

1851 England Census: FamilySearch ark:/61903/1:1:SGF7-92K. John (40, Cordwainer), Jane (32, Seamer), James Gillam (20), Robert (15), Mary (7), John (5), Ann (1) — Countesthorpe, Leicestershire.

Leicester Conference Report, October 1848: Millennial Star, Vol. 10, No. 23 (1 December 1848), p. 358. contentdm.lib.byu.edu/digital/collection/MStar. 4 branches, 166 members, 8 baptized, 15 cut off. President John Fidoe; Clerk John Clarke.

Robert Hastings — Anglican Marriage, 1857: St. Margaret's Parish Register, Leicester. FamilySearch ark:/61903/1:1:QP4W-81WR. Robert Hastings married Elizabeth Dunkley. Residence: Leaden Hall Street, Leicester.

Clara Wheeler emigration — John Hastings, 1854–1855: Saints by Sea / Mormon Migration Database. Departed Liverpool 27 November 1854; arrived New Orleans 12 January 1855.

Manchester emigration — Jane Hastings, 1861: Saints by Sea / Mormon Migration Database; New York Passenger Lists, FamilySearch LKVY-2YC sources. 'Jane and children Mary, John, Ann, and Emma migrating to USA in May 1861 on ship Manchester.' Company President

Claudius V. Spencer; Captain Trask. 379 LDS emigrants. Departed Liverpool approximately 10–16 April 1861; arrived New York approximately 14 May 1861.

History of Mary Elizabeth (Lizzie) Hastings: Compiled by Alena M. Welker, granddaughter, March 1974. FamilySearch Memories, KWJW-YSJ. Source for: gospel presented fall 1848; mother's Easter 1849 baptism; Thomas died about this time; left England 10 April 1861; ship Manchester; lodged with Stone family; joined Joseph Horn Company; John joined them in St. Joseph, Missouri; children walked most of the way; passed Johnson's Army encampment; Indian encounters; arrived Ogden 14 September 1861; first home adobe house near 22nd and Wall Avenue.

Joseph Horn Company — 1861 Trek: Utah Mormon Pioneer Overland Travel Database, 1847–1868, history.churchofjesuschrist.org. Jane Burdett Hastings listed for 1861. History of Jane Burdett Hastings: '13 September 1861 — Joseph Horn Company (ox-team and wagon).'

John Hastings Obituary: FamilySearch Memories, KWJW-YSJ. Funeral 6 November 1884, Third Ward Schoolhouse, Ogden. Speakers included Patriarch Lorin Farr. "The room was filled with mourners and friends of the deceased."

Grandma Jane Hastings Obituary: FamilySearch Memories, LKVY-2YC. Published approximately 9 December 1900. "Endured many hardships but was valiant and faithful through it all, teaching her family the Gospel of Jesus Christ." Six children named. Thomas and Lizzie (Eliza) died in England.

Temple Ordinances — John Hastings: FamilySearch Ordinances tab, KWJW-YSJ. Endowment: 4 March 1865, Endowment House. Sealed to Jane Burdett: 4 March 1865, Endowment House. Sealed to Abigail Gillam (proxy): 19 October 1870, Endowment House. Sealed to Mary Goodman: 14 July 1881, Endowment House.

James Mellor — Sources: Brief Sketch from the Life of James Mellor, FamilySearch Memories KWN7-G38 — primary source for imprisonment quote and social shunning quote. History of the Leicester Stake, 1844–1983, FamilySearch Memories, pages 4–8 — source for Blaby Branch geography, railway accident, 1847 depression, market square campaign, converting older brother John Mellor, Mary Ann's father's opposition. The Mellor Family of the Martin Handcart Company, FamilySearch Memories — source for Horizon voyage, porthole incident, Elder Savage's warning. Physical manuscripts: James Mellor history and journals, 1841–1903, BYU L. Tom Perry Special Collections, MSS SC 1561. Also held at Church History Library.

Ann Hastings (Elizabeth Ann Nicholl) — Death Certificate: Utah State Death Certificate No. 240, Burial Permit No. 113. Died 2 June 1909, 102 Cross Street, Ogden, Weber County, Utah. Father: John Hastings, England. Mother: Jane Burdett, England. Informant: Louis H. Nicholl. Buried Ogden City Cemetery, 3 June 1909. Cause: pneumonia.

Henry Burdett (Jane's brother) — Vital Records: FamilySearch profile K2W3-TYW. Born 29 June 1835, Countesthorpe. Died 15 July 1902, Ogden, Weber, Utah. Buried Ogden, 17 July 1902. Baptized 13 September 1881, confirmed 18 September 1881 — decades after his siblings' earlier conversions.

Cross-Document Connection — Claudius V. Spencer: Spencer presided over the 1861 Manchester voyage (this story) and led the Claudius V. Spencer overland company that brought

Robert and Mary Ann Aldous to Utah in 1853 (see Robert and Mary Ann Aldous). Both documents should note this connection.

Cross-Document Connection — Ogden Settlement: The Hastings family settled in Ogden, Weber County — the same community established by Erastus Bingham (Bingham's Fort), settled by the Aldous, Wilson, Wiggins, and Bingham families documented elsewhere in this series.

Story 6 of 12

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Freezing Waters, a Broken Ship, and Bingham's Fort

Robert and Mary Ann Aldous

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Fenstanton, Huntingdonshire • England to Utah • 1849–1854

Baptized: 12 December 1849 (Robert)

Fenstanton, Huntingdonshire, England



Freezing Waters, a Broken Ship, and Bingham's Fort

Robert and Mary Ann Aldous

Fenstanton, Huntingdonshire • England to Utah • 1849–1854

The World of Fenstanton, Huntingdonshire

Robert Frederick Aldous and his wife, Mary Ann Parkin, built their early lives in the low-lying, fertile clay lands of Fenstanton, England, bordered by the bustling transport highway of the River Great Ouse. The local economy was anchored by intensive agriculture and a booming malting industry that supplied regional breweries.

As a skilled carpenter, Robert was vital to this infrastructure. He rented a timber-framed cottage on the sprawling estate owned by the prominent Reverend Lancelot Robert Brown — the grandson of England's most celebrated landscape architect, Lancelot "Capability" Brown. There, Robert spent his days constructing and repairing the heavy agricultural wagons, brewing barrels, and timber granaries required to move goods down to the river wharves. It was a secure, respectable working-class life, but one tightly bound to a rigid social hierarchy where housing, livelihood, and social acceptance required strict conformity to the established Church of England.

Social, Industrial, and Moral Disruption

The decades leading up to 1849 brought massive upheavals to Huntingdonshire. In his youth, Robert witnessed the desperation of the Swing Riots (1830–1831), where local agricultural laborers revolted against automation and starvation wages. The legacy of the Enclosure Acts continued to sting, stripping working-class families of common land rights and leaving them entirely dependent on landlords like Reverend Brown.

By the late 1840s, modernization arrived in the form of the East Anglian Railway (1847), which rapidly connected their quiet valley to the rest of Britain. Alongside the railway swept the Temperance Movement — an organized moral reform effort pushing for total abstinence from alcohol. It was this specific network of reform that Latter-day Saint missionaries intentionally utilized to find spiritually receptive souls looking to transform their lives.

The Curriculum of Conversion

The catalyst for change in the Aldous home arrived via Elder James H. Flanigan, a young Irish-born missionary who blanketed the Bedfordshire Conference on foot. Born in County Down, Ireland, in September 1822, Flanigan had converted to Mormonism as a young man, immigrated to Nauvoo in the early 1840s, and spent years preaching across Tennessee, Kentucky, and the northeastern United States before arriving in

Liverpool on **5 October 1848** to begin his English mission. Logging grueling winter walks through the freezing mud, he focused his energy intensely on Fenstanton. On **25 October 1849**, he recorded preaching to a standing-room-only "full house" right in Stanton.

Elder Flanigan's sermons did not preach an easy faith. His journals note that his preparatory lessons focused squarely on the comprehensive "History of the Church" — detailing the martyrdom of Joseph Smith, the building of Nauvoo, and the recent, heroic trek of the Saints to the Rocky Mountains. Investigators like Robert and Mary Ann were explicitly taught the heavy physical and spiritual price tag of the Restoration before they ever made a covenant.

Freezing Waters and Separate Covenants

The spiritual momentum culminated in the dead of winter. On Wednesday evening, **12 December 1849**, local investigators and Saints gathered with the missionaries for a communal "Tea party" and meeting. These gatherings were designed to foster deep community trust and steel nerves before stepping out into the freezing elements. Following the meeting, under the cover of an icy winter night, Elder Flanigan led Robert down into the local waters and personally immersed him. While official branch ledger entries later batch-recorded this event on December 20, Flanigan's real-time diary preserves the true night of Robert's baptism.

Mary Ann's path to the water required its own independent courage. Managing a household with five young children — George (13), Georgiana (11), Charles (9), Frederick (7), and Angelina (5) — in a cottage owned by the parish rector meant the stakes were frustratingly high. She waited exactly 17 days, navigating domestic demands and the immediate social friction of their choice, before entering the waters herself on Saturday, **29 December 1849**.

> *She waited exactly 17 days — navigating domestic demands and the immediate social friction of their choice — before entering the waters herself.*

The Urgent Turn to Zion

Once the covenants were made, the timeline accelerated rapidly. Within six months, Robert was ordained an Elder and briefly presided over the tiny Fenstanton Branch. By January 1850, Elder Flanigan was already at the Church's emigration offices in Liverpool organizing the machinery of migration. The spirit of the "Gathering" pulled at the Aldous family with an undeniable gravity.

As the family prepared for their departure, the urgency to bind their children to the covenant framework became paramount. On **3 September 1850** — exactly one month

before boarding their ship — their ten-year-old son, Charles Aldous, was led down to the waters in England to receive his own childhood baptism, forever marking his membership in the original British branch ledgers.

On **2 October 1850**, Robert packed up his carpentry tools, collected Mary Ann and their five children, and walked away from the security of the Brown estate forever. They were among 254 Latter-day Saint converts who boarded the emigrant ship *James Pennell* at the Liverpool docks, bound for an unknown life across the sea.

A Storm at the Gulf

Their faith was tested almost immediately. After weeks of Atlantic crossing — during which Mary Ann grew gravely ill before recovering as they neared the West Indies — catastrophe struck as the ship rounded the Cape of Florida entering the Gulf of Mexico. On the morning of **4 November 1850**, a hurricane hit suddenly while all sails were set. Before the crew could react, the roaring winds sheared the main and mizen masts completely off, split the foremast, tore every sail to pieces, and swept the deck caboose, hogsheads, and ship's boats overboard. The *James Pennell* was left crippled and wallowing.

As waves washed over the battered decks and provisions dwindled to near-starvation levels, the family held fast to their faith. Eventually a pilot boat located the vessel and towed the broken ship safely into New Orleans on **22 November 1850**. They had survived.

The St. Louis Crucible (1850–1853)

Lacking the immediate funds to purchase wagons, teams, and long-term provisions, the Aldous family paused their journey for nearly three years in the gateway city of St. Louis, Missouri. This interlude was an intense furnace of labor. Arriving just a year after the Great Fire of 1849 had leveled the city's wharf district, Robert found a city in a frenzied rebuilding phase.

He threw himself into the local construction boom, navigating a volatile labor market where the Church operated its own organized lumberyards and cooperatives to protect incoming immigrants from exploitation. While Robert labored to earn their overland outfit, the family lived through the devastating cholera outbreaks of 1851 and 1852 that ravaged the crowded riverfront districts.

Amidst the constant grind of survival and labor, Robert and Mary Ann kept their eyes anchored to their faith. When their youngest daughter, Angelina Theresa, reached the accountable age of eight, they saw to it that her ordinances were completed right there in the migration camps. She was baptized on **10 October 1853**, a sign that even during

their hardest years of displacement along the Mississippi, the family prioritized their spiritual duties.

By the spring of 1853, the heavy physical price had finally been paid. With their hard-earned oxen, wagon, and provisions safely secured, Robert and Mary Ann loaded their five children into the Claudius V. Spencer Company. They turned their faces west.

Crossing the Plains

The journey was grueling — punctuated by sudden plains storms, heavy dust, and the constant threat of illness. But the company moved steadily forward through the summer and into the early autumn of 1853. The Claudius V. Spencer Company, with roughly 250 individuals and 40 wagons, arrived in the Salt Lake Valley between **17 and 26 September 1853**. Robert and Mary Ann had survived thousands of miles of travel, a catastrophic storm at sea, and nearly three years of displacement along the Mississippi.

Gathering to the Weber Valley: Settling the Ogden Frontier

The family did not stay long in Salt Lake City. Recognizing the immediate need for skilled woodsmen and builders to expand the northern frontier, Church authorities directed the family to move to Weber County. By 1854, Robert and Mary Ann had traveled forty miles north of Salt Lake to settle at **Bingham's Fort** — located in the modern Lynn/Five Points area of north Ogden, and named in honor of Bishop Erastus Bingham of the North Ward, who had helped establish it on his own farmland in August 1851. The fort was a fortified agricultural settlement built to protect early families during regional territorial tensions, and Robert's master carpentry skills were instantly put to use building its defensive walls, timber gates, and interior cabins.

It was here that the family began to lay down deep roots. In **January 1855**, their eldest daughter, Georgiana Maria Aldous, was married inside the fort walls to local pioneer Martin Henderson Harris. Georgiana did not live long in the valley she had helped settle — she died on **30 October 1858**, three years after her wedding, leaving behind an infant son.

The family's connections to the Bingham household ran deeper than the fort itself. Angelina Theresa Aldous — the five-year-old who had stood at her mother's side on that icy December night in Fenstanton — married **Brigham Heber Bingham**, son of Bishop Erastus Bingham, on **24 December 1862**, formally uniting the two pioneer families whose lives had been intertwined since the day the Aldous family first crossed through the fort gates.

As the frontier expanded and the fort walls were safely dismantled, Robert and Mary Ann moved into the steep, rugged mountains just east of Ogden to help pioneer the valley of **Huntsville**. Utilizing the timber from the surrounding canyons, Robert hand-

built a sturdy hewn-log cabin for his family — the first cabin built in Huntsville, completed in 1861, which survived for well over a century as a monument to their labor. Robert was a man of many callings in the community: he built the first school in Huntsville and served as its first superintendent, superintended the construction of three bridges when Ogden Canyon was first opened, and served five years as watermaster. He was ordained a Seventy and a High Priest.

Mary Ann died on **21 April 1892** in Huntsville, Utah, and was buried on **24 April 1892** at the Huntsville Cemetery. Robert outlived her by four years, dying on **24 August 1896** in Huntsville — the valley he had spent four decades helping to build — and was laid to rest alongside her. Together they had traded the rigid, secure traditions of the English fens for the radical freedom of the Utah frontier. The arc of their journey, which had begun with a carpenter's quiet decision to walk away from a landlord's estate on an icy December night in Fenstanton, closed in the mountain valley where they had built something lasting from nothing.

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A Note on Elder Flanigan

The young missionary who set all of this in motion did not live to see the Aldous family cross the plains. James Henry Flanigan died of smallpox in Birmingham on **29 January 1851** — just fourteen months after leading Robert into the freezing waters of a Fenstanton winter night. He was 28 years old. He never returned to Ireland or to America. What he left behind, in Fenstanton and a dozen parishes like it, were covenants that outlasted him by generations.

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Source Citations

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Reverend Lancelot Robert Brown — Landlord and Estate: Orson F. Whitney, *History of Utah*, Vol. 4, p. 433. *Alumni Cantabrigienses*, Vol. 2, Part 1, p. 411. National Archives (UK), Brown of Fenstanton Estate Records, BUS/1–22.

Flanigan Biography — Arrival, Mission, and Death: Born County Down, Ireland, September 1822. Converted and immigrated to Nauvoo early 1840s. Arrived Liverpool 5 October 1848. Appointed Bedfordshire Conference president January 1849. Died of smallpox, Birmingham, 29 January 1851, age 28. — BYU Religious Studies Center, *Descriptive Bibliography of the Mormon Church*, Vol. 2, Entries 346–399; Andrew Jenson, *Latter-day Saint Biographical Encyclopedia*.

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Standing-Room-Only Crowds — 25 October 1849: Flanigan diaries, Volume 4, page 56: "25th Thursday Came to Stanton & preached in the evening to a full house & good attention."

"History of the Church" Context — 27 October 1849: Flanigan diaries, Volume 4, page 54: "27th Saturday… preached in the evening at Irchester on the History of the Church &c."

Mary Ann Parkin Baptism — 29 December 1849: Documented Ordinance Data, Mary Ann Parkin Personal Profile, FamilySearch (KWVM-KCB).

Charles Aldous Baptism — 3 September 1850: Charles Aldous baptismal entry, FamilySearch — recorded 3 September 1850, Fenstanton, England.

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Story 7 of 12

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The Mother Who Moved First

George Stratford and Eliza Barwell

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Maldon, Essex • England to Utah • 1851–1893

Baptized: 17 April 1851 (Eliza)

Maldon, Essex, England



The Mother Who Moved First

George Stratford and Eliza Barwell

Maldon, Essex • England to Utah • 1851–1893

The World of Maldon, Essex

George Stratford and his wife, Eliza Barwell, built their early lives in the bustling market town of Maldon, on the tidal reaches of the Blackwater Estuary in Essex, England. The salt air rolling off the estuary carried with it the sounds of George's carpenter and cabinet-making shop, established by the late 1830s at Wantz on the edge of town. The local economy was anchored by intensive agriculture, a booming malting industry that supplied regional breweries, and the river trade that moved goods up and down the Blackwater. George was well established within this world — recorded in *Pigot & Co.'s Royal National and Commercial Directory* of 1839 as a cabinet maker at Wantz, confirmed in the household of the 1841 census. It was a secure and respectable working-class life.

George had been born in Maldon on **7 November 1807**, christened at St. Peter's Parish on 21 February 1808, the son of Samuel Stratford and Elizabeth Cass Stratford. His son Edwin would later record that Samuel had spent his youth in a workhouse before apprenticing as a farmer and eventually establishing himself as a gardener in Maldon. George had risen considerably further, mastering a skilled trade and founding his own shop. He married Eliza Barwell on **17 May 1832** at Great Maplestead in Essex. Eliza had been born on **5 October 1809** at St. Mary's Parish in Maldon, the daughter of Robert Barwell and Mary Rule Barwell — a family rooted in the same Essex world George inhabited.

They were, from the beginning, people of active religious faith. George and Eliza found their early spiritual home among the Wesleyan Methodists, regularly opening their doors to traveling preachers and seeking genuine Christian fellowship. But over time, the sectarian divisions of their world began to ring hollow to George's searching mind. Edwin would describe his father as a champion of absolute freedom of thought, a man who felt that the primitive authority of the ancient Church was entirely missing from the conflicting pulpits of Essex. Eventually the family departed the Wesleyans altogether and aligned with a small congregation known as the Brethren of Freedom of Thought. It was in this condition — already once converted, already once dissatisfied, still searching — that the 1840s found them.

Grief Across Two Decades

Between 1836 and 1849, the shadow of infant mortality crossed the Stratford threshold four times — not in a single devastating run, but woven across the years between the births of their living children, a recurring grief that no amount of sectarian promise could fully answer.

Their third child, **George Samuel**, was born **19 September 1836** at All Saints Parish, Maldon. He survived more than two years before dying on **9 January 1839** and was buried in the Independent Chapel yard in Maldon. The family continued to grow — Eliza arrived in January 1838, Julia in September 1839 — but loss came again. Their seventh child, **Emma**, was born **24 June 1841** in Maldon. Two years later, in 1843, the entire family relocated to London. It was there, far from Essex, that Emma died on **6 November 1843**. She was buried in the churchyard of St. John's Wood Church, St. John's Wood, London.

The family's years in London and the subsequent moves that followed were part of a decade of restless displacement. From London they moved to Rayleigh in southeast Essex, where their ninth child, **George Robert**, was born on **30 August 1845**. The family then moved back to London, and it was there that George Robert died on **11 December 1846** — buried alongside his sister Emma in the St. John's Wood churchyard. By the late 1840s the family had returned to Maldon. Their tenth child, **Esther**, was born in April 1848 at St. Peter's Parish and died on **19 June 1849**, buried in the Independent Chapel yard beside George Samuel. Four children sent into the eternities, their graves scattered between the Independent Chapel at Maldon and a London churchyard miles away. The Stratfords were left as grieving seekers — parents who had buried four of their ten children and were desperately longing for a theology that could match the depth of their loss.

The Penniless Elder and the Domino Covenant (Spring 1851)

By early 1851, the family had settled back into Maldon with their six surviving children: Edwin (18), Lucetta (16), Eliza (13), Julia (11), Ann (7), and Emily, who was still three months from being born. When the April census taker arrived, he recorded a standard hardworking English household. They had no idea that a spiritual whirlwind was already walking toward them on bleeding feet.

In January 1851, a nineteen-year-old elder named **Charles W. Penrose** was baptized into the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints in London and ordained an Elder. On **6 January 1851** he received his missionary call. True to the principle of going without purse or scrip, he left London on foot in early March, walking the rough country roads to Maldon, Essex — an entirely new missionary field. He arrived in Maldon completely penniless, having walked until his feet bled, spending his first night sleeping on a cold straw stack. But he carried a message of a restored gospel, the authority of the priesthood, the eternal sealing of families, and the promise that the dead were not lost.

When the paths of this penniless young Londoner and the searching Stratford family intersected, the impact was immediate — but it did not follow the conventional order of the era. It was the mother who acted first. On **17 April 1851**, Eliza Barwell Stratford stepped forward alone and was baptized by Elder Penrose, breaking the ice for her entire household. Her act of faith unleashed a remarkable sequence through the family over the next ten weeks, recorded in the Maldon Branch Record of Members of the London Conference:

9 May 1851: Eighteen-year-old Edwin Stratford walked down to the water and received his own baptism. 28 May 1851: Thirteen-year-old Eliza Stratford stepped into the waters of covenant. 2 June 1851: George Stratford, seeing the unified faith of his wife and children, was baptized by Elder Penrose — surrendering his remaining doubts to the authority he had sought for decades. 1 July 1851: Sixteen-year-old Lucetta Stratford entered the covenant, completing the initial gathering of the family into the fold.

On **28 July 1851** — just weeks after Lucetta's baptism — Emily Stratford was born, christened the following day at St. Peter's Parish. She was the first Stratford child born into an already-converted household. The four babies they had buried were not lost to them forever; they were part of an eternal chain that this young elder had the authority to seal together.

Pillars of the Maldon Branch (1851–1860)

The Stratfords did not convert and immediately flee England. Instead, they became foundational pillars of the newly formed Maldon Branch, anchoring the local Church throughout the 1850s. Their relationship with Charles W. Penrose deepened from that of missionary and investigator into the closest of family bonds. Elder Penrose was kept on a continuous mission in Great Britain for seven years. During this time, he courted Lucetta Stratford, and the two were married in Maldon on **21 January 1855**, with her older brother Edwin standing as a witness. The civil marriage certificate, registered as No. 35 in the District of Maldon, preserves this record. Penrose also played matchmaker within the family: it was through him that Julia Stratford met a young traveling Elder named **William Budge**. Their courtship lasted only two weeks before Julia and William were married on **24 September 1856** in England, with Penrose, now her brother-in-law, presiding over the match.

As the decade waned, the spirit of gathering pressed upon the family. The first to act as trailblazer was young Eliza Stratford. In 1860, at twenty-two years old, she left her parents behind and crossed the Atlantic, settling in Davis County, Utah, to prepare a place for the family she knew would follow. Julia and William Budge followed that same year, embarking on **10 May 1860** aboard the sailing vessel *William Tappscott*. The ship's company was quarantined upon arrival in New York and, after a considerable

period of detention, permitted to proceed to Florence, Nebraska, arriving **5 October 1860**. William Budge was chosen as Captain of the last ox-team company to cross the plains that season, leading seventy-two wagons into Salt Lake City.

Back in England, George and Eliza Barwell spent the closing months of 1860 winding up the affairs of the cabinet shop, preparing Ann and young Emily for the great exodus. Edwin and Lucetta remained behind with Penrose to complete their service to the British Mission.

The Price of Gathering (1861)

On **23 April 1861**, the moment of ultimate departure arrived. George, Eliza Barwell, Ann, and nine-year-old Emily boarded the ship *Underwriter* at Liverpool, joining 624 fellow Latter-day Saints under the presidency of Milo Andrus. They were not alone in their family circle: Charles and Lucetta Penrose and their children sailed on the same vessel — the missionary who had baptized the family now crossing the Atlantic alongside them as one of their own. The voyage lasted six weeks.

The crossing was not peaceful. Ann Stratford Robinson, who crossed as an eighteen-year-old, later recorded the ordeal in her own words: *"While we were on the ocean, my father was taken very sick, and we were afraid we would have to bury him at sea, but he lived until we reached land, then died."* For six weeks, the family watched George decline across the Atlantic, fearing each day that they would lower him into the sea. He held on until the ship made land.

They dropped anchor in New York on **21 May 1861** and pushed inland toward the outfitting posts in Nebraska. But the rally was brief. On **23 June 1861**, while the company was camped at Florence, Nebraska — the old Winter Quarters trailhead — George Stratford's worn body finally gave out. He died on the very threshold of the plains, never setting his eyes on the Salt Lake Valley.

> *"We had to bury him in that far-off land, Winter Quarters, 23 June 1861. It was a deep trial to my dear mother." — Ann Stratford Robinson*

Refusing to turn back, the widowed Eliza Barwell Stratford gathered her daughters and joined the Homer Duncan Company, crossing the plains by ox team and entering the Salt Lake Valley in **September 1861**. Charles Penrose and Lucetta made the same crossing that season, settling first in Farmington and then later in Logan, Utah, where Penrose would build a career as a journalist and civic leader.

Gathering to the Valley: The Children's Utah Lives

The reunion in Utah brought both profound joy and sudden, heartbreaking loss. Eliza Barwell was reunited with her vanguard daughter, Eliza Stratford, who married Henry

Rampton in the Endowment House on **29 March 1862**. The joy did not last. On **25 April 1863**, just over a year after her marriage, twenty-five-year-old Eliza Stratford Rampton passed away in Bountiful, Davis County, followed closely by her infant son, James. She was the third Stratford child buried far from Maldon — the brave daughter who had crossed the ocean first, who had come to Utah ahead of the family to prepare the way, who had survived the gathering only to be taken just as it was complete.

The surviving children put down deep roots. Ann Stratford, whose own account of the voyage and George's death preserved the family's memory, married Oliver Lee Robinson in the Endowment House in 1862, settling in Farmington, Davis County, where she raised eleven children and lived until **12 June 1926** — the longest-lived of all her siblings. Julia Stratford Budge, who had crossed the plains with her husband commanding seventy-two wagons, settled in the Cache Valley community of Logan, where her family became a fixture of pioneer society. She died on **27 September 1912** in Pocatello, Idaho, and was buried at the Logan City Cemetery. Emily Stratford, who had crossed the ocean at age nine clinging to a dying father's ship, married and settled in Providence, Cache County, where she died on **7 January 1913**, buried in the Providence City Cemetery. Edwin and Lucetta, who had remained in England to complete their service to the British Mission, eventually followed and established their own Utah families in the same Cache Valley communities.

The widowed Eliza Barwell Stratford built a resilient pioneer life as a skilled dressmaker, documented in the 1880 Federal Census with that occupation. She moved between her children's households across Utah — from the Davis County settlements near Bountiful, to Providence in Cache County where Emily lived, and finally to Ogden in Weber County. She outlived her husband by more than thirty years and outlived her daughter Eliza by three decades. She finally passed away in Ogden on **8 December 1893**, buried at the Ogden City Cemetery.

A Legacy That Lasted a Lifetime

The bond between the Stratford family and Charles W. Penrose did not end with the crossing. Penrose's life after Utah grew into one of extraordinary distinction. He became editor of the *Deseret News*, a member of the Quorum of the Twelve Apostles in 1904, and ultimately served as First Counselor in the First Presidency of the Church under Presidents Joseph F. Smith and Heber J. Grant — one of the highest offices in Latter-day Saint history. He had been a penniless nineteen-year-old sleeping on a straw stack in Maldon when he first knocked on the Stratford door. When Julia Stratford Budge died in 1912, the funeral services were held in the Stake Tabernacle in Logan, and President Charles W. Penrose personally delivered one of the tributes — sixty-one years after he had walked bleeding and penniless into Maldon and baptized her mother in the cold waters of Essex.

The legacy begun with Eliza Barwell's single, courageous step into the waters on 17 April 1851 ran unbroken through every branch of the family she and George had built. Four children buried across two continents. A cabinet shop closed and a life in England relinquished. A father who survived the Atlantic only to die within sight of the American plains. And yet the covenant held. The Stratford name, carried forward by Edwin, Lucetta, Julia, Ann, and Emily into the communities of Cache Valley and Davis County, became part of the foundational fabric of pioneer Utah — woven into it by a woman who moved first, before anyone else in her family was ready, and changed the course of everything that followed.

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A Note on Elder Penrose

Charles William Penrose was born on **4 February 1832** in Camberwell, London, the son of Richard Penrose and Matilda Sims. He was baptized into the Church on **14 May 1850** in London, called as a missionary on **6 January 1851**, and walked to Maldon, Essex — an entirely new missionary field — in early March of that year. He served in the British Mission for seven continuous years. He married Lucetta Stratford in 1855, immigrated to Utah on the *Underwriter* in 1861, and went on to serve as editor of the *Deseret News*, president of the Church's British Mission (1906–1910), a member of the Quorum of the Twelve Apostles (1904), and First Counselor in the First Presidency under Presidents Joseph F. Smith and Heber J. Grant. He died on **16 May 1925** in Salt Lake City at the age of 93 — more than seventy years after he slept on a straw stack in Maldon and changed the Stratford family's destiny.

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Source Citations

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Ann Stratford Robinson — Eyewitness Account of the Voyage: Anne Stratford Robinson, "Short Sketch," as compiled in "Stratford, Anne — George Stratford," biography compiled by Georgia Green Fooks (great-granddaughter), FamilySearch Memories, profile KWNV-KPR. Direct quotations on the shipboard illness and George's death at Winter Quarters.

George Stratford — Vital Records: FamilySearch profile KWJW-2B6, familysearch.org/en/tree/person/details/KWJW-2B6. Born 7 November 1807, Maldon, Essex;

christened 21 February 1808, St. Peter's Parish, Maldon; died 23 June 1861, Florence (Winter Quarters), Nebraska. 77 sources, High Quality rating.

Eliza Barwell — Vital Records: FamilySearch profile KWJW-2BZ, familysearch.org/en/tree/person/details/KWJW-2BZ. Born 5 October 1809, St. Mary's Parish, Maldon, Essex; died 8 December 1893, Ogden, Weber, Utah; buried Ogden City Cemetery. 52 sources, High Quality rating.

Marriage — 17 May 1832, Great Maplestead, Essex: Great Maplestead Parish Registers (Essex, England), marriage of George Stratford and Eliza Barwell, 17 May 1832.

Cabinet-Making Trade and Residence: *Pigot & Co.'s Royal National and Commercial Directory* (1839), Section on Maldon, Essex, listing George Stratford under "Carpenters & Wheelwrights/Cabinet Makers" at Wantz. Verified in the 1841 England Census for Maldon All Saints with St. Peter, household of George Stratford (FHL Film #193644).

Children's Burial Records — Independent Chapel Yard and St. John's Wood: George Samuel Stratford (died 9 January 1839) and Esther Stratford (died 19 June 1849): Independent Chapel yard, Maldon. Confirmed in Edwin Stratford, *Genealogy and Mission Journal*. Emma Stratford (died 6 November 1843) and George Robert Stratford (died 11 December 1846): St. John's Wood Church yard, London. Emma's burial confirmed in "England, Deaths and Burials, 1538–1991," FamilySearch, Pg 241, No. 1927; burial date 12 November 1843, Marylebone registration district.

Charles W. Penrose — Missionary Call and Walk to Maldon: Andrew Jenson, *Latter-day Saint Biographical Encyclopedia*, Vol. 1, pp. 256–261: baptized 14 May 1850; ordained Elder and called as missionary 6 January 1851; "left London early in March, walking to Maldon, Essex, an entirely new missionary field, where he began his labors without purse or scrip." Born 4 February 1832, Camberwell, London; died 16 May 1925, Salt Lake City. Church History Biographical Database, history.churchofjesuschrist.org/chd/individual/charles-william-penrose-1832.

Domino Conversions — Maldon Branch Record of Members: Maldon Branch Record of Members (1851), London Conference, Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints. Sequence of baptisms: Eliza Barwell (17 April 1851), Edwin Stratford (9 May 1851), Eliza Stratford (28 May 1851), George Stratford (2 June 1851), Lucetta Stratford (1 July 1851). Document digitized in FamilySearch Memories, profile KWJZ-8K8.

Penrose and Lucetta Stratford Marriage — 21 January 1855: Register Office Marriage Certificate, District of Maldon, County of Essex, No. 35, solemnized 21 January 1855, between Charles William Penrose and Lucetta Stratford, witnessed by Edwin Stratford. FamilySearch profile: Lucetta Stratford, KWJW-L8Z.

Julia Stratford and William Budge — Marriage and 1860 Emigration: William Budge pioneer biography, FamilySearch Memories, profile KWJZ-8K8: married 24 September 1856; sailed *William Tappscott*, departed 10 May 1860; arrived Florence, Nebraska, 5 October 1860; William Budge appointed Captain of the last overland company (72 wagons), 1860. Julia Stratford Budge: FamilySearch profile KWJZ-8K8.

The *Underwriter* Voyage — 23 April 1861: Mormon Migration Database, manifest of the ship *Underwriter*, departing Liverpool 23 April 1861, arriving New York 21 May 1861, carrying 624

LDS immigrants under the presidency of Milo Andrus. Passengers include George, Eliza, Ann, and Emily Stratford, and Charles and Lucetta Penrose and children. Confirmed in Church Historians Press biography of Charles William Penrose.

George Stratford's Death at Florence/Winter Quarters — 23 June 1861: Ann Stratford Robinson, "Short Sketch" (primary eyewitness): "We had to bury him in that far-off land, Winter Quarters, 23 June 1861. It was a deep trial to my dear mother." Cross-referenced with Edwin Stratford, *Genealogy and Mission Journal*, and the Homer Duncan Company roster, Mormon Pioneer Overland Travel Database (1847–1868).

Homer Duncan Company — Eliza Barwell's Crossing: Mormon Pioneer Overland Travel Database (1847–1868), roster of the Homer Duncan Company (1861). Widowed Eliza Barwell, Ann, and Emily departed Florence 25 June 1861 and entered the Salt Lake Valley September 1861.

Eliza Stratford Rampton — Marriage and Death: Henry Rampton's Diary and Life History (1853–1878), Church History Library, MS 6080, p. 51, recording marriage to Eliza Stratford on 29 March 1862 at the Endowment House. Her death on 25 April 1863 confirmed by the *Deseret News* death notice (Wednesday, 20 May 1863, p. 8) and the *Millennial Star*, Vol. 25, No. 32, p. 512. FamilySearch Memories: Eliza Stratford, KWJW-L49.

Ann Stratford Robinson — Utah Life: FamilySearch profile KWNV-KPR. Born 4 May 1843, Maldon; married Oliver Lee Robinson, Endowment House, 1862; died 12 June 1926, Farmington, Davis County, Utah.

Julia Stratford Budge's Funeral — President Penrose as Speaker: Funeral notice, FamilySearch Memories, profile KWJZ-8K8: "Impressive funeral services were held in the Stake Tabernacle yesterday afternoon over the remains of Mrs. Julia Stratford Budge… The speakers were John U. Stucki of Paris, Idaho, Bishop C.W. Nibley, and President C.W. Penrose of Salt Lake City." Julia died 27 September 1912, Pocatello, Bannock County, Idaho; buried Logan City Cemetery, Logan, Cache County, Utah.

Emily Stratford Poulsen — Vital Records: FamilySearch profile KWNR-1QW. Born 28 July 1851, St. Peter's Parish, Maldon; christened 29 July 1851; died 7 January 1913, Providence, Cache County, Utah; buried Providence City Cemetery.

Eliza Barwell Stratford — Utah Legacy: East Bountiful Ward Record of Members (FHL Film #25821, Item 01, p. 54); 1870 US Federal Census, Providence, Cache County; 1880 US Federal Census, Ogden, Weber County (listing occupation as Dressmaker). Death registered 8 December 1893; buried Ogden City Cemetery. FamilySearch profile KWJW-2BZ.

Story 8 of 12

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Two Converts, One Friday on the Blackwater

Marianna Crabb and Edwin Stratford

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Danbury and Maldon, Essex • England to Utah • 1851–1919

Baptized: 9 May 1851
Maldon, Essex, England



Two Converts, One Friday on the Blackwater

Marianna Crabb and Edwin Stratford

Danbury and Maldon, Essex • England to Utah • 1851–1919

Danbury sits on a chalk ridge above the quiet valleys of central Essex, a parish of scattered farms, woodland, and the unhurried rhythms of English rural life. Its working households ran on trades—shoemakers, blacksmiths, agricultural laborers—and its social life turned on the parish church of St. John the Baptist, whose Norman tower stood watch over a community that had changed little in a generation. A dozen miles to the northeast, the character of the county shifted entirely. Maldon, a market town set at the head of the Blackwater Estuary, was a busier, more commercial world: cabinet shops and malting barns stacked near the river wharves, and a maritime economy that tied the town to the wider trade routes of Essex. These two places—Danbury's quiet ridge and Maldon's tidal shore—were unremarkable corners of mid-Victorian England. In the spring of 1851, they became the unlikely origins of a single family.

The Orphan of Danbury

Marianna Crabb had known loss before most young women her age had reason to reckon with it. Born in Danbury, Essex, on **6 December 1831**, she had lost her mother early, and watched her father, Jesse Crabb, follow in **1849**, leaving her, at seventeen, without the domestic anchor that defined most women's lives in this era. By the spring of 1851, she had done what practical necessity demanded: she moved into the household of John Brett, a master shoemaker in Danbury, and was working there as a live-in dressmaker's apprentice. The 1851 England Census records her in that position—age nineteen, under the shoemaker's roof alongside Brett's family and a fellow apprentice. It was a respectable arrangement, and Marianna was clearly capable of holding her place in it. But she was, in the most literal sense, a young woman without a family of her own.

Into that particular loneliness came the missionaries of The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints, moving through the parishes of Essex with the message of a restored gospel and the promise of an eternal family sealed beyond the reach of death.

The Carpenter's Son

Twelve miles away in Maldon, a family was already in the midst of its own remarkable spiritual awakening. George Stratford, a master cabinet-maker at Wantz, and his wife Eliza Barwell had spent years searching—departing the Wesleyans, aligning briefly with

the Brethren of Freedom of Thought—before a penniless nineteen-year-old missionary named Charles W. Penrose walked bleeding into Maldon in early March of 1851 and changed their lives entirely. On **17 April 1851**, Eliza Barwell Stratford—the moral center of the household—stepped forward alone and was baptized by Elder Penrose, breaking the ice for her entire family. The full account of that conversion and the extraordinary chain of faith it set in motion is told in the companion story, *George Stratford and Eliza Barwell*.

Edwin Stratford, the eldest of the Stratford children, was born in Maldon on **6 February 1833**. He had grown up in the cabinet shop world of the town, the son of a master craftsman, acquainted from boyhood with the weight of tools and the grain of wood. His mother's courage was before him. The missionaries were in his home. And across the Essex countryside, an orphaned dressmaker's apprentice was making her own independent way toward the same water.

Friday, May 9, 1851

> *The handwritten ledger of the Maldon Branch records, with spare precision, what happened on a Friday afternoon in early May: two converts, baptized by the same elder, on the same day—and no one else.*

On **9 May 1851**—three weeks after his mother had stood in the water alone—Edwin Stratford was baptized by Elder Charles W. Penrose into The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints. He was eighteen years old. On the same Friday afternoon, Marianna Crabb—nineteen, orphaned, making her own independent way across the Essex countryside—walked down to the water and received the same ordinance from the same elder's hands. The original Maldon Branch ledger records them together on the same page: Line 9, Edwin Stratford, age 18, baptized by C. W. Penrose; Line 25, Marianna Crabb, age 19, baptized by C. W. Penrose.

They were the only two baptized that day. Not the last of a larger gathering, not part of a Sunday service or an evening meeting—simply two young people from different villages and different circumstances who arrived at the same river on the same Friday afternoon and left it as members of the same church.

They had no way of knowing, as they stood at the river's edge, that this shared spiritual birthday was the beginning of a family.

The Household Transformed

Marianna returned to the Brett household in Danbury as a changed woman, and the effect on those around her was immediate. Forty-eight hours after her baptism—on **11 May 1851**—her employer, John Brett (age 45), and his sister, Naomi Brett (age 43),

were themselves baptized by Elder Penrose and recorded in the Maldon Branch ledger. The orphan apprentice had not simply found a new faith; she had carried it home with her. Months later, Samuel Smith, a fellow apprentice in the shoemaker's household, followed them into the water. When the Church formally organized the independent Danbury Branch on **11 October 1852**, the records show that the Brett household's entire membership was transferred together as a single, unified block of believers.

> *The girl who had arrived at the shoemaker's door as an outsider had quietly transformed it into a gathering place of faith.*

Witnesses to a Marriage—and Then a Marriage of Their Own

In the years that followed their shared baptism, Edwin and Marianna each deepened their place in the Essex LDS community. Elder Penrose remained on continuous mission in Great Britain, and over those same years his relationship with the Stratford household grew from that of missionary and investigators to the closest of family bonds. He courted Lucetta Stratford, Edwin's younger sister, and on **21 January 1855**, they were married in Maldon. Edwin Stratford stood as a witness and signed the marriage certificate beside the man who had led him into the water four years before, now his brother-in-law.

Eleven months later, on **25 December 1855**, Edwin Stratford and Marianna Crabb were married in Chelmsford, Essex—on Christmas Day. They had shared a baptismal date, a branch, and four years of faith in the same community. The Atlantic lay ahead of them, and half a continent beyond that. They were walking into all of it together.

Newlyweds on the Caravan

The newlyweds did not linger in England. In **February 1856**—just two months after their wedding—Edwin and Marianna packed what they owned and joined the company of Saints departing for America. They boarded the emigrant ship *Caravan*, and on **27 March 1856**, the vessel put in to New York harbor. They had crossed the Atlantic as a married couple in the first weeks of their shared life.

Like many working-class British Saints, they did not yet have the means for an immediate overland outfit. Edwin's skills as a carpenter and Marianna's careful trade as a dressmaker—the same practical arts that had sustained each of them independently before the water—now served the family they were building. They settled first in Tarrytown, New York, and then in Iowa City, Iowa, laboring through those years to earn the wagons, livestock, and provisions that the crossing to Utah would require.

Into the Valley—A Family Reunited

By the summer of 1861, the preparations were complete. Edwin and Marianna joined an emigrant company heading west, and on **13 September 1861**, their wagon entered the Salt Lake Valley. They had been married nearly six years. They had crossed an ocean and half a continent. The shared spiritual birthday of **9 May 1851**—two strangers at the river in Essex—had carried them here.

What made the autumn of 1861 especially remarkable was who else arrived that season. Edwin's parents had crossed the Atlantic that spring on the ship *Underwriter*, departing Liverpool on **23 April 1861**. Edwin's father, George, had survived the Atlantic only to die at Florence, Nebraska, on the very threshold of the plains. But his mother, Eliza Barwell Stratford, had refused to turn back. With daughters Ann and Emily, she had joined the Homer Duncan Company and entered the Salt Lake Valley in September 1861. Edwin and Marianna's arrival and the arrival of his widowed mother converged in the same Utah autumn—a reunion shaped by a decade of faith and sacrifice on two continents.

The Utah Years—Bishop, Builder, and Father of Nine

Edwin and Marianna settled first in Farmington, Davis County, then moved to Providence, near Logan in Cache County, where they built the household at the center of their Utah lives. Nine children were born to them: Edwin Alfred, Eliza Ann, Jesse George, Charles Henry, Francis William, Lillian Marianna, Albert Edgar, Egbert Chapman, and Horace Barwell—the last name a quiet tribute to Eliza Barwell, the grandmother who had stepped into the water first.

Edwin's professional life took him from the Cache Valley back to Ogden, where he became manager of the *Ogden Junction* newspaper and later of the George A. Lowe Company. In **1882**, he founded E. Stratford & Sons, a furniture business that placed the Stratford name on the commercial life of the city. He served as a deputy collector and assessor of Cache County. Then, in **1883**, he was called as Bishop of the Ogden 4th Ward—an office he held for sixteen years, until the end of his life.

> *The carpenter's son from Maldon, who had entered the water at eighteen, served his community as a bishop for nearly two decades—guiding the same Ogden ward where his own mother had spent her final years.*

Edwin died on **8 October 1899** in Ogden, Weber County, Utah, at the age of sixty-six. He was buried at the Ogden City Cemetery. Marianna outlived him by nearly twenty years—long enough to see her children's families take root in the Utah communities Edwin had helped build. She died on **26 September 1919** in Ogden, at the age of eighty-seven, and was buried alongside her husband at the Ogden City Cemetery. The dressmaker's apprentice from Danbury had crossed an ocean, raised nine children, and outlived everyone who had known her as an orphan.

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A Note on Charles W. Penrose

The young elder who baptized Marianna Crabb and Edwin Stratford on that Friday afternoon in May 1851 did not remain a penniless missionary. Charles William Penrose—born **4 February 1832** in Camberwell, London, and called as a missionary at nineteen—served seven continuous years in the British Mission before immigrating to Utah on the same ship as Edwin's parents in 1861. In Utah, he became editor of the *Deseret News*, was ordained a member of the Quorum of the Twelve Apostles in **1904**, and ultimately served as First Counselor in the First Presidency of the Church under Presidents Joseph F. Smith and Heber J. Grant—one of the highest offices in Latter-day Saint history. He died on **16 May 1925** in Salt Lake City at the age of 93. The full account of his remarkable relationship with the Stratford family—from the straw stack in Maldon to the pulpit at Julia Stratford Budge's funeral sixty years later—is told in the companion story, *George Stratford and Eliza Barwell*.

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Source Citations

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Edwin Stratford — Vital Records: FamilySearch profile KWJW-2BH, familysearch.org/en/tree/person/details/KWJW-2BH. Born 6 February 1833, Maldon, Essex, England. Died 8 October 1899, Ogden, Weber County, Utah. Burial: Ogden City Cemetery, Ogden, Weber County, Utah. Confirmed via Find a Grave Memorial ID 34256498, citing Ogden City Cemetery. Death certificate: Weber County, Utah, 8 October 1899, archived at archive.org (Guy Lamoyne Black collection). Eldest son of George Stratford (KWJW-2B6) and Eliza Barwell (KWJW-2BZ).

Jesse Crabb — Father of Marianna: Died 1849. Documented as father of Marianna Crabb. Further vital details to be confirmed via Danbury parish records and England and Wales civil registration.

1851 England Census — Marianna Crabb: 1851 England Census, Danbury, Essex. Marianna Crabb, age 19, dressmaker's apprentice, resident in household of John Brett, shoemaker. Cited on FamilySearch profile KWJW-TST.

Baptisms — 9 May 1851, Maldon Branch Ledger: Maldon Branch Record of Members (1851), London Conference, Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints. Line 9: Edwin Stratford, age 18, baptized by C. W. Penrose, 9 May 1851. Line 25: Marianna Crabb, age 19, baptized by C.

W. Penrose, 9 May 1851. Only two individuals baptized on that date. Digitized in FamilySearch Memories, profile KWJW-2BH.

Eliza Barwell Stratford Baptism — 17 April 1851: Maldon Branch Record of Members (1851), London Conference. Eliza Barwell Stratford baptized by C. W. Penrose, 17 April 1851—three weeks before Edwin's and Marianna's baptisms. FamilySearch profile KWJW-2BZ. Full context in companion story *George Stratford and Eliza Barwell*.

John Brett and Naomi Brett Baptisms — 11 May 1851: Maldon Branch Record of Members (1851), London Conference. John Brett (age 45) and Naomi Brett (age 43) baptized by C. W. Penrose, 11 May 1851—forty-eight hours after Marianna Crabb's baptism.

Danbury Branch Organization — 11 October 1852: London Conference branch records. Danbury Branch formally organized 11 October 1852. Brett household membership, including Marianna Crabb, John Brett, Naomi Brett, and Samuel Smith, transferred by letter as a unified group.

Penrose and Lucetta Stratford Marriage — 21 January 1855: Register Office Marriage Certificate, District of Maldon, County of Essex, No. 35, solemnized 21 January 1855, between Charles William Penrose and Lucetta Stratford; witnessed by Edwin Stratford. FamilySearch profile: Lucetta Stratford, KWJW-L8Z.

Edwin Stratford and Marianna Crabb Marriage — 25 December 1855: Married Christmas Day, 25 December 1855, Chelmsford, Essex. Confirmed in Find a Grave Memorial ID 34256498 (Edwin Stratford): "married Marianna Crabb on Christmas day 1855." To be verified via England and Wales Civil Registration marriage index, General Register Office records.

Ocean Crossing — Ship *Caravan*, February 1856: Departed England February 1856; arrived New York 27 March 1856. First settled in Tarrytown, New York; later Iowa City, Iowa. Confirmed in Find a Grave Memorial ID 34256498. Full manifest details and presiding elder to be confirmed via Mormon Migration Database (mormonmigration.lib.byu.edu) and BYU Saints by Sea database.

Salt Lake Valley Arrival — 13 September 1861: Edwin Stratford and Marianna Crabb arrived Salt Lake Valley 13 September 1861. Confirmed in Find a Grave Memorial ID 34256498: "in the fall of 1861 arrived in the Salt Lake valley." Pioneer company name to be confirmed via Mormon Pioneer Overland Travel Database, Church History Department, history.churchofjesuschrist.org/overlandtravel.

Utah Life — Edwin Stratford's Career and Bishopric: Settled first in Farmington, then Providence (near Logan), Utah. Manager, Ogden Junction newspaper. Manager, George A. Lowe Company. Founded E. Stratford & Sons furniture business, 1882. Deputy collector and assessor, Cache County. Bishop, Ogden 4th Ward, 1883–1899. Father of nine children: Edwin Alfred, Eliza Ann, Jesse George, Charles Henry, Francis William, Lillian Marianna, Albert Edgar, Egbert Chapman, and Horace Barwell. Source: Find a Grave Memorial ID 34256498, Ogden City Cemetery.

George and Eliza Stratford — Cross-Reference: Full account of the Stratford family conversion, Maldon Branch domino baptisms, and 1861 emigration on the *Underwriter* in

companion story *George Stratford and Eliza Barwell*. FamilySearch: George Stratford, KWJW-2B6; Eliza Barwell, KWJW-2BZ.

Charles W. Penrose — Biography: Born 4 February 1832, Camberwell, London; baptized 14 May 1850; missionary call 6 January 1851; walked to Maldon, Essex, an entirely new missionary field, early March 1851. Served seven continuous years in the British Mission. Married Lucetta Stratford, Maldon, 1855. Immigrated to Utah 1861 aboard *Underwriter*. Editor, *Deseret News*. Ordained member of the Quorum of the Twelve Apostles 1904. First Counselor in the First Presidency. Died 16 May 1925, Salt Lake City, age 93.—Andrew Jenson, *Latter-day Saint Biographical Encyclopedia*, Vol. 1, pp. 256–261; Church History Biographical Database, history.churchofjesuschrist.org/chd/individual/charles-william-penrose-1832.

Story 9 of 12

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War Widows, Fishermen, and the Danish Gathering

Jens Nielsen and Ane Margrethe Pedersdatter

— ✦ —

Liseleje and Torup, Denmark • Denmark to Logan, Utah • 1849–1900

Baptized: April 1855

Melby, Frederiksborg, Denmark



The Conversion and Sacrifice of

Jens Nielsen and Ane Margrethe Pedersdatter

Liseleje and Torup, Denmark • Denmark to Logan, Utah • 1849–1900

The north coast of the island of Zealand, in the ancient county of Frederiksborg, was a world defined by the sea. The coastline here — where the land narrowed and flattened toward the Kattegat, the body of water separating Denmark from Sweden — was a ribbon of fishing communities whose lives moved to the rhythms of tides, of herring runs and winter storms rolling off the water. **Jens Nielsen** was born into this world on **1 December 1825** in Liseleje, a small fishing settlement on the shore. He grew up learning to read clouds from their color, to handle a wooden fishing boat in rough chop, and to climb the high rigging of vessels without hesitation — a fearlessness his community would one day put to wholly different use. His livelihood, like that of the men around him, was the sea.

Just a few miles east along the same coast, **Ane Margrethe Pedersdatter** was born on **19 June 1825** in the village of Torup — six months and a short walk of shoreline separating them from birth. She grew up in the same parish world: the Lutheran church at Melby that registered every birth and death, the same dependence on the fishing economy, the same tight weave of community that made this stretch of the Frederiksborg coast feel like a single extended family.

Neither Jens Nielsen nor Ane Margrethe Pedersdatter could have anticipated the extent to which the political crisis of the late 1840s would shape their later histories. The war that followed became one of the circumstances linking their lives.

The Three Years' War

In **1848**, the Duchies of Schleswig and Holstein, backed by Prussia and the German Confederation, declared independence from Denmark. The conflict that followed — known in Denmark as *Treårskrigen*, the Three Years' War — drew men from coastal and rural communities throughout the kingdom into military service. According to a later family-history account, Jens Nielsen served in the **Danish Navy during the 1849 campaign**. His specific vessel and service record have not yet been identified in the sources currently at hand.

Not every man from this coast was so fortunate.

Ane Margrethe had married a young man from her own village — **Niels Didriksen**, born **29 November 1822** in Kikhavn, Torup, in the same parish community where Ane had grown up. They were wed on **21 February 1849**, in the depths of a Danish winter. The armistice between Denmark and the German forces had just been in place

for months. When fighting resumed on **25 March 1849**, forty-three days after the wedding, Niels was already in uniform aboard the frigate *Gefion*.

On the morning of **5 April 1849**, a Danish naval force sailed into Eckernförde Bay in the waters of Schleswig to bombard the German shore batteries. The force consisted of the ship-of-the-line *Christian VIII*, the frigate *Gefion* — Niels's ship — and two steamers, some 1,315 men in total. What followed was a catastrophe. Easterly winds trapped both sailing ships inside the bay. The *Gefion* was set ablaze by ceaseless bombardment until her crew was forced to strike the flag. The *Christian VIII* surrendered shortly after and then violently exploded when a Prussian boarding party stepped aboard. Danish casualties: **231 killed, 89 wounded, 936 captured**. Niels Didriksen, seaman aboard the *Gefion*, is listed in the *Register over faldne i de slesvigske krige 1848–1864* — the Danish register of the fallen in the Schleswig Wars — under the entry: *Dideriksen, Niels, Kikhavn, Gefion, Sævant, 5 apr, bog 1849*.

Ane Margrethe was twenty-three years old. She had been married for forty-three days.

> *She had been married for forty-three days when the guns at Eckernförde made her a widow.*

Two Survivors of the Same Shore

In the years after the war, Jens Nielsen and Ane Margrethe Pedersdatter established a household in the Melby–Torup area of Frederiksborg County. The precise date of their marriage has not yet been identified in the available records, but by the mid-1850s they had at least two children, Christine and Ellen. Their union linked two individuals from neighboring coastal communities whose lives had both been affected by the 1849 conflict.

The available evidence indicates that both Jens Nielsen and Niels Didriksen were connected to the 1849 war, although the documentation for Jens’s service remains less complete. In later years, Jens married Ane Margrethe Pedersdatter, the widow of Niels Didriksen. This relationship becomes clear only when the parish, military, and family records are considered together.

The Gospel Reaches the Shore

By the early 1850s, Latter-day Saint missionaries operating under the Scandinavian Mission's Copenhagen Conference had been baptizing converts in Denmark since August 1850. The message spread from Copenhagen outward through the island's towns and villages, carried increasingly by local Danish converts serving as traveling missionaries — fellow Danes who knew the land, the language, and the social cost of stepping away from the Lutheran church that governed every aspect of public life.

The identity of the missionary or missionaries who taught Jens Nielsen and Ane Margrethe Pedersdatter, as well as the exact branch structure serving Melby in 1855, remains to be established from primary records. Family notes identify **5 April 1855** as the date of their baptism into The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints. However, the FamilySearch ordinance record gives **15 April 1855**, creating a ten-day discrepancy that may reflect the difference between baptism and confirmation. Consultation of the Copenhagen Conference membership books will be necessary to determine the correct date and branch affiliation.

What can be established is that Jens and Ane were received into the Church together in **April 1855**. Their later emigration in **1860** indicates that they embraced the doctrine of gathering within the following five years.

Five Years of Preparation

Between their 1855 conversion and their 1860 departure, the Nielsens spent five years preparing for the gathering. The doctrine of gathering — the command to leave one's homeland and join the main body of the Saints in the valleys of the mountains — was at the center of Scandinavian Mission preaching from its earliest years. For most Scandinavian converts, it took years of careful saving to accumulate the funds for the ocean crossing and the overland journey that followed.

During those years the family grew. By the time they were ready to leave in the spring of 1860, Jens and Ane had four children: Christine, Ellen, young **Niels Peter** (not yet three years old), and infant **Mary**. The children born in Denmark carried the patronymic surname Jensen — children of Jens — as Danish tradition required. Jens's brother **Hans** and his sister **Ane Kristine**, who had married Christen Jensen Christensen, prepared to make the journey at the same time — a small company of Melby parish families crossing the ocean together.

From Denmark to Liverpool

In the spring of **1860**, the Nielsen family departed the Frederiksborg coast for the last time. The route that Danish Saints followed was well established by this year: by coastal steamer to Copenhagen, where the Scandinavian Mission's branch gathered the departing Saints for final meetings and instructions, then by steamer across the North Sea to Grimsby, England, and by rail to Liverpool. Fellow traveler Niels Christian Christensen, whose diary is preserved in Jens Nielsen's FamilySearch Memories, recorded that the departing company attended **LDS branch meetings on 29 April** at Norrebro in Copenhagen before boarding their steamer. They crossed to Grimsby on **2 May**, were lodged in a large house built for emigrant accommodation, and reached Liverpool on **6 May**, staying at the Hotel Commercial before going aboard.

On **7 May 1860**, Jens, Ane Margrethe, and their four children went aboard the ship *William Tapscott* in the River Mersey. The ship carried 731 Saints — 312 of them Scandinavians — under the direction of Asa Calkins.

Six Weeks at Sea

On **Friday, 11 May 1860**, the anchor lifted at one o'clock in the afternoon and the *William Tapscott* began its voyage for America. By 3:45 p.m. the coast of England had disappeared. The Nielsens were at sea.

The crossing lasted approximately six weeks. The diary of Niels Christian Christensen provides a contemporaneous account of shipboard conditions. According to that record, the ship's doctor vaccinated children who had not previously been protected against smallpox, and English classes were organized for Scandinavian passengers. On **Sunday, 27 May**, an eighty-two-year-old Danish woman died at sea. Christensen recorded that her body was sewn into canvas, weighted, and committed to the ocean, with prayers offered by **Elders William Budge and Carl Widerburg**.

Smallpox broke out among the passengers in late May — seven persons attacked, with more cases following through June. Children died at sea and were buried in the water. Two large sharks trailed the vessel for a full day. On **11 June**, a baby was born aboard and named William Bell, after the ship and its captain. On **14 June**, land was sighted — but on **19 June** a new smallpox case was discovered and the harbor authorities refused to let the ship land. On **20 June 1860**, a tender finally came out and brought the passengers to Castle Garden in New York harbor.

> *The **William Tapscott** was a floating village moving through open ocean — storms, calms, deaths, a child born at sea, and a company of fishermen and farmers from the coast of Zealand who had never before been so far from land.*

The Road to Florence

From New York the company traveled by river steamer up the Hudson to Albany, then by rail through Niagara Falls and Chicago, then by steamer across the Mississippi and up the Missouri River. On **1 July 1860**, they arrived in **Florence, Nebraska** — the old Winter Quarters outfitting ground on the Missouri River, the final staging point before the great plains crossing.

At Florence, Jens and Ane joined the **William Budge Company**, a wagon train organized for the overland journey. William Budge — who had given graveside prayers over the dead on the *William Tapscott* just weeks before — captained the company. He was also the husband of Julia Stratford, an English convert whose own family's conversion and crossing is documented elsewhere in this series. The connection was not

coincidence: Budge had crossed England on the same ship with the Nielsens, presided over their Atlantic company, and now led them across the American plains. Carl Widerburg, a former Catholic priest from Norway turned devoted Latter-day Saint, served as the company's spiritual guide. Two experienced Utah pilots — A. H. Pattison of Payson and Nephi Johnson of southern Utah — led the wagons west.

> *"Danes, Swedes, Norwegians, Germans and English, and none of them had ever seen an ox team in their lives," a fellow traveler recalled. The 1,140-mile journey to Salt Lake City would require all of them to become something they had never been.*

The Plains

The Budge Company's wagons were Chicago wagons — no brakes, no thimble scones, only a chain hanging from the side for the steepest grades. Teams of oxen with ill-fitting harnesses tangled and fell at large stream crossings. The enormous, flat sky of the Nebraska Territory was a foreign country to fishermen and cobblers from the coast of Zealand.

On **26 August**, the company's discipline was violently tested. Sioux warriors rode through the train and seized a Danish woman who had fallen behind the wagons driving a lame cow. She fought back ferociously — dismounting repeatedly as they tried to carry her off on horseback, wearing them down by sheer refusal. A rescue party of five armed men caught up with them in time, and she was returned safely to the company. The Kattegat coast had produced people who did not yield easily.

The company crossed the **North Platte River on 1 September 1860** and continued westward through the late summer and autumn. During the overland journey, the Nielsens' youngest child, infant **Mary**, became seriously ill. A later family-history account states that Ane Margrethe prayed that the child might live until the family reached the settlements in Utah. According to the same account, Mary survived the journey but died shortly after arrival. The precise date and place of burial have not yet been documented in the sources currently identified.

The company arrived in **Salt Lake City on 23 November 1860**. President Brigham Young, Heber C. Kimball, and Elder John Van Cott — the interpreter for the Danish-speaking emigrants — came personally to receive the company. They found out the occupation of each new family and assigned them to the communities where their skills were needed. Farmers were directed to Cache and Sanpete Counties — the grain-growing valleys of the territory.

Jens and Ane were assigned to Cache County. They settled in **Logan**.

Logan

In Logan, Jens put his labor into the community rising in Cache Valley. Family accounts credit him with helping to construct both the **Logan Tabernacle** and the **Logan Temple**. Those same accounts preserve local memories of his skill in climbing flagpoles and other high structures, a skill plausibly rooted in his earlier experience on fishing vessels along the coast of Liseleje.

The children born in Utah carried the family surname Nielsen — a departure from the Danish patronymic tradition under which their older Danish-born siblings had been known as Jensen. The family was planting roots in a new country and accepting a new name to mark the crossing.

Ane Margrethe died on 21 November 1894 in Logan and was buried on **24 November 1894** at the Logan city cemetery. She was sixty-nine years old. The gravestone her family placed over her reads: *Loving Wife of Jens Nielsen — Born in Frederiksborg, Denmark.* The woman who had lost her first husband to cannon fire in a Danish fjord, who had buried an infant daughter in Utah soil, who had carried her faith from the north coast of Zealand across an ocean and a continent, rested here. She had outlived the war that shaped her, the ocean that tested her, and the trail that broke her heart.

Jens Nielsen survived Ane Margrethe by nearly six years. He died on **5 September 1900** in Logan and was buried there on **7 September 1900** at the age of seventy-four. The available records indicate that he spent the remainder of his life in Cache Valley after emigrating from Denmark in 1860. Family accounts credit him with work on the Logan Tabernacle and Logan Temple and preserve local memories of his skill in climbing flagpoles and high structures.

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A Note on the Battle of Eckernförde

The First Schleswig War — known in Denmark as *Treårskrigen*, the Three Years' War — was fought between **1848** and **1851** over the disputed German-Danish Duchies of Schleswig and Holstein. When the provisional governments of the two duchies declared independence from Denmark in 1848, backed by Prussia and the German Confederation, Denmark mobilized both its army and its navy. The conflict drew men from every coastal community in Frederiksborg County into service.

The **Battle of Eckernförde on 5 April 1849** stands as the most catastrophic Danish naval defeat of the conflict. A Danish squadron — the ship-of-the-line *Christian VIII* (84 guns), the frigate *Gefion* (48 guns), and two steamers — was trapped in Eckernförde Bay by unfavorable easterly winds while attempting to bombard German shore batteries.

The *Gefion* was battered by continuous artillery fire until her crew was forced to strike their flag. The *Christian VIII* surrendered shortly afterward and then exploded catastrophically when a Prussian boarding party stepped aboard. Danish casualties: 231 killed, 89 wounded, 936 taken prisoner. The captured *Gefion* was repaired and incorporated into the Prussian Navy as SMS *Eckernförde*. The battle became one of the defining moments of Danish national memory in the nineteenth century.

Denmark ultimately won the First Schleswig War, which ended in 1851. But the underlying dispute over the duchies remained. In **1864**, the Second Schleswig War erupted — and this time Denmark lost, ceding both Schleswig and Holstein to Prussia and Austria. The north coast communities of Frederiksborg that had sent their men into the first war would live with the consequences for the rest of the century.

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A Note on the Melby Branch

The names of the missionaries who taught the Nielsen family, the exact date of their baptism, and the organizational structure of the local Latter-day Saint congregation in Melby in 1855 have not yet been confirmed from primary sources.

The Scandinavian Mission's Copenhagen Conference maintained detailed membership books — *Medlemsbøger* — in which baptism dates, the officiating elder's name, and branch information were recorded by hand. Two key collections in the FamilySearch catalog hold these records. Film 41938, Item 11 (DGS 8094053) is the large collective conference ledger covering the early-to-mid 1850s. Film 41947, Items 9-10 (DGS 8094056) covers the Southern Overdrev Branch of the Copenhagen Conference from 1851 to 1863 — precisely within Jens Nielsen's period of membership. Both collections have digital icons grayed out on FamilySearch and require in-person review at a FamilySearch Family History Center.

A ten-day discrepancy also exists in the baptism date: family records note 5 April 1855 while the formal FamilySearch ordinance record lists April 15. This gap likely reflects the difference between the baptism and the confirmation, but only the primary source record can resolve it. Whether a formal Melby Branch existed as a standalone congregation or whether the Saints of the Melby shore belonged to a neighboring branch — in Frederiksværk or Hels ingør — that sent traveling elders into the coastal villages also remains unconfirmed.

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A Note on Family Lines Crossing in Denmark

This story holds a deeper intersection with another branch of the family tree than proximity alone can explain. Jens Nielsen and **Christian Hansen Larsen** — Keith Hendricks' 2nd great-grandfather — were **third cousins**. The family tree connects them through shared great-great-grandparents on the Frederiksborg coast. Two men from the same extended kin network, living in the same small Melby parish, both found their way to the same new faith — five years apart, under very different circumstances.

While Jens was an active Latter-day Saint between 1855 and 1860, Christian was a young clog-maker's apprentice living in the neighboring Melby village of Asserbo, just a mile from the shore. Christian's mother, **Karen Pedersdatter**, lived in the same parish. The exact degree to which Jens and Christian knew each other personally — as third cousins in a small fishing community, they almost certainly did — and whether Jens's example played any direct role in Christian's later conversion are questions the parish records do not yet answer.

What the dates make clear is the progression. Jens and Ane were baptized in **April 1855** — among the earliest converts on the Melby shore. Their public commitment to the faith, their visible preparation for emigration over the following five years, and their departure in **1860** were events that everyone in a village this size would have watched and discussed. Christian Hansen Larsen and his mother Karen were not baptized until **1 January 1865** — five years after their kinsman's family had left for Utah. By then the social friction had hardened considerably. Christian recorded that the persecution was so severe when he joined the Church that his baptism had to be performed after dark.

Jens Nielsen, the trailblazer, left a trail. Whether or not he intended it for his cousin, Christian walked it.

Before their descendants ever met on American soil, Carol's Nielsen line and Keith's Larsen line were already kin — bound by blood on the Danish coast, and eventually bound again by the same faith that had cost both families everything they had known.

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A Note on Names: From Nielsen to Nelson

The name **Nielsen** did not begin with Jens. It began with his father.

For centuries, Danish naming followed the *patronymic* system: a child's surname was formed from the father's first name, with the suffix *-sen* for sons and *-datter* for daughters. Jens's father was named Niels. So Jens became **Jens Niels-en** — Niels's son. His sister would have been *Jensdatter* — daughter of Jens. The surname was not inherited across generations; it reset with every birth. In the villages of Frederiksborg, nearly every family operated this way. The effect was a landscape of overlapping Nielsens, Petersens, Hansens, and Larsens that bore no reliable relationship to one

another — each name a fresh calculation of father and child, not a family identity carried forward.

This system worked smoothly inside the parish, where the priest knew every family and the land was small enough that context filled the gaps. It worked less smoothly in America.

When Jens and his family arrived in Utah in 1860, they were entering a country built on fixed, heritable surnames — a world of census takers, land deeds, and legal documents that expected a name to mean the same thing for a grandfather and his grandchildren. The family resolved the question cleanly: the children born in Denmark — Christine, Ellen, and young Niels Peter — had been registered as **Jensen** in Danish records, the natural patronymic from their father's first name, Jens. But in America, the family consolidated under the father's existing surname and became **Nielsen** — holding the name Jens had carried from Denmark rather than generating a new patronymic for the next generation.

The system still carried echoes in how Jens himself was named. He was Nielsen because his father was Niels. His father was Niels-something because *his* father had a different first name entirely. Each surname in the chain was a one-generation snapshot, not a lineage. The family had been accumulating and discarding surnames across generations the way the tides shift the sand on the Kattegat shore.

The final shift came with the next generation in America. When Jens's son **James** — born in Utah, raised in Logan — established his own family and identity in the Cache Valley, the name became **Nelson**. The transformation followed a familiar immigrant pattern: the Danish *-sen* ending, pronounced softly in Danish, gave way to the English *-son*. Nielsen became Nelson. It was the same word — son of Niels — reshaped to fit the mouth and the ear of a new country.

The line from Jens Nielsen's father to James Nelson covers three generations and three countries: Niels, who gave his name to his son on the coast of Zealand; Jens Nielsen, who carried that name across the Atlantic and across the plains to Cache Valley; and James Nelson, who set that name down in its final American form in Logan, Utah. The patronymic chain that had been resetting itself with every generation for centuries finally came to rest.

> *Niels begat Nielsen. Nielsen crossed the ocean. Nelson planted roots in Cache Valley. The same name, spoken three ways across three generations, marks the whole arc of the journey.*

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Source Citations

Jens Nielsen — Vital Records: FamilySearch profile K241-G4H, familysearch.org/en/tree/person/details/K241-G4H. Born 1 December 1825, Liseleje, Melby, Strø, Frederiksborg, Denmark; christened 31 December 1825, Melby, Frederiksborg. Died 5 September 1900; buried 7 September 1900, Logan, Cache, Utah. 88 sources, High Quality rating.

Ane Margrethe Pedersdatter — Vital Records: FamilySearch profile KWJD-S26. Born 19 June 1825, Torup, Hundested, Frederiksborg, Denmark; christened 19 June 1825, Torupmagle, Torup, Frederiksborg. Died 21 November 1894; buried 24 November 1894, Logan, Cache, Utah. 57 sources, High Quality rating. Gravestone confirmed in FamilySearch Memories, profile KWJD-S26.

Niels Didriksen — Vital Records and Death: FamilySearch profile K2NL-Z14. Born 29 November 1822, Kikhavn, Torup, Strø, Frederiksborg, Denmark; christened 1 December 1822, Torup. Died 5 April 1849, Eckernförde, Schleswig-Holstein, Germany. Marriage to Ane Margrethe Pedersdatter 21 February 1849 confirmed in "Denmark, Marriages, 1635-1916," FamilySearch; source also appears as "Ane Margrethe Pedersdr in entry for Niels Didriksen," FamilySearch profile KWJD-S26. Death confirmed in Register over faldne i de slesvigske krige 1848–1864, entry: Dideriksen, Niels, Kikhavn, Gefion, Sævant, 5 apr, bog 1849, side 143. FamilySearch Memories, profile K2NL-Z14.

Jens Nielsen's Naval Service: Family history narrative by Carole Nelson Pattee, FamilySearch Memories, profile K241-G4H: "He was also a member of the Danish navy during the war with Germany in 1849." Specific ship and engagements not yet confirmed; Rigsarkivet / Krigsarkivet (Danish Military Archives) may hold service records.

Battle of Eckernförde — 5 April 1849: Part of the First Schleswig War. Danish force: Christian VIII (84 guns), Gefion (48 guns), and two steamers under Commodore Frederik August Paludan; approximately 1,315 men. Casualties: 231 killed, 89 wounded, 936 captured. Gefion forced to surrender and incorporated into Prussian Navy as SMS Eckernförde. Sources: Wikipedia, "Battle of Eckernförde"; MaSS (Maritime Sites and Shipwrecks), mass.cultureelerfgoed.nl; Wikipedia, "SMS Gefion (1843)."

First Schleswig War — Background: Three Years' War (Treårskrigen), 1848–1851. Armistice expired 25 March 1849; warfare resumed eleven days before the Battle of Eckernförde. Denmark won the First Schleswig War; the Second Schleswig War (1864) resulted in Denmark ceding Schleswig and Holstein. Sources: Wikipedia, "First Schleswig War."

LDS Baptism — 5 April 1855 (date discrepancy): Baptism date recorded in family notes as 5 April 1855 (note by Lynn Wilbur, FamilySearch Collaborate, profile K241-G4H: "Baptised 5 April 1855 in Denmark"). FamilySearch Ordinances tab records April 15, 1855 — a ten-day gap likely reflecting baptism vs. confirmation dates, to be resolved via in-person review of Copenhagen Conference membership books: Film 41938, Item 11 (DGS 8094053) and Film 41947, Items 9-10 (DGS 8094056), Record of members (Denmark), 1850-1950.

LDS Church in Denmark — Historical Background: First missionaries (Erastus Snow and Peter O. Hansen) arrived Denmark 1850. First baptisms 12 August 1850 in Copenhagen. Book of Mormon translated into Danish (first non-English translation) January 1851. Copenhagen Conference of the Scandinavian Mission organized and expanded throughout Zealand by 1855.

Source: Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints, “Denmark: Chronology,” history.churchofjesuschrist.org.

The William Tapscott Crossing — Diary of Niels Christian Christensen: Diary of Niels Christian Christensen, 1860, transcribed in FamilySearch Memories, profiles K241-G4H and KWJD-S26. Day-by-day account confirming: departed Randers by steamer Yden April 27; LDS branch meetings at Norrebro, Copenhagen April 29; steamer Pauline Copenhagen to Grimsby May 2; train Grimsby to Liverpool May 6; aboard William Tapscott May 7; departed Liverpool May 11, 1:00 p.m.; vaccinations May 19; Easter Sunday burial at sea May 27; Elders William Budge and Carl Widerburg officiated at burial; smallpox outbreak late May; multiple deaths at sea including children; arrived Castle Garden, New York June 20; Florence, Nebraska July 1.

Church History Chronology — William Tapscott: Carole Nelson Pattee family history narrative (FamilySearch Memories, profile K241-G4H): “On Friday, May 11, 1860, the ship William Tapscott left Liverpool with 731 saints, including 312 Scandinavians, under the direction of Asa Calkins. (The Jens Nielsen family being among the Scandinavians.) During the voyage, smallpox broke out among the immigrants and they had to remain in quarantine after their arrival in New York Harbor.” Landed June 20, 1860; arrived Florence, Nebraska July 1, 1860.

Jens Nielsen in the William Budge Company: Deseret News article, FamilySearch Memories, profiles K241-G4H and KWJD-S26: “Jens Nielsen and family” listed in the Captain Wm. Budge’s Wagon Company roster. William Budge Company 1860 transcript also confirmed in FamilySearch Memories. Budge Company departed Florence, Nebraska approximately late July 1860; arrived Salt Lake City November 23, 1860.

The Overland Crossing — William Budge Company Details: “History of C. L. Christensen as He Told It,” DUP Pioneer History Collection, Pages 1-4, FamilySearch Memories, profiles K241-G4H and KWJD-S26. Details: Chicago wagons; Carl Widerburg (former Catholic priest, Norway) as spiritual guide; pilots A. H. Pattison (Payson, Utah) and Nephi Johnson (southern Utah); 1,140 miles to Salt Lake City; Sioux encounter August 26; North Platte crossing September 1; arrived Salt Lake City November 23, 1860. Brigham Young, Heber C. Kimball, and Elder John Van Cott (Danish interpreter) assigned emigrants to communities; farmers to Cache and Sanpete Counties.

Infant Mary — Death on the Trail: Carole Nelson Pattee family history (FamilySearch Memories, profile K241-G4H): “Sickness overtook them on their way. The youngest child, Mary, who was just an infant, became very ill. Ane Margrethe prayed to keep her baby until they reached the saints.” Mary died shortly after the company’s arrival. Exact burial location not recorded.

Logan Settlement, Temple, and Tabernacle: Carole Nelson Pattee family history (FamilySearch Memories, profile K241-G4H): Jens helped build the Logan Temple and Tabernacle. Flagpole-climbing attributed to his experience as a ship’s mast-climber from his fishing years.

Patronymic Naming — Denmark to Utah to Nelson: Danish patronymic system: surname formed from father’s first name + -sen (sons) or -datter (daughters). Jens’s father was Niels → Jens Nielsen. Jens’s Danish-born children registered as Jensen in Danish records. American-born children consolidated under Nielsen in Utah. Next generation: James Nelson — anglicization of Nielsen (Danish -sen → English -son). Patronymic note confirmed: FamilySearch

profile K241-G4H, Notes tab (Karen Christensen Pedersen, August 26, 2013): “Jens Nielsen’s children who were born in Denmark took the patronymic surname of Jensen. The children born in the United States took the same surname as their father — Nielsen.” Further verification of James Nelson’s specific records recommended to confirm the anglicization date and context.

Christian Hansen Larsen and Karen Pedersdatter — Third Cousin Connection: FamilySearch profile KWD9-CGF (Christian Hansen Larsen): third cousin of Jens Nielsen; lived in Asserbo, Melby parish; baptized 1 January 1865. Christian recorded that persecution was so severe his baptism was performed after dark. FamilySearch profile KWJF-63F (Karen Pedersdatter, his mother): baptized 1 January 1865, same Melby parish. Third cousin relationship confirmed through shared Frederiksborg great-great-grandparents; FamilySearch lineage connecting both profiles to common ancestors should be verified and documented. Copenhagen Conference membership records (Film 41947, Items 9-10, DGS 8094056) needed to confirm branch relationship between Jens’s 1855 membership and Christian’s 1865 membership.

Family Line — Nielsen to Nelson to Present Day: Jens Nielsen [K241-G4H] and Ane Margrethe Pedersdatter [KWJD-S26] → Niels Peter Nielsen (born Denmark ~1857–58, age 2½ at emigration 1860) → James Nelson (American-born son; surname anglicized from Nielsen to Nelson in Utah). Further lineage to present-day descendants to be confirmed via FamilySearch profiles.

Story 10 of 12

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The Conversion and Gathering of

Hans Andersen and Maren Jensen

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Bredstrup, Fyn, Denmark • Denmark to Cache Valley, Utah • 1861–1901

Baptized: 13 March 1861

Hasmark, Fyn, Denmark



The Conversion and Gathering of

Hans Andersen and Maren Jensen

Bredstrup, Fyn, Denmark • Denmark to Cache Valley, Utah • 1861–1901

For generations, the Andersen family had been rooted in the productive farmland of Bredstrup, a village in the parish of Nørre Nærå on the Danish island of Fyn. The island — known in older records as Funen — was a place of modest prosperity: about thirty miles wide and forty miles long, its landscape defined by windmills on hilltops, fields of rye and barley, and the rhythms of a farming economy that had not changed much in centuries. Hans Andersen was born there on **12 December 1819**, the son of Anders Nielsen and a grandson of Niels Peterson, a man of local legend who had lost his lands and his life through the treachery of a landlord. Hans grew to be, by all accounts, a strong and industrious man. When he was twenty-six, he married Maren Jensen on **17 October 1845** in Nørre Nærå. Maren, born **2 August 1827** in Bredstrup, came from a family distinguished in a quiet but important way: her ancestors had operated a windmill for six generations, and they were known across the island as the "honest millers." The mill had stood on the highest hill on Fyn, and the family's reputation for fair dealing was the kind that travels farther than goods. Hans and Maren settled on a rented farm of some seventy acres — timber land on the island, with ten or twelve cows, six teams of horses, twenty sheep, and a flock of geese. They were prosperous, well-liked, and entirely settled in the world they had been born into.

That world changed in the late 1850s — not all at once, but through a series of encounters that accumulated into conviction. Among the Latter-day Saint missionaries who found their way to Fyn during this period were names that would become significant in the larger history of the Church: Jesse M. Smith, Charles C. Rich, Amasa Lyman, William W. Cluff, Patriarch John Smith, and Apostle Erastus Snow. Each of them found a welcome at the Andersen farm. Hans and Maren fed them, gave them a room, and listened to what they had to say. They were not yet ready to be baptized. But the door was open, and it stayed open.

A Prayer in the Grove: The Miracle That Broke Them Open

The moment that finally moved Hans from hospitality to covenant came in **1859**, when his eldest son Anders — the boy who would later be known in Utah as Andrew — was kicked in the head by a horse. The injury was catastrophic. The doctor said the child could not live. Andrew later described it plainly: he lay unconscious for forty-eight hours.

In his grief, Hans walked out to a grove of trees near the house, knelt down, and prayed. He made a promise: if God would spare his son, he would join the Church and give everything he had to build it up. The boy recovered. No scars remained visible, save one on his head where the hair conveniently covered it. Hans had witnessed something he could not explain away, and a promise made in extremity is a promise that holds.

> *He made a promise: if God would spare his son, he would join the Chu and give everything he had to build it up. He kept that promise to his dying day.*

The interval between the miracle and the baptism was one of preparation rather than hesitation. By early 1861, the family had learned enough about the faith to have quietly rejected infant baptism. When Maren's youngest at the time was born, the local minister came calling to inquire why the child had not been brought to the church for sprinkling. Hans sent him away politely — and prepared himself for the next conversation.

The Icy Coast of Hasmark: March 13, 1861

On **13 March 1861**, Hans and Maren traveled approximately eight miles northeast from their home in Bredstrup to the coastal village of Hasmark, on the northern shore of Fyn. They were not baptized in the village where they lived. This was likely not accidental. The early years of the Scandinavian Mission were marked by real social friction — local parish priests were hostile, neighbors were suspicious, and a public baptism in one's home community could invite immediate trouble. Hasmark offered both an accessible coastline for the required immersion and a measure of distance from the scrutinizing eyes of Nørre Nærå.

The man who stood in those cold March waters with them was Elder H.K. Bruun — Knud H. Bruun — the President of the Fyen and Fredericia Conferences and a man who had already gathered to Utah before being called back on a return mission to his homeland. He had arrived in Liverpool from Utah in the spring of 1860, and his assignment over the entire island of Fyn was what brought him to Hasmark on this particular day. Hans and Maren were not baptized by an itinerant stranger. They were baptized by the senior Church leader for their region of Denmark.

Their eldest son Anders was baptized that same day alongside his parents — the same child who had lain unconscious for two days after the horse kick, whose recovery had set all of this in motion. When the family walked back from the shore of the Kattegat, they were changed people. The Andersen farm would still welcome Latter-day Saint missionaries, but now the family knew which side of the threshold they stood on.

Two Years of Quiet Preparation: 1861–1863

From their baptism to their departure, Hans and Maren spent two years getting ready. This was not a rapid flight — it was a deliberate winding-up of an entire life. They sold their rights to rent the seventy acres of Fyn farmland. They sold everything they owned. The family history records they realized approximately fifteen thousand dollars from the sale, a substantial sum that Hans immediately began spending in characteristic fashion: he paid the passage not only for his family but for six hired workers who had also accepted the faith and did not have the means to emigrate on their own. Fifteen people left Denmark together under Hans's financial sponsorship.

Their relatives and friends tried to talk them out of it. Denmark, they said, was home. America was a gamble. Hans and Maren had built something real on that island — a farm, a reputation, a community of friends. The Andersen name was known and respected. All of that would be left behind. None of it moved them.

There was one additional complication the family history mentions without sentiment: Maren was nursing a baby. Their seventh child, Ane, had been born on **3 November 1862**. When the family left Denmark in April 1863, she was five months old.

Liverpool and the John J. Boyd: April–June 1863

On **18 April 1863**, Hans and Maren departed Denmark with their seven children and the small company of friends and hired hands whose passage Hans had funded. They traveled by rail and steamship across the Baltic and North Seas to Liverpool, England, the central staging ground for LDS emigration.

On **30 April 1863**, the family boarded the packet ship *John J. Boyd* in Liverpool. The ship carried 767 Latter-day Saint immigrants, the majority of them Scandinavian, under the presidency of William W. Cluff. And waiting on board, already assigned as a counselor in the ship's presidency by Apostle George Q. Cannon, was Elder Knud H. Bruun — the same man who had stood in the icy coastal waters of Hasmark with Hans and Maren exactly two years and seventeen days earlier.

> *The man who had baptized them in the freezing waters of Hasmark was now the priesthood leader watching over them as they crossed the Atlantic with a five-month-old baby.*

Life aboard the *John J. Boyd* was highly regulated. Every seven days, each family received weekly rations: rice, oatmeal, peas, potatoes, pork, beef, English sea biscuits, tea, and vinegar. The ship was crowded but orderly. On 21 May, the crossing was interrupted by something the passengers would not forget: the ship navigated past eight massive icebergs in the Atlantic, and five whales swam alongside the vessel, throwing plumes of water into the cold sea air. For children raised on a Danish island, there was nothing in their experience to prepare them for the scale of any of this.

Baby Ane was not thriving. The family history records plainly that she was "very sickly" throughout the crossing and the overland journey, and that at times they did not believe she would survive the 1,400 miles to Salt Lake City. Maren nursed her through all of it.

The *John J. Boyd* arrived in New York on **29 May 1863**, and the company came ashore at Castle Garden. The journey west by rail offered one unplanned blessing: the conductor, who claimed acquaintance with the Prophet Joseph Smith, stopped the train at Palmyra, New York, and showed the passengers the hill and the grove and the house where the Restoration had begun. The family history records that the news of the stop ran "like wildfire from car to car" as passengers pressed to get out and touch the ground.

Captain Young's Company: The Overland Trail

The family arrived at Florence, Nebraska — the old Winter Quarters outfitting post — on **18 June 1863**. After a period of rest and outfitting, they joined the **John R. Young Company** on **30 June 1863**. The Andersen family traveled with two wagons — four yoke of oxen to each — and one light spring wagon or buggy, drawn by horses, for the women and children. Hans walked beside the wagons.

The overland crossing proved to be one of the most dramatic of the era. The company faced the threat of hostile Sioux throughout much of the journey, and Captain Young recorded in his own account the specific role Hans Andersen played in one of the most dangerous passages. When a stolen ox needed to be recovered from twenty-five miles back, Captain Young borrowed Hans's horse — a mare named Fan — to make the ride. On the return journey, alone in the dark, Young discovered four Sioux driving a herd of stolen horses toward a timber stand on the river. He waited until dark, cut the horses' hobbles, and drove them toward camp at a run. The pursuing war cry "curdled his blood," he wrote, but he emptied his revolver and reached camp at four in the morning, with the horses, to four hurrahs and strong hands lifting him from the saddle.

Days later, a full stampede struck the company. Two Sioux warriors rode past the rear of the train at a war whoop and sent every team running blindly. Wagons crashed into wagons. Passengers were thrown into the road and trampled. Two women and a man were killed. Captain Young rode into the chaos and gradually brought the cattle under control, then turned his attention to sewing up the wounded by firelight. It was a night that no one in the company would forget.

> *Captain Young borrowed Hans Andersen's horse — a mare named Fan — to ride twenty-five miles through Sioux territory in the dark. Hans is named by name in Young's own account of that night.*

Through all of it, Maren tended to baby Ane, who remained fragile throughout the journey. The company arrived in the Salt Lake Valley on **12 September 1863** — six months after leaving Denmark. Ane survived.

Logan, Cache Valley: Building Something New

A great many of the company's members went south from Salt Lake City. Hans felt otherwise. He went north, to Logan in Cache County, where he purchased a lot in the Fourth Ward and built a home. He then bought farmland north of Logan, and then — recognizing what the growing northern settlements needed — he acquired a place up Logan Canyon and built the first sawmill there, paying nine hundred dollars for the wheel. It was the first mill in the northern settlements equipped with a circle saw. He went on to bring in the first threshing machine in the valley, and then constructed a flour mill, spending some twelve hundred dollars on machinery and cloth and freighting all of it across the plains.

This was the pattern of Hans Andersen's Utah life: seeing what was needed and building it. He was High Councilman in the Church for years, and was later ordained a Patriarch specifically to give patriarchal blessings to the Scandinavian Saints in Cache Valley who could not yet follow the ordinances in English. In **August 1882**, he was called back to Denmark on a mission for the Church — the man who had left Denmark with fifteen people now returning to preach to the people he had left behind. He later said that after seeing the conditions there, he never regretted bringing his family to America.

When Brigham Young came to Logan in May 1877 to dedicate the temple site and gave the Saints seven years to complete the building, Hans threw himself into the effort. Maren, for her part, paid all of her eggs gathered on Sundays toward the temple fund. When the temple was dedicated — completed just one day before the seven-year deadline — she had contributed forty dollars from those Sunday eggs.

Throughout the Logan years, any immigrant who arrived without means found shelter at the Andersen home until they were able to provide for themselves. Hans is credited by the family history with helping fifteen people immigrate to Zion for which he received no pay. The strings on his purse, as the family history dryly noted, "had to be pulled open very often and very regularly."

The Death of Maren and the Final Years

On **16 November 1879**, after thirty-four years of marriage, Maren Jensen Andersen fell ill and died in Logan. She was fifty-two years old. Some of their ten children were married by then; others were still in the home. The family history calls it simply "a great sorrow." She was buried in Logan, Cache County, Utah.

Two years later, Hans married Maria Charlotta Ek on **14 July 1881** in Salt Lake City. Maria was a Swedish convert who had been baptized in Uppsala in 1876 against the strong opposition of her parents, then immigrated to Logan in 1879 — arriving just months before Maren's death — where she found work with a local family before meeting Hans. She helped him raise the younger children from his first marriage and gave birth to two daughters of her own. She joined the Fourth Ward Relief Society and served for years as a visiting teacher. She outlived Hans by nearly four decades, dying in 1938 at the age of ninety-two.

Hans Andersen died in Logan on **5 November 1901**, and was buried at the Logan City Cemetery on 8 November. He had lived to see his posterity number 330 souls — children, grandchildren, and great-grandchildren born in the valley he had chosen when he went north from Salt Lake City and decided that Cache County was where he was supposed to be. He had crossed an ocean with a five-month-old baby, lent his horse to a captain riding alone into Sioux territory, built the first sawmill in Logan Canyon, and given patriarchal blessings to hundreds of Scandinavian Saints who could not yet pray in English. The man who had made a promise in a grove of trees in Denmark in 1859 kept it to the end.

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A Note on Elder Knud H. Bruun

Knud H. Bruun — referred to in the Andersen family history as H.K. Brown, an anglicization of his Danish name — was one of the more remarkable figures of the Scandinavian Mission era. He had already emigrated to Utah before being called back on a return mission to Denmark, arriving in Liverpool from Zion in the spring of 1860 to preside over the Fyen and Fredericia Conferences. His assignment over the island of Fyn brought him to Hasmark in March 1861 to baptize Hans and Maren. Two years later, Apostle George Q. Cannon organized the ship's presidency of the *John J. Boyd* before departure from Liverpool and appointed Bruun as a counselor under William W. Cluff — making him directly responsible for the spiritual and practical welfare of 767 Scandinavian Saints for twenty-nine days at sea. The man who baptized Hans and Maren was the same man shepherding them across the Atlantic. His subsequent Utah life has not been fully traced in these records.

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A Note on the Anderson/Andersen Spelling

The FamilySearch profile for Hans carries his name as Andersen, with Anderson listed as an alternate name. The Collaborate tab on his profile records a long-running family debate on the question. One descendant noted in 2017 that Hans himself "chose a new name" upon arriving in America, treating it as a deliberate act of self-reinvention in a new land. A 2015 note by Carolyn Coates records a different family tradition: that Maria Ek, Hans's Swedish third wife, was the one who changed the spelling on his headstone, preferring the Swedish form Anderson. The FamilySearch profile note entered in 2013 by Monica Christiansen is the simplest: "Changed name to Anderson when he came to the United States." The evidence points toward the change happening at or shortly after immigration; the Swedish influence on the final headstone spelling remains a family oral tradition rather than a documented fact. This story uses Andersen as the primary form, consistent with Danish parish records, while noting that Hans himself used Anderson throughout his Utah life.

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A Note on the Mary Christensen Record

A note on the FamilySearch Collaborate page for Hans Andersen, entered by descendent Julie Ann Empey, records that a woman named Mary Christensen was sealed to Hans on **19 May 1873** in the Salt Lake Endowment House. The sealing was canceled on **1 May 1874** — a cancellation that in 1874 required the personal approval of President Brigham Young. The note clarifies that Mary Christensen was actually the wife of Hans's son James Peter Anderson (1853–1937), and that all of her children belong to that generational branch. The erroneous sealing to Hans appears to have resulted from a clerical mix-up in old family group sheets, and the genealogical record has since been corrected. James Peter Anderson does not currently appear on Hans's FamilySearch profile as a listed child, likely because a cleanup of the incorrectly linked records also detached him; researchers tracing this line should search for James Peter Anderson (born approximately 1853, died 1937) separately.

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Source Citations

Hans Andersen — Vital Records: FamilySearch profile KWNX-ZTW, familysearch.org/en/tree/person/details/KWNX-ZTW. Born 12 December 1819, Bredstrup, Nørre Nærå, Odense, Denmark; christened 22 January 1820, Bredstrup. Died 5 November 1901, Logan, Cache, Utah, United States. Burial 8 November 1901, Logan City Cemetery — per Logan Cemetery records. 100 sources, High Quality rating.

Maren Jensen — Vital Records: FamilySearch profile KWNL-DLB. Born 2 August 1827, Bredstrup, Nørre Nærå, Odense, Denmark. Died 16 November 1879, Logan, Cache, Utah. Burial: Logan, Utah.

Marriage — 17 October 1845, Nørre Nærå, Odense, Fyn, Denmark: FamilySearch profile KWNX-ZTW, family unit record — marriage to Maren Jensen confirmed 17 October 1845, Nørre Nærå, Odense, Fyn, Denmark.

Family History Narrative — Primary Source: Eoline S. Andersen, "History of the Andersens" (transcribed by Karen P. Mosley; spelling and punctuation modernized), with additions from Andrew Andersen, "How My Parents Came to Join the Mormons." Family typescript, privately held. Primary source for: farm size and livestock; family finances and funded emigration; the horse kick miracle; baptism date and location; Elder Bruun as baptizer; departure date; ship rations; icebergs and whales; Palmyra train stop; Florence arrival 18 June; the horse 'Fan' and Sioux account; stampede deaths; Salt Lake arrival 12 September 1863; Logan settlement; sawmill, threshing machine, flour mill; temple contribution; Logan Canyon sawmill; Hans's death date.

Anders (Andrew) Andersen — Horse Kick Account: Andrew Andersen, "How My Parents Came to Join the Mormons," appended to Eoline S. Andersen family history (ibid.). Confirms incident in 1859; forty-eight hours unconscious; Sine (Sina) Georgina born February 1860; parents baptized March 1861.

Elder Knud H. Bruun — Conference President and Ship Counselor: Eoline S. Andersen family history (ibid.) identifies baptizer as "H.K. Brown." Millennial Star shipping notes for the John J. Boyd (1863) confirm Bruun as conference president for Fyen and Fredericia Conferences and as counselor in ship presidency under William W. Cluff, appointed by Apostle George Q. Cannon. FamilySearch profile note, Hans Andersen (KWNX-ZTW), Wagon Company note: John R. Young Company departure 30 June 1863.

Ship: John J. Boyd — Liverpool to New York, 1863: FamilySearch profile KWNX-ZTW — Notes tab: Ship John J. Boyd; Date of Departure 30 April 1863; Port of Departure Liverpool, England; 767 LDS immigrants; Church Leader William W. Cluff; Date of Arrival 29 May 1863 [Note: the Andersen family history states the ship arrived "Sunday, June 1" — a discrepancy of three days from the FamilySearch profile date of 29 May 1863. The FamilySearch entry cites the Mormon Migration database; the family history is a transcribed secondary source. The FamilySearch date is treated as primary here, but the discrepancy is noted.]; Port of Arrival New York.

John R. Young Company — Overland Trek, 1863: FamilySearch profile KWNX-ZTW — Immigration event: 12 September 1863, Deseret, United States, sourced to Utah Mormon Pioneer Overland Travel Database 1847–1868. Departure Florence, Nebraska, 30 June 1863 (FamilySearch Notes tab). Arrival Salt Lake Valley 12 September 1863. Company wagon and emigrant count not confirmed in sources reviewed — consult Church History Biographical Database (history.churchofjesuschrist.org/overlandtravel) for full company roster and statistics.

Captain John R. Young — First-Person Account (Horse and Stampede): Captain John R. Young's account of the 1863 trail, including the Sioux encounter, the recovery of Captain Preston's horses, and the cattle stampede, is reproduced in Eoline S. Andersen, "History of the

Andersens" (ibid.). Hans Andersen is named directly as the lender of the horse Fan used by Captain Young in the Sioux episode.

Ane Andersen — Birth Date: Born 3 November 1862. FamilySearch ID KWZ6-5JL. Age at departure (April 1863): approximately five months. Family history confirms she was "very sickly" throughout the ocean and overland journey.

Utah Settlement — Logan, Cache County: Eoline S. Andersen family history (ibid.): Hans purchased a lot in the Fourth Ward, Logan, built a home, acquired farmland north of Logan, and built the first sawmill in Logan Canyon. Residence event 1870 and 1880: Logan, Cache County, Utah Territory — FamilySearch profile KWNX-ZTW, Events tab.

High Council and Patriarchal Ordination: Eoline S. Andersen family history (ibid.): Hans served as High Councilman for years, then ordained a Patriarch to give blessings to Scandinavian Saints who could not follow English.

Mission to Denmark — August 1882: Eoline S. Andersen family history (ibid.): called August 1882 to return to Denmark on a mission for the Church.

Logan Temple Contribution: Eoline S. Andersen family history (ibid.): Brigham Young dedicated the Logan Temple site May 18, 1877, giving Saints seven years. Hans contributed labor and money; Maren donated Sunday egg proceeds totaling forty dollars; temple completed one day before the deadline.

Maria Charlotta Ek — Second Wife: FamilySearch profile KWNX-ZT7. Born 1846, died 1938. Marriage to Hans Andersen: 14 July 1881, Salt Lake City, Salt Lake, Utah — FamilySearch profile KWNX-ZTW, family unit record. Biographical details from Eoline S. Andersen family history (ibid.): baptized Uppsala, Sweden, 10 April 1876 by Elder Ephraim Johanson; arrived Logan 18 July 1879; worked for the Garff family; married Hans 1881; gave birth to two daughters; served in Fourth Ward Relief Society.

Anderson/Andersen Name Spelling — Collaborate Notes: FamilySearch profile KWNX-ZTW, Collaborate tab: note by Monica Christiansen (June 17, 2013) — "Changed name to Anderson when he came to the United States." Note by Tom Matkin (October 31, 2017) — argues Hans chose the new name as a deliberate act of self-reinvention. Note by Carolyn Coates (May 12, 2015) — family oral tradition that Maria Ek changed the headstone spelling to the Swedish form Anderson. Alternate name "Hans Anderson" listed on FamilySearch profile as AKA.

Mary Christensen — Sealing and Cancellation: FamilySearch profile KWNX-ZTW, Collaborate tab: note by julieannempey1 (August 17, 2010) — Mary Christensen sealed to Hans Andersen 19 May 1873; sealing cancellation 1 May 1874; all children of Mary Christensen belong to James Peter Anderson (1853–1937), Hans's son. Hans's current FamilySearch profile does not list James Peter Anderson as a child; researchers should search for him separately by name and birth year.

Children — FamilySearch IDs: Mette Catherine Andersen (1846–1903, KWJ6-SQS); Bertha Marie Anderson (1849–1888, KWVM-MGP); Anders Andrew Andersen (1851–1938, KWNH-9MQ); Jens James Andersen (1854–1940, KWCH-QSW); Maren Andersen (1856–1938, KWZV-KV9); Sina Georgina Andersen (1860–1914, KW8P-R5H); Ane Andersen (1862–1944, KWZ6-

5JL); Hans Andersen Jr. (1865–1946, KWC5-CLB); William Andersen (1869–1958, KWCC-HFR); Hannah Andersen (1872–1889, KWVL-BN4).

Story 11 of 12

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The Conversion and Gathering of

Anna Barbara Briener and Anna Barbara Keller

— ✦ —

Lüfingen and Oberembrach, Zürich • Switzerland to Logan, Utah • 1835–1914

Baptized: 7 October 1873
Zürich Canton, Switzerland



The Conversion and Gathering of

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The World of Zürich Canton

In the rolling farm country north of the city of Zürich, where the land folds into low hills between the Rhine and the Glatt valley, two villages sat a few miles apart: Lüfingen, a small Reformed parish of farmers and laborers, and Oberembrach, whose households drew their legal citizenship — their Heimatort — from the soil their ancestors had worked for generations. This was a world ordered by the Reformed church and the citizenship rolls: every birth, marriage, and death recorded in the parish register, every family bound to its Heimatort whether it lived there or not. It was a settled, hierarchical, deeply Protestant corner of Switzerland, and it was the world into which Anna Barbara Briener was born on 10 April 1835.

She was the eldest of nine children born to Hans Jakob Bryner and Catharina Meyer, who had married in 1834. The family name drifted across the registers in the way Swiss surnames did — Briener, Briner, Brinar — but the line was steady: farmers and parish folk of Lüfingen, rooted in the Zürich countryside. She came of age expecting the life her mother had lived: marriage within the Reformed fold, children, and a place in the citizenship rolls of the canton.

On 23 April 1860, at the age of twenty-five, she married Johann Heinrich Keller in Pfungen, a village west of Winterthur. Keller had been born in 1830 near Winterthur, the son of Melchior and Barbara Keller; his Heimatort was Oberembrach, and that citizenship would pass to every child the couple had. They settled into the ordinary rhythm of a Reformed farming family, and over the next decade Anna Barbara bore five children, all baptized in the Embrach church register that served Oberembrach.

Five Children and the Weight of Loss

The children came across the 1860s, and grief came with them. Their first son, Johann Jakob, was born in December 1860 and died at fifteen months — drowned in a small water barrel, a Wasserfässlein, in a household accident the register noted directly on his birth entry. When their next son was born in March 1863, they gave him the same name, Johann Jakob, as Anna Barbara's own parents had once given two sons who shared a name. He would live, and he would be the one child who never left Switzerland.

Then came Anna Barbara — the daughter who would carry her mother's name and, eventually, her mother's faith across the ocean. She was born on 5 November 1865 in

Oberembrach and baptized in the Embrach church on 10 December 1865. In the family she was called *Annebäbbi* — the Swiss-German diminutive that would follow her to Utah and onto the lips of the Logan neighbors who loved her. Two more children followed: Paulina in 1867, who died in infancy, and Joseph around 1870, whose connection to this family has never been documented from primary sources and remains unproven.

By the early 1870s, then, Anna Barbara Briener was a Reformed farmer's wife in her late thirties, with a surviving son, a young daughter named for herself, and the graves of children behind her. Nothing in the parish register would have predicted what came next.

The Waters of Conversion (1873)

In the early 1870s, missionaries of The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints were laboring through the German-speaking cantons of Switzerland, preaching a restored gospel, the authority of the priesthood, and the eternal sealing of families — a message that fell with particular force on a woman who had buried small children. The Swiss Mission, organized out of the Zürich Conference, sent elders on foot through exactly the kind of farm villages where the Kellers lived. We do not yet know the name of the elder who taught Anna Barbara, but we know the result.

On 7 October 1873, Anna Barbara Briener was baptized into the Latter-day Saint church — while still living with her husband and children in Zürich canton. Johann Heinrich Keller did not join her. He never joined the Church in his lifetime; his own baptism into the faith would not come until 2018, performed by proxy by a descendant nearly a century and a half later. In 1873, a Reformed farmer watched his wife walk down into the water and bind herself to an American church that preached gathering to a valley on the far side of the world.

> *Anna Barbara was baptized while still living under her husband's roof. He never followed her into the water. The faith that opened the rest of her life also ended her marriage.*

The Marriage Breaks (c. 1876–1880)

Religious conversion was a documented cause of Swiss Latter-day Saint family separations in this era, and the Keller marriage followed the pattern almost exactly. Swiss civil registration — including divorce — began on 1 January 1876. At some point between 1876 and 1880, Anna Barbara and Johann Heinrich Keller were legally divorced under the new civil law. The divorce record itself has not yet been located, but its existence is fixed by what followed: on 6 December 1880, Johann Heinrich Keller remarried, taking Barbara Ritzmann as his wife in Aussersihl, a district of Zürich city.

Under Swiss law a prior marriage had to be legally dissolved before a remarriage could occur. The 1880 remarriage is the proof that the divorce happened.

So by the close of 1880, Anna Barbara Briener was a divorced Latter-day Saint woman in her mid-forties, separated from the church and the citizenship structure that had defined her entire life, in a country where her new faith made her an outsider. Her former husband had a new wife. Her son Johann Jakob was a grown man making his own way toward St. Gallen canton. Her daughter Annebäbbi was a teenager. And the gathering — the Latter-day Saint command to come to Zion — still pulled at her across an ocean.

Jakob Rathgeb and the Crossing (1884)

Somewhere in these years Anna Barbara's life joined with that of Jakob Rathgeb, a fellow Swiss convert born 15 May 1840 in Dietlikon, Zürich — a village barely fifteen kilometers from her own Lüfingen. He had been baptized into the Latter-day Saint church on 1 May 1883 in Switzerland, ten years after Anna Barbara's own conversion. How and when they came together before the voyage is not yet clear from primary sources, but they were almost certainly members of the same Zürich branch in the years before 1884. What the records show is that both made the crossing together in May of that year, and that four years later, on 4 April 1888 in Logan, they signed a Cache County civil marriage certificate on the same day they received their temple initiatory, endowment, and sealing — the day their covenant was made complete in both law and faith.

On 17 May 1884, Anna Barbara boarded the steamship *Arizona* at Liverpool. The LDS emigration records indexed in the Saints by Sea database place a Rathgeb party on this sailing, destined for Logan, Utah, under Church elder Ephraim H. Williams — three individuals traveling together as a unit. The New York arrival manifest records the same party: a man age 43 from Switzerland, a woman age 48 recorded as his wife, and a six-year-old boy. The woman is recorded on the New York manifest as "Elisabeth" — a name that does not match Anna Barbara's given name. Whether this is a New York port clerk's error for "Barbara," written in the chaos of a busy arrival hall by someone unfamiliar with Swiss-German names, or whether it reflects a genuine uncertainty about who traveled with Jakob Rathgeb in 1884, cannot be resolved from the records currently available online. The LDS departure register from Liverpool, compiled by Swiss-German-speaking missionaries who knew these saints by name, has not yet been examined. It remains the key document for this question. Anna Barbara's age as given on the New York manifest — 48, born 1836 — is one year younger than her actual birth year of 1835, a discrepancy well within normal range for 19th-century recording. The *Arizona* reached New York on 29 May 1884.

The six-year-old boy recorded on the manifest presents its own open question. He is listed as "Gottliek" and appears to travel as part of the Rathgeb family unit. No Gottlieb Rathgeb appears in any Swiss church record, any Utah census, or any other document before or after this single manifest entry. He does not appear in the Logan community in any form. The most probable explanation is that he died in childhood in Utah, before death certificates were required in the territory in 1905, leaving no paper trail. But his identity — whether a child of Jakob's, a child of Anna Barbara's, or a ward in their care — is not yet established.

> *She had waited eleven years between the water and the ship. When she finally crossed, she crossed as a woman of forty-nine, beginning again in a valley she had never seen.*

Anna Barbara settled in Logan, in Cache Valley, among a community of Swiss and German converts who had gathered to the same northern Utah town. Four years after her arrival, on 4 April 1888, she and Jakob Rathgeb were united in what was, for Latter-day Saints of their generation, a single complete act: a civil marriage performed by LDS elder N. C. Odlefsen before witnesses Lorenzo Petersen and J. W. Thurren, filed with Cache County — and on the same day, in the Logan Temple, the initiatory, endowment, and sealing that bound them for eternity. She signed the civil certificate as *Barbara Breiner* — her own hand, her maiden name. The couple had no children together but shared a household recorded in the 1900 and 1910 censuses in Logan's Fourth Ward.

Annebäbbi Follows (1887)

Anna Barbara had not brought her daughter with her. Annebäbbi — Anna Barbara Keller, then nineteen years old — followed her mother across the ocean in 1887, three years after the *Arizona* sailing, and made her own way to Logan and the Swiss-German community gathered there. Before her marriage she sang in the Swiss German Choir, which met half a block west of the Ninth Ward church in Logan — a small picture of a young immigrant woman finding her place among people who spoke her language in a strange valley.

In Logan she met Julius Friedrich Hinrich Stender — known as Julius F. H. Stender in American records — a German-born miller who had crossed the Atlantic on Christmas Eve 1885 aboard the steamship *Cumberland*, departing Hamburg and sailing via Glasgow to New York, arriving in January 1886. He had been born on 3 December 1857 in Curau, in the Schleswig-Holstein region of northern Germany, the son of Claus Heinrich Stender and Christina Dorothea Maria Eggert. His father had died the same year Julius was born; his mother died in 1886, the year he arrived in America. He crossed the ocean as an orphan, starting completely fresh. His trade was milling — Müller in German — and he arrived in Logan with a craft and the ambition to use it.

Annebäbbi, it is said, would not marry him until he joined the Church — and he did. The exact date of his LDS baptism has not yet been located; the most likely record is in the Logan 1st Ward membership register or in the Logan Temple's baptisms of the living from the late 1880s, both of which require a FamilySearch Library visit to examine. What is certain is that by early 1890 he was ready: a German miller in Logan, Utah, newly converted, about to bind himself in both law and faith to a Swiss immigrant woman who had grown up speaking the same Germanic tongue on the other side of the Alps.

One Day, Two Covenants (19 February 1890)

On 19 February 1890, Julius Stender and Annebäbbi Keller completed everything at once. That morning or afternoon they were married civilly in Logan, with the ceremony performed according to the rites of the Church and duly recorded with Cache County. Then they went into the Logan Temple, where Julius received his initiatory and endowment, and the two of them were sealed together for time and all eternity. It was the same pattern her mother and Jakob Rathgeb had followed on 4 April 1888 — the same Logan Temple, the same single-day completion of civil and eternal covenant — and it was standard practice for the Swiss and German converts who had come to Cache Valley without prior temple access. The Swiss German Choir member and the Holstein miller were bound together on an ordinary February day in a Utah valley neither of them had been born to.

> *Mother and daughter both married in the Logan Temple in the same decade — each in a single complete act of civil ceremony and eternal sealing, on the same day, in the same building, two years apart.*

Julius established himself quickly. He was a miller by trade and Logan needed millers. Central Milling — located at 122 East Center in Logan, the oldest continuously operating business in the state of Utah — had been founded in 1867 as a water-powered farmer's cooperative, nearly twenty years before Julius arrived. In the late 1880s it was rebuilt and converted to the new roller-milling process, and Julius became deeply associated with its operation in this era. A family memory preserved in FamilySearch refers to it as the "Julius Stender Flour Mill," a name that captures how completely he came to define it even if he did not found it. In 1906 he also held forty shares in the newly formed Trenton-Clarkston Mill and Elevator Company, organized to mill the "Turkey Red" wheat grown on the newly irrigated Clarkston Bench — a venture that brought him into business alongside members of the Bingham family, the same family whose fort had anchored the early Ogden settlement a generation earlier. He was a member of the Jefferson Club. He owned land and kept cows. He was, by the measure of Logan in the 1890s, doing well.

Into this stable life, children arrived and died with the same cruel rhythm that had marked the Briener and Keller generations before. Six children were born to Julius and Annebäbbi: Julius Henry in 1891, Edwin Claus in 1892, Martha Barbara in 1894, Richard Arthur in 1897, Henry in 1901, and Myrtle Ruth in 1905. Henry lived only through 1901; Myrtle Ruth was born and died in 1905, the year before her mother. When the Logan newspaper published Annebäbbi's death notice in October 1906, it counted six children with four living — Julius Henry, Edwin, Martha, and Richard — a tally that matches the record exactly.

Annebäbbi's Early Death (1906)

Anna Barbara Keller Stender did not grow old. She fell ill in her early forties and was seriously sick for many months, confined to her bed through the last half-year of her life. She died on 1 October 1906 at her home in Logan's Sixth Ward, of what the newspaper described as incipient diabetes and nervous prostration. She was forty years old. Her Utah death certificate — number 153, signed in Logan by her husband Julius — records her parents as Johannes Keller and Barbara Brener, fixing her place in the family beyond doubt. Her funeral was held in the Sixth Ward meetinghouse the same day the notice ran.

She left young children. Her daughter Martha, only twelve years old, took on the responsibility of caring for the household with the help of neighbors — the same age, almost to the year, that other daughters in this story's long family line had been when loss fell on them. The death notice remembered her as "a good wife, fond mother and faithful Saint." The family biographical sketch remembered her as firm, serious, an excellent cook — a woman who had held Julius to a standard before she would have him, and who had maintained that firmness to the end.

> *Annebäbbi died at forty, eight years before her mother. The daughter who had followed Anna Barbara across the ocean went into the ground first, in the valley they had both crossed the world to reach.*

Anna Barbara's Long Last Years (1906–1914)

Anna Barbara Briener had crossed an ocean at forty-nine, built a second marriage and a new life in Logan, and then watched her daughter die before her. Jakob Rathgeb died on 5 January 1911 in Logan, predeceasing his wife by three years. Anna Barbara lived on into the community she had helped populate, a Swiss convert who had outlived her marriage, her emigration, her second husband, and her own daughter.

She died on 8 September 1914 in Logan, Cache County, Utah, at the age of seventy-nine — a month after the outbreak of the First World War in the Europe she had left thirty

years before. She was buried two days later, on 10 September 1914, in the Logan City Cemetery. She had lived in Utah for three decades. She never went back to Switzerland.

Two women, mother and daughter, both named Anna Barbara, both born in the Zürich countryside, both gathered to the same small valley in northern Utah by the same faith — the mother who moved first, against her marriage and her whole inherited world, and the daughter who followed her across the water, married in the temple her mother's church had built, raised children and buried two of them, and died in the same city, in the same faith, eight years before her mother did. Whatever path led Carol's family to where it stands today, it passed through these two women.

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A Note on Julius Stender After 1906

Julius Friedrich Hinrich Stender outlived Annebäbbi by twenty-three years. He remarried on 22 July 1908 — less than two years after her death — wedding Elise Bärfuss (1873–1959, KWV7-T6Z) in Logan. They were sealed in the Logan Temple the same day, the third Logan Temple same-day civil-and-eternal ceremony in this family's story within a single generation. His son Edwin Claus died in 1907, his business ventures moved through the founding of the Trenton-Clarkston Mill in 1906, and he continued to operate his Logan flour enterprise through the following decades. His mill would outlast him by a century.

Julius died on 3 January 1929 at his home at 242 South 1st West in Logan, of bilateral lobar pneumonia, at the age of seventy-one. He had lived at that address for forty-five years. The informant on his death certificate was his daughter Martha S. Nelson — the same Martha who at age twelve had cared for her dying mother in 1906, and who carried the Stender family memory through the rest of the century. Julius was buried in Logan the following day. His grandson Reed S. Nelson later wrote that Julius was "very special" to the family and that he had been "very good to the Nelson family at a time when we were a poor farm family." Elise Bärfuss Stender outlived him by thirty years, dying in 1959.

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A Note on the Son Who Stayed

Not every Keller child gathered to Zion. Johann Jakob Keller, born 31 March 1863 — the second son to carry that name — remained in Switzerland when his mother and sister emigrated. He moved south into St. Gallen canton and married Maria Cäcilie Breitenmoser on 15 January 1889 in Wattwil, in the Toggenburg region. They had at least two children: a son, Johann Jacob, born in 1889, and an unnamed infant who died

at twenty days in June 1891. Johann Jakob's own death date has not been confirmed, but it was likely before 1913, when his son married under the surname Breitenmoser — his mother's name — suggesting his father was already gone. His branch of the family stayed Swiss, a reminder that the gathering split families as often as it bound them, and that for every name on a ship's register there were others who remained behind in the villages of the old country.

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A Note on the Cache Valley Connection

Anna Barbara and Annebäbbi gathered to Logan, in Cache Valley — the same northern Utah community where other families in this series put down roots. Julia Stratford Budge, daughter of George Stratford and Eliza Barwell, settled in Logan with her husband William Budge, and Charles W. Penrose — the missionary who converted the Stratford family in Essex — built his early career as a journalist and civic leader in the same town before rising to the First Presidency of the Church. The Swiss Briener-Keller women and the English Stratford-Budge family, converted on opposite ends of Europe and gathered by separate ships, became neighbors in the same valley. Cache Valley was where more than one thread of this family's history came to rest.

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A Note on the Unproven Connections

Several threads in this story remain deliberately open, and they are named here rather than hidden.

The identity of the woman on the 1884 Arizona manifest is the most significant open question. The New York arrival record lists a woman traveling with Jakob Rathgeb as "Elisabeth," age 48, born Switzerland — one year younger than Anna Barbara Briener's actual age of 49. The given name does not match. Whether "Elisabeth" is a New York port clerk's mishearing or miscopying of "Barbara" — a plausible error in a chaotic arrival hall — or whether it reflects a genuine first wife or companion of Jakob's who is not otherwise documented, cannot be resolved from records currently available online. An exhaustive search for any Elisabeth Rathgeb in Swiss church records and Utah records returned nothing. A search for Gottlieb Rathgeb in any record before or after the 1884 manifest also returned nothing. The Liverpool departure register (FHL Film 25693), compiled by Swiss-German-speaking missionaries who knew these saints by name, is the only document that can resolve this question. It has not yet been examined. Until it is, the identification of the woman on the Arizona as Anna Barbara Briener, while probable, remains unconfirmed.

The six-year-old boy named Gottlieb on the manifest is a separate open question. He appears in no Swiss birth record, no Utah census, no Church membership record, and no death record under any spelling variant. His parentage is unknown. The most likely explanation is that he died as a young child in Utah before the territory began requiring death certificates in 1905, but this has not been confirmed.

The identity of the missionary who baptized Anna Barbara Briener on 7 October 1873 in Switzerland has not been found. Swiss Mission branch records for the Zürich Conference in 1873 have not yet been examined.

The Swiss civil divorce record for Keller and Briener, approximately 1876–1880, has not been located. The divorce is proven circumstantially by Johann Heinrich's 1880 remarriage, which required a prior legal dissolution under Swiss law. The record itself is to be sought at the Staatsarchiv Zürich.

Joseph Keller, listed in some family trees as a fifth child of Anna Barbara and Johann Heinrich born around 1870, has no documented connection to this family from primary sources. No baptism record has been found in the Embrach parish register or elsewhere. He is excluded from this account until a primary source establishes the relationship.

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Source Citations

Anna Barbara Briener — Vital Records: FamilySearch profile 2X1S-V9W. Born 10 April 1835, Lüfingen, Embrach parish, Zürich, Switzerland; died 8 September 1914, Logan, Cache, Utah; buried 10 September 1914, Logan City Cemetery. High Quality profile, 26 sources. Death and burial confirmed by Find a Grave Index and BillionGraves Index. Birth and parentage from Lüfingen Reformed church register, Film 996460, DGS 8480705.

Parents and Siblings of Anna Barbara Briener: Hans Jakob Bryner (L4B5-RDB) and Catharina Meyer (LZNQ-NRH), married 1834, Lüfingen. Eldest of nine children. Two sons named Heinrich (infant name reuse after the first died at seven months) confirmed in Lüfingen Kirchenbuch, Film 996460.

Marriage to Johann Heinrich Keller — 23 April 1860: Pfungen, Zürich, Switzerland. Johann Heinrich Keller, FamilySearch 2XB2-97V, born 1830 near Winterthur; Heimatort Oberembrach; died 1903, Zürich.

Children of Keller and Briener — Embrach Baptism Register: Five children baptized in the Evangelisch-Reformierte Kirche Embrach register (Film 996844, DGS 8341354): Johann Jakob #1 (3 Dec 1860 – 13 Mar 1862, drowned, Wasserfässlein); Johann Jakob #2 (31 March 1863); Anna Barbara "Annebäbbi" (5 Nov 1865, baptized 10 Dec 1865); Paulina (1867–1868, died in infancy); Joseph (abt. 1870, connection unproven).

LDS Conversion of Anna Barbara Briener — 7 October 1873: FamilySearch profile 2X1S-V9W. Baptized into The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints in Switzerland while resident in Zürich canton. Baptizing missionary not yet identified; Swiss Mission / Zürich Conference branch records to be searched. Johann Heinrich Keller never joined in life; proxy baptism 2018.

Divorce and Johann Heinrich's Remarriage — c. 1876–1880: Swiss civil registration began 1 January 1876. Johann Heinrich Keller remarried Barbara Ritzmann (M789-4NX) on 6 December 1880 in Aussersihl, Zürich. The remarriage proves a prior legal divorce. Divorce record not yet located; to be searched at Staatsarchiv Zürich. 1880 remarriage record to be searched at Stadtarchiv Zürich.

Jakob Rathgeb — Vital Records: FamilySearch profile KH7M-SW4. Born 15 May 1840, Dietlikon, Zürich; son of Bernhard Rathgeb (–1860) and Margaretha Meier (1817–1887). Died 5 January 1911, Logan, Cache, Utah. LDS baptism: 1 May 1883, Switzerland (Ordinances tab). 9 sources, High Quality.

Emigration — SS Arizona, May 1884 — TWO SOURCES, IDENTIFICATION PENDING: Source 1: Saints by Sea (saintsbysea.byu.edu), voyage 39. SS Arizona, departed Liverpool 17 May 1884, arrived New York 29 May 1884; 259 LDS passengers under Church leader Ephraim H. Williams. A Rathgeb party of three is listed, origin Zürich, destination Logan, Utah. Source: British Mission Register, Book #1042, pp. 471–478 (FHL Film #025,693 — restricted, requires FamilySearch Center visit). Source 2: New York Passenger Lists 1820–1920 (M237, Film 476, Image 1004 of 1,084). The same ship records three travelers as a bracketed family unit: Jacob Rathgate (male, age 43, Plumber, Switzerland), Elizabeth [Rathgate] (female, age 48, Wife, Switzerland), and Gottliek [Rathgate] (male, age 6, Child, Switzerland). NOTE: The identification of Rathgate = Rathgeb is probable (matching ship, date, age, origin, party size) but unproven — no single document contains both spellings. The woman is recorded as 'Elisabeth' on the New York manifest, not 'Barbara.' Anna Barbara Briener was born 1835 (age 49 in 1884); manifest records age 48, born 1836 — a one-year discrepancy within normal range. Exhaustive searches for Elisabeth Rathgeb in Swiss records and Utah records returned no results. The six-year-old Gottlieb appears in no record before or after this manifest entry. FHL Film #025,693 (the Liverpool departure register) is the key document to resolve all of these questions and has not yet been examined.

Civil Marriage and Temple Sealing of Rathgeb and Briener — 4 April 1888: Cache County Marriage Certificate Indexes 1887–1915, Image 371 of 613, FamilySearch. Certificate: Jacob Rathgeb and Barbara Breiner, Logan; officiant N. C. Odlefsen, Elder of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints; witnesses Lorenzo Petersen and J. W. Thurren; signed Jakob Rathgeb and Barbara Breiner. Temple ordinances same day: Initiatory, Endowment, and Sealing to Spouse, 4 April 1888, Logan Utah Temple (FamilySearch Ordinances tab, KH7M-SW4). Note: the 1884 manifest lists her as "Mrs. Rathgeb" four years before this certificate; whether a prior Swiss civil marriage exists remains an open research question for the Switzerland trip.

Anna Barbara Keller ("Annebäbbi") Stender — Vital Records: FamilySearch profile L7BH-32R. Born 5 November 1865, Oberembrach, Zürich; baptized 10 December 1865, Embrach. Nickname Annebäbbi; went by Barbara Keller in Utah. Immigrated 1887 (per 1900 US Census; source confirmed). LDS membership recorded 19 February 1890, Utah Territory (Early

Church Information File, ark:/61903/1:1:QPC5-7JFW). Died 1 October 1906, Logan, Cache, Utah, age 40.

Julius Friedrich Hinrich Stender — Vital Records: FamilySearch profile KWJ6-SG5. Born 3 December 1857, Curau, Schleswig-Holstein, Germany; christened 3 January 1858, Curau. Father: Claus Heinrich Stender (LLQJ-5KS, 1800–1858); Mother: Christina Dorothea Maria Eggert (L7YV-54L, 1817–1886). Parents married 7 January 1855, Curau, Lübeck. Sibling: Wilhelm Stender (1858–1920, GQJ5-NQ7). Died 3 January 1929, Logan, Cache, Utah, of bilateral lobar pneumonia; buried Logan, Cache County, 4 January 1929. 27 sources, 24 memories.

Julius Stender — Immigration: Hamburg Passenger Lists 1850–1934: Julius Stender, departed Hamburg 24 December 1885, ship SS Cumberland, Captain Tait, English flag; occupation Müller (miller); residence Curau, Lübeck; destination New York via Glasgow (Leith). FamilySearch profile also records arrival Ellis Island 15 January 1886 on ship Ethiopia — likely two legs of the same journey (Hamburg to Glasgow on the Cumberland, Glasgow to New York on the Ethiopia). Residence of 45 years in Logan confirmed on death certificate (242 S. 1 West).

Julius Stender — LDS Baptism (Not Yet Located): Julius received his initiatory, endowment, and sealing at the Logan Utah Temple on 19 February 1890 — living ordinances requiring a prior valid baptism. The ECIF records his LDS membership date as 19 February 1890 (ark:/61903/1:1:QPC5-7JFW), which records the temple date, not the baptism date. A proxy baptism recorded 12 September 1989 at the Mesa Arizona Temple (Ordinances tab, KWJ6-SG5) is almost certainly erroneous; a person cannot receive a living endowment without a prior valid baptism. His actual baptism record has not been located. Most likely sources: Logan 1st Ward membership records, FHL #164,612; Logan Temple baptisms of the living 1884–1957; possibly the Swiss-German Branch or Cache Stake records. FamilySearch Library visit required.

Julius Stender — The Flour Mill: "Julius Stender Flour Mill now known as Central Milling 122 E Center in Logan Utah Herald Journal," FamilySearch Memories, profile KWJ6-SG5, contributed by elisabethbingham1, July 2018. Described as the oldest continuously operating business in the state of Utah; produces approximately 60 million pounds of organic flour per year. Julius also held 40 shares in the Trenton-Clarkston Mill and Elevator Company, incorporated 7 August 1906 (alongside B.F. Bingham of Trenton and others); source: Trenton-Clarkston Mill and Elevator Company records, FamilySearch Memories, KWJ6-SG5.

Civil Marriage of Julius Stender and Annebäbbi — 19 February 1890: Utah County Marriages 1871–1941; Utah Marriages 1887–1935; United States Western States Marriage Index — all attached to FamilySearch profile KWJ6-SG5. Temple ordinances same day: Initiatory, Endowment, and Sealing to Spouse (Anna Barbara Keller), 19 February 1890, Logan Utah Temple (Ordinances tab, KWJ6-SG5). This is a parallel pattern to the Rathgeb/Briener marriage of 4 April 1888 — both couples completed civil marriage and temple ordinances on the same day at the Logan Temple.

Children of Julius and Annebäbbi Stender: FamilySearch profile KWJ6-SG5, Details tab. Six children: Julius Henry Stander (K2HF-PGT, 1891–1949), Edwin Claus Stender (K2HN-ZHJ, 1892–1907), Martha Barbara Stender (KVG6-YGF, 1894–1951), Richard Arthur Stender (K2HN-ZWJ, 1897–1922), Henry Stender (K2HN-C1J, 1901–1901), Myrtle Ruth Stender (L7BH-W48,

1905–1905). At Annebäbbi's death October 1906: four children living (Julius Henry, Edwin, Martha, Richard).

Annebäbbi's Death — Utah Death Certificate: "Utah, Death Certificates, 1904–1966," Anna Barbara Stender, died 1 October 1906, Logan, Cache, Utah; certificate no. 153. Father: Johannes Keller; Mother: Barbara Brener. Signed by Julius F. H. Stender. FamilySearch profile L7BH-32R.

Annebäbbi's Death Notice: "Barbara Keller Stender Death Notice," The Journal [Logan], 4 October 1906, FamilySearch Memories, L7BH-32R. Born 6 November 1865, Embrach; came to US 1887; joined Church the following year; married 19 February 1890; six children, four living; died Sixth Ward; "a good wife, fond mother and faithful Saint." Note: a separate family biographical sketch records seven children with two surviving to maturity; the discrepancy is preserved rather than resolved.

Julius Stender — Death Certificate: Utah Death Certificates 1904–1966; Julius F. Henry Stender, died 3 January 1929, Logan, Cache, Utah; age 71; residence 242 S. 1 West (45 years); occupation Miller; birthplace Curau, Germany; father Henry Stender (Germany); mother Christinia D. Eggertz (Germany); spouse Elis Barfus (second wife); cause: bilateral lobar pneumonia. Informant: Martha S. Nelson (daughter). Buried Logan, 4 January 1929. FamilySearch profile KWJ6-SG5.

Julius Stender — Second Marriage: Elise Bärfuss (KWV7-T6Z, 1873–1959); married 22 July 1908, Logan, Cache, Utah; sealed same day, Logan Utah Temple. Utah County Marriages 1871–1941 and Utah Marriages 1887–1935 attached to KWJ6-SG5. Grandson Reed S. Nelson memoir: "Memories of Julius F. Stender by his grandson, Reed S. Nelson," FamilySearch Memories, KWJ6-SG5.

Johann Jakob Keller (the son who stayed) — Wattwil Branch: FamilySearch profile KHRP-TMV. Born 31 March 1863, Oberembrach; married Maria Cäcilie Breitenmoser (GYR7-6NC) 15 January 1889, Wattwil, St. Gallen. Children: Johann Jacob (born 10 April 1889) and unnamed infant (died 24 June 1891, age 20 days). Death date unconfirmed, likely before 1913. Records to be confirmed: FamilySearch Library Films 957683 and 957669; Staatsarchiv St. Gallen, Toggenburger Genealogie / Wickli Archive, StASG ZLA 002/451–472.

Cross-Document Connection — Cache Valley: Julia Stratford Budge and Charles W. Penrose settled in Logan, Cache County, Utah (see "George Stratford and Eliza Barwell" in this series). The Briener-Keller-Stender family gathered to the same community, connecting the Swiss and English conversion lines of the series in one valley.

Cross-Document Connection — Bingham Line: Julius Stender held shares in the Trenton-Clarkston Mill and Elevator Company alongside B.F. Bingham of Trenton, Utah — connecting the Stender business ventures to the Bingham family line documented in "Erastus Bingham and Lucinda Gates" in this series.

Story 12 of 12

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The Conversion and Gathering of

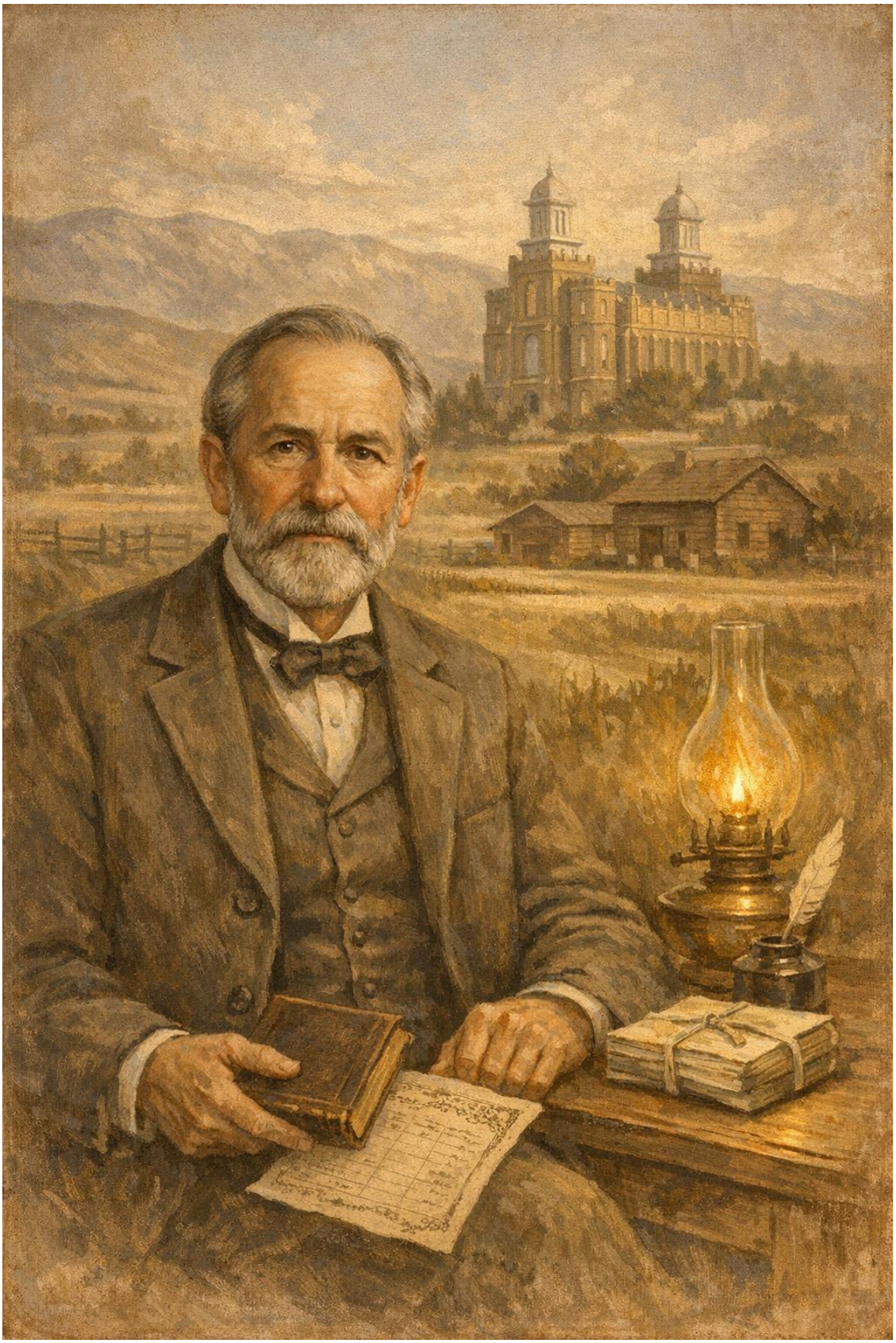
Julius Friedrich Hinrich Stender

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Curau, Holstein, Germany • Brigham City and Logan, Utah • 1857–1929

Baptized: 1889

Logan, Cache Valley, Utah



The Conversion and Gathering of

Julius Friedrich Hinrich Stender

Curau, Holstein, Germany • Brigham City and Logan, Utah • 1857–1929

The World of Curau, Holstein

In the flat farmland south of Lübeck, where the Duchy of Holstein met the Danish border and the wind off the Baltic carried the smell of grain and mill dust, the village of Curau sat among a cluster of small Protestant communities that had been milling the local wheat for generations. It was a Lutheran world, ordered by the church register and the miller's wheel, where a man's trade was something he was born into and trained in from boyhood. The Stender family had been part of that world for at least two generations. Claus Heinrich Stender was a miller in Curau — not a wealthy man, but a skilled one — and the trade defined the family as surely as the parish register recorded their names.

Claus Heinrich married twice. His first wife was Catharina Dorothea Loeh, who bore him a son, Joachim Heinrich Christian, in December 1827, and then died in 1845 when the boy was still young. His second wife was Christina Dorothea Maria Eggert, who bore him two more sons: Julius Friedrich Hinrich, and the younger Wilhelm. The date of Julius's birth is recorded variously in the sources — a published biographical account gives 3 December 1863, while earlier records suggest a birth year closer to 1857 — and the Curau church baptism register, available in the Ostholstein Protestant church books, is the primary source awaiting examination to settle the question. What is not in doubt is that he was born in Curau, that he was the son of a miller, and that his father died while Julius was still a small child, leaving Christina Eggert to raise Julius and Wilhelm alone.

By 1856 — years before Julius was old enough to leave — Joachim Heinrich Christian, the eldest half-brother, had already gone. He emigrated to America that year, wandered through St. Louis and Omaha, and eventually made his way west with a wagon party to Salt Lake City. It was there, in the first years of the Utah settlement, that something unexpected happened to him: he attended a Latter-day Saint church conference, could not understand the English being spoken, and yet — as he later described it — understood every word that President Brigham Young delivered that day, so completely that he thought the prophet was speaking German. He was baptized into The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints on 8 August 1859. He changed his surname from Stender to Stander, settled in Brigham City in Box Elder County, and built a life there that would span the rest of the century. By the time Julius was a grown man in Holstein,

his half-brother Henry — as he was known in America — had already lived in Utah for twenty years.

The Miller's Son (1857–1885)

Julius grew up in the shadow of his father's absence and his mother's widowhood, in a small Holstein village where a boy with a trade and no father had to earn his place early. The biographical account he provided later in life is precise about this: "when seven years of age he started to earn his own living." Whether this means formal employment or simply that he was contributing to the household from that age, the picture is of a childhood defined by work rather than schooling. He was educated in the public schools of Holstein, but the mill was the real classroom. At fourteen years of age he was apprenticed to the miller's trade — the same trade his father had followed, the same trade his half-brother had carried in his hands to America. He followed it, by his own account, for forty-eight years.

The apprenticeship system in northern Germany in this period was formal and demanding. A young man bound to a miller's trade learned everything from the mechanics of the millstones to the grading of wheat, from water-wheel maintenance to the management of grain accounts. It was a skilled industrial craft, not simple labor, and the men who mastered it were sought after. Julius mastered it. By the time he was a young adult he was a trained professional miller in a region that was beginning to convert from the old millstone process to the new roller-milling technology that was transforming the industry across Europe. That technical knowledge — specifically the roller process — would eventually make him valuable on the other side of the world.

Through all of this, Christina Eggert was still alive, and Julius and Wilhelm were still in Curau with her. The biographical account is unambiguous on the point that shaped everything: "in his boyhood and following the death of his father he aided in the support of his widowed mother." He did not leave. He stayed through his apprenticeship, through his young adult years, through whatever ambitions or correspondence with his half-brother in Utah may have accumulated over those decades. He stayed because she needed him.

> *He stayed through his apprenticeship, through his twenties, through whatever longing may have accumulated across the years. He stayed because she needed him. When she died, he left within the year.*

Christina Dorothea Maria Eggert died in 1886 at the age of sixty-five. On Christmas Eve of the previous year — 1885 — Julius had already boarded a ship at Hamburg, the steamship *Cumberland*, sailing first to Glasgow and then crossing the Atlantic. He arrived in New York on 17 January 1886. Whether his mother was still living when he sailed, or had died in the weeks immediately before his departure, is a question the

Curau church death register will answer. What the timeline makes plain is that the two events — her death and his emigration — were separated by weeks, not months. For thirty years he had waited. The moment she was gone, he went.

The Half-Brother in Utah (January–March 1886)

Julius did not arrive in America without a destination. He went directly to Brigham City, Utah, where Henry Stander — Joachim Heinrich Christian, the half-brother who had left Curau three decades earlier — was then living. The journey from New York to Utah in January 1886 was by rail, the transcontinental line having been complete for seventeen years. He arrived in Brigham City and stayed for two months.

Those two months matter. Henry Stander was by 1886 a well-established figure in Brigham City society — a committed Latter-day Saint of twenty-seven years, a polygamist with three families, a property owner with deep community roots in Box Elder County. His third wife, Anne Christine Neilsen, had children born in the years immediately after Julius arrived, and Henry named two of them — William Peter and Julius Martin — after the younger half-brothers who had just crossed the ocean to find him. That naming is its own kind of evidence: these were not distant relatives conducting a polite visit. These were brothers, reunited after thirty years, and Henry honored the reunion by giving his children their names.

> *Henry named his newborn sons William and Julius in the months after the brothers arrived. Two children named for the men who had crossed an ocean to find him.*

What Julius absorbed in those two months in Brigham City cannot be fully documented, but the shape of it is clear. He arrived as a Lutheran German miller from Holstein and spent two months in the home of a devout Latter-day Saint patriarch whose conversion story included understanding Brigham Young in a language he shouldn't have been able to understand. He encountered the Church not as an abstract institution but as the living community his half-brother had built his entire American life inside. He did not convert during those two months — that came later, in Logan — but the ground was prepared there, in Brigham City, in Henry's home.

After two months he moved to Logan, fifty miles south in Cache Valley, and immediately began work at the miller's trade. Logan needed millers. Central Milling — founded in 1867 as a water-powered farmer's cooperative at what is now 122 East Center Street — was in the midst of converting from millstone grinding to the new roller process in the late 1880s. A German-trained roller-process miller arriving in Logan in 1886 was not an accident. He had the skills the town's largest mill needed at exactly the moment it needed them.

Logan, Anna Barbara, and the Covenant (1886–1890)

Logan in 1886 was a small but rapidly growing city in the Cache Valley, dominated by the LDS community that had settled it. The Logan Utah Temple had been dedicated just three years earlier, in 1884. Among the Swiss and German converts who had gathered to Cache Valley was a community of German-speaking immigrants who sang together, worshipped together, and found in each other the familiar sounds of a language that the surrounding English-speaking world did not speak. Julius, a German-speaking miller in a predominantly English-speaking town, would have found his way into that community naturally.

It was in that community that he met Anna Barbara Keller — known to everyone as Annebäbbi — the Swiss-German daughter of Anna Barbara Briener and Johann Heinrich Keller of Oberembrach, Zürich. Annebäbbi had followed her mother to Logan in 1887, the year after Julius arrived. She was twenty-one years old. Before her marriage she sang in the Swiss German Choir, which met half a block west of the Ninth Ward church in Logan. Julius was German-speaking. She was Swiss-German. The distance between Holstein and Zürich was irrelevant in a Cache Valley where both of them were far from home.

The family tradition, preserved in the biographical account compiled by those who knew them, is direct on what happened next: she would not marry him until he joined the Church. He joined. The biographical sketch published while Julius was alive states that "Mr. Stender became a convert to the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints in 1889." The exact date of his baptism has not yet been located — the most likely record is in the Logan 1st Ward membership register or in the Logan Temple's baptisms of the living — but the year is confirmed. He converted in 1889. He married Annebäbbi on 19 February 1890.

The question of what drew Julius to the faith is not simple. Annebäbbi's requirement was the immediate cause, but the ground had been prepared. He had lived in Brigham City for two months in the home of a half-brother who had been a committed Latter-day Saint since 1859. He had then lived for three years in Logan, in a community defined by the same faith, working alongside men and women who had crossed oceans and plains to reach that valley. A man who converted under those conditions was not converting in a vacuum. The Church had surrounded him since January 1886. Annebäbbi may have been the requirement, but Henry's life and Logan's community were the context.

> *She would not marry him until he joined the Church. He joined. The biographical sketch is matter-of-fact about it. Three years in an LDS community and two months in his half-brother's home had done their work.*

One Day, Two Covenants (19 February 1890)

On 19 February 1890, Julius Stender and Anna Barbara Keller completed everything at once. The civil marriage was performed according to the rites of the Church and recorded with Cache County. Then they went into the Logan Temple, where Julius received his initiatory and endowment as a living member, and the two of them were sealed together for time and all eternity. It was standard practice for converts who had come to Cache Valley without prior temple access to accomplish the civil ceremony and the temple ordinances on the same day. The German miller from Holstein and the Swiss-German daughter of Lüfingen were bound together on an ordinary February afternoon in a Utah valley that neither of them had been born to.

Julius was already working. His association with the milling operations of Cache Valley had begun the moment he arrived in Logan in 1886, and he built it steadily through the following years. Between 1897 and 1900 he operated the Corinne mill in Box Elder County — near Brigham City, near Henry — on his own account, a venture that prospered before the lease expired. He then accepted the position of head miller at the Thatcher Brothers mill in Logan, where he continued for nine years, until approximately 1909. He also conducted the Trenton-Clarkston mill and elevator during this period, until February 1918, his executive ability and thorough understanding of the milling trade making him valuable to every operation he touched. Around 1915 he established his own business at No. 63 North First East in Logan — dealing in flour, feed, hay, grain, and seed — and gave it his entire attention from February 1918 onward.

He was also a large stockholder in the Trenton-Clarkston Mill and Elevator Company, incorporated in 1906 alongside shareholders that included members of the Bingham family — the same Bingham line whose patriarch Erastus had established Bingham's Fort in Weber County a generation earlier, and whose name marked the earliest Mormon settlement in that part of Utah. The mills of Cache Valley and Box Elder County connected Julius Stender's career to the wider fabric of Utah pioneer settlement in ways he may not have fully recognized.

Children came and, as they had for every generation of this family, some of them died young. Six children were born to Julius and Annebäbbi: Julius Henry in 1891, Edwin Claus in 1892, Martha Barbara in 1894, Richard Arthur in 1897, Henry in 1901, and Myrtle Ruth in 1905. Henry died in 1901; Myrtle Ruth was born and died in 1905, the year before her mother. When Annebäbbi died on 1 October 1906 — of incipient diabetes and nervous prostration, at forty years of age — she left four living children. Their daughter Martha, twelve years old, took on the household. A later account would remember Annebäbbi as firm and serious, an excellent cook, a woman who had held Julius to a standard and maintained it to the end.

The Second Half (1906–1929)

Julius outlived Annebäbbi by twenty-three years. Less than two years after her death, on 1 July 1908, he married again — Elizabeth Barfuss, a native of Switzerland, the daughter of Shenk and Elizabeth Barfuss. The marriage and sealing were performed at the Logan Temple on the same day, maintaining the pattern of the family he had built. Elizabeth's mother had crossed the Atlantic and was living with Julius and Elizabeth at the time his biographical account was written. His son Edwin Claus had died in 1907. His surviving children — Julius Henry, Martha, and Richard Arthur — were building their own lives in Logan, Omaha, and the United States Marine Corps respectively.

Through the second decade of the century Julius's business continued to expand and then consolidate. He became a naturalized American citizen in 1893, gave his political allegiance to the Democratic Party, and owned both his residence at No. 242 South First West and the business block at No. 63 North First East where he conducted his trade. The biographical account published during his lifetime describes him as a man who "had never at any time received financial assistance," who had worked his way up entirely by his own labor, who deserved "much credit for what he has accomplished." It is the language of a man who was aware that he had arrived as an immigrant with nothing but a trade and had turned it into a life.

His half-brother Henry had died on 14 November 1915 in Brigham City, at the age of eighty-seven or eighty-eight — the man who had left Curau thirty years before Julius, who had built the LDS life that drew Julius across the ocean, who had named his sons William and Julius in the year the brothers arrived. Henry was buried in Brigham City. Julius was listed at his death as one of two brothers surviving in America.

Julius Friedrich Hinrich Stender died on 3 January 1929 at his home at 242 South First West in Logan, of bilateral lobar pneumonia. He was seventy-one years old — or sixty-five, depending on which birth year the Curau record ultimately confirms. He had lived at that address for forty-five years. The informant on his death certificate was his daughter Martha S. Nelson, the same Martha who had been twelve years old when her mother died and who had carried the household and the family memory ever since. Julius was buried in Logan the following day. His grandson Reed S. Nelson would later write that Julius had been very special to the family, that he had been "very good to the Nelson family at a time when we were a poor farm family." Elise Bärfuss Stender outlived him by thirty years, dying in 1959.

> *He had arrived in January 1886 as a Lutheran miller from Holstein with nothing but his trade and a half-brother's address. Forty-three years later he left behind a business, a home, and a family woven into the fabric of Cache Valley. He is buried in Logan, the valley he had not been born to, which became the only home that mattered.*

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A Note on Henry Christian Stander

The half-brother who made everything possible deserves his own paragraph. Joachim Heinrich Christian Stender — Henry Christian Stander in America — was born in Curau, Holstein, on 2 December 1827, the son of Claus Heinrich Stender and his first wife, Catharina Dorothea Loeh. He emigrated in 1856, converted to the LDS Church in Salt Lake City in approximately 1859 — baptized 8 August 1859 — and settled in Brigham City, Box Elder County, Utah, where he lived most of his remaining life. He married three times — Maria Sophia Hansen in the Old Endowment House, Karen Maria Olsen as a second wife, and Anne Christine Neilsen as a third — and had a total of nine children across those families. He died 14 November 1915 in Brigham City and was buried there.

His conversion story is remarkable on its own terms. He attended a general conference in Salt Lake City unable to understand any English, and yet understood every word President Brigham Young spoke that day so completely that he thought the prophet was speaking German. That experience became the foundation of a faith he held for fifty-six years, through polygamy, through the early pioneer hardships of Box Elder County, through three marriages and the deaths of wives and children. He is not a principal subject of this series, but without him Julius Stender has no destination. The story begins with Henry leaving Curau. It ends with Julius arriving in Brigham City to find him.

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A Note on the Birth Year Question

Two sources give different birth years for Julius Friedrich Hinrich Stender. The FamilySearch profile (KWJ6-SG5), drawing on the Hamburg passenger lists and earlier indexed records, gives a birth year of 1857. The biographical sketch published in *Utah Since Statehood* — based on information Julius himself provided — states he was born 3 December 1863. This is a six-year difference that affects his age at his father's death, his age at apprenticeship, and every subsequent calculation. The Ostholstein Protestant church books (1597–1959), which explicitly cover Curau and are available online at FamilySearch, contain the baptism register that will settle the question. Until that record is examined, both dates are preserved in this account and the source citations flag the conflict. The narrative uses "small child" and "young adult" rather than specific ages where the conflict would produce contradictions.

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A Note on the Cross-Document Connections

The Stender story intersects with several other stories in this Pioneer Family History Series. The most direct is the Briener and Keller story: Julius married Anna Barbara Keller (Annebäbbi), the daughter of Anna Barbara Briener and Johann Heinrich Keller, Swiss converts who gathered to Logan from Zürich canton. His business connection to the Trenton-Clarkston Mill and Elevator Company — incorporated in 1906 alongside members of the Bingham family — links his commercial career to the Bingham line documented in the Erastus Bingham and Lucinda Gates story. The presence of Julia Stratford Budge and Charles W. Penrose in Logan connects the Stender family's Cache Valley community to the Stratford story from Maldon, Essex. These families, converted on opposite ends of Europe, gathered to the same valley and became, in the most practical sense, neighbors.

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A Note on the Unresolved Questions

Several threads in this story remain open and are named here rather than hidden. The birth year of Julius Friedrich Hinrich Stender — 1857 or 1863 — is documented above and awaits the Curau church register. The exact date of his mother Christina's death in 1886 and whether Julius had already sailed before she died is answerable from the same source. His LDS baptism date and the identity of the baptizing elder have not been located; the most likely records are the Logan 1st Ward membership register (FHL #164,612) and the Logan Temple baptisms of the living, 1884–1957, both requiring a FamilySearch Library visit. The second marriage date — the biographical sketch says 1 July 1908, earlier records say 22 July 1908 — should be confirmed against the Logan Temple record. The identity of the woman recorded as "Elisabeth" on the 1884 Arizona manifest traveling with Jakob Rathgeb remains unresolved pending examination of FHL Film 25693; this affects the Briener and Keller story more directly than this one, but is noted here for completeness since Annebäbbi's mother is a character in both accounts.

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Source Citations

Julius Friedrich Hinrich Stender — Vital Records: FamilySearch profile KWJ6-SG5. Birth date conflict: FamilySearch records show 3 December 1857; Utah Since Statehood biographical sketch (based on Julius's own account) states 3 December 1863. Both preserved pending examination of Curau church baptism register in Ostholstein Protestant church books, 1597–1959 (FamilySearch, free online). Birthplace: Curau, Ostholstein, Schleswig-Holstein, Germany. Father: Claus Heinrich Stender (also rendered Henry Stender), miller. Mother:

Christina Dorothea Maria Eggert (also rendered Christinia D. Eggertz). Died 3 January 1929, Logan, Cache, Utah; buried Logan, 4 January 1929.

Utah Since Statehood — Julius F. H. Stender Biographical Sketch: Utah Since Statehood: Historical and Biographical, Vol. [5], pp. 345–346. Published while Julius was alive. Primary source for: birthdate 3 December 1863 (conflict noted); father Henry Stender, miller, died June 1864 age 64; mother died 1886 age 65; two children in family (Julius and William); apprenticed to miller's trade at age 14, followed 48 years; emigrated 1886 following mother's death; landed New York 17 January 1886; went directly to Brigham City to half-brother Henry Stender; stayed two months; removed to Logan, began work at miller's trade; Corinne mill 1897–1900; Thatcher Brothers mill ~9 years; Trenton-Clarkston mill until February 1918; own business from ~1915; LDS conversion 1889; married Barbara Keller 19 February 1890; six children, three living at time of writing (Julius F.H. Jr., Martha Barbara Nelson, Richard Arthur); deceased children Henry, Myrtle, Edwin Claus; married Elizabeth Barfuss 1 July 1908 (note: other records say 22 July 1908); naturalized 1893; Democrat; owner 242 S. First West and 63 N. First East. FamilySearch Memories, KWJ6-SG5.

Henry Christian Stander — Vital Records and Biography: FamilySearch profile KW8Q-C15 (also rendered LLQJ-5KS for father Claus Hinrich Stender). Full name: Joachim Heinrich Christian Stander (changed from Stender in America). Born 2 December 1827, Curae, Schleswig-Holstein, Prussia. Son of Claus Heinrich Stender and Catharina Dorothea Loeh (Julius's mother was Christina Eggert — different mothers, same father; half-brothers confirmed). Emigrated 1856. Baptized LDS 8 August 1859. Initiatory and Endowment 28 January 1865, Old Endowment House, Salt Lake City. Married (1) Maria Sophia Hansen, Old Endowment House; (2) Karen Maria Olsen; (3) Anne Christine Neilsen. Third wife's children: Henry, Nels, William Peter, Julius Martin, Amanda — William and Julius named after half-brothers who arrived 1886. Died 14 November 1915, Brigham City, Box Elder, Utah. Sources: Henry Christian Stander obituary and biographical summary, FamilySearch Memories, KW8Q-C15; FamilySearch Ordinances tab (baptism 8 August 1859, endowment 28 January 1865 Endowment House); Sources tab includes Deutschland, ausgewählte evangelische Kirchenbücher 1500–1971 (1828 birth entry); 1870 and 1880 US Census records.

Father Claus Heinrich Stender — Death Date Conflict: Utah Since Statehood sketch states father died June 1864 at age 64. FamilySearch profile for Henry Stander lists father (Claus Hinrich Sten..., LLQJ-5KS) with dates 1800–1858. These conflict by six years. The Curau church death register in the Ostholstein Protestant church books (FamilySearch, free online) will resolve this. Both dates preserved pending that examination.

Immigration — SS Cumberland and Atlantic Crossing, December 1885–January 1886: Hamburg Passenger Lists: Julius Stender, departed Hamburg 24 December 1885, SS Cumberland, Captain Tait, English flag; occupation Müller (miller); residence Curau, Lübeck; destination New York via Glasgow. Arrived New York 17 January 1886 — date confirmed by Utah Since Statehood sketch. Second leg of voyage likely SS Ethiopia, Glasgow to New York; FamilySearch profile records arrival Ellis Island 15 January 1886 on Ethiopia (date discrepancy with sketch; 17 January 1886 from biographical account taken as more reliable). Went directly to Brigham City, Utah, to half-brother Henry Stander. Remained two months, then removed to Logan.

LDS Conversion — 1889: Utah Since Statehood: 'Mr. Stender became a convert to the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints in 1889 and now has his membership in the sixth ward.' Exact baptism date not yet located. Most likely records: Logan 1st Ward membership register, FHL #164,612 (FamilySearch Library visit required); Logan Temple baptisms of the living, 1884–1957 (FamilySearch Library visit required). FamilySearch Ordinances tab shows erroneous proxy baptism 12 September 1989, Mesa Arizona Temple — this is almost certainly a researcher error; Julius received living initiatory, endowment, and sealing 19 February 1890 (Ordinances tab), which require prior valid living baptism. Collaborate page correction pending location of original baptism record.

Marriage to Anna Barbara Keller (Annebäbbi) — 19 February 1890: Civil marriage and Logan Temple initiatory, endowment, and sealing all completed 19 February 1890. Utah County Marriages 1871–1941; Utah Marriages 1887–1935; ECIF membership record 19 February 1890. Anna Barbara Keller (L7BH-32R), born 5 November 1865, Oberembrach, Zürich, Switzerland; daughter of Johann Heinrich Keller (2XB2-97V) and Anna Barbara Briener (2X1S-V9W). See Briener and Keller story in this series for full account of Anna Barbara Keller and her family.

Children of Julius and Anna Barbara Keller Stender: Six children: Julius Henry (K2HF-PGT, 1891–1949, later of Omaha, Nebraska), Edwin Claus (K2HN-ZHJ, 1892–1907), Martha Barbara (KVG6-YGF, 1894–1951, married Wesley Nelson, Logan), Richard Arthur (K2HN-ZWJ, 1897–1922, United States Marine Corps), Henry (K2HN-C1J, 1901–1901), Myrtle Ruth (L7BH-W48, 1905–1905). Note: Utah Since Statehood (written after 1906) lists three living children; the 1906 Logan death notice listed four living. Edwin Claus died 1907, between the two accounts, accounting for the discrepancy.

Anna Barbara Keller Stender — Death: Died 1 October 1906, Logan, Cache, Utah; age stated as 41 in biographical sketch (Utah Since Statehood), 40 on Utah Death Certificate #153. Born 5 November 1865 — death certificate is primary source; she had not yet reached her 41st birthday. Cause: incipient diabetes and nervous prostration. Informant: Julius F. H. Stender. FamilySearch profile L7BH-32R.

Milling Career: Utah Since Statehood biographical sketch: apprenticed age 14, followed trade 48 years; began work in Logan immediately on arrival 1886; operated Corinne mill (Box Elder County) 1897–1900 on own account; head miller Thatcher Brothers mill approximately 9 years (to ~1909); conducted Trenton-Clarkston Mill and Elevator until February 1918; established own business (flour, feed, hay, grain, seed) at No. 63 North First East, Logan, approximately 1915. Central Milling Co., founded 1867 as water-powered farmer's cooperative; original owners Nels Peterson and Niels Hansen; converted to roller process late 1880s. See millpictures.com, Mill ID 1305. Trenton-Clarkston Mill and Elevator Co., incorporated 7 August 1906 (alongside B.F. Bingham of Trenton); Julius held 40 shares. FamilySearch Memories, KWJ6-SG5.

Second Marriage — Elizabeth Barfuss: Elise/Elizabeth Bärfuss (KWV7-T6Z, 1873–1959), native of Switzerland, daughter of Shenk and Elizabeth Barfuss. Utah Since Statehood gives marriage date 1 July 1908; other records (Utah County Marriages) give 22 July 1908; Logan Temple sealing same day. Elizabeth's mother crossed the Atlantic and was living with Julius and

Elizabeth at time of sketch writing. Elizabeth's father never came to America (per sketch). Elizabeth outlived Julius by 30 years, dying 1959.

Julius Stender — Death Certificate: Utah Death Certificates 1904–1966; Julius F. Henry Stender, died 3 January 1929, Logan, Cache, Utah; age 71; residence 242 S. 1 West (45 years); occupation Miller; birthplace Curau, Germany; father Henry Stender (Germany); mother Christinia D. Eggertz (Germany); cause: bilateral lobar pneumonia. Informant: Martha S. Nelson (daughter). Buried Logan, 4 January 1929. FamilySearch profile KWJ6-SG5.

Reed S. Nelson Memoir: 'Memories of Julius F. Stender by his grandson, Reed S. Nelson,' FamilySearch Memories, KWJ6-SG5: 'Grandpa Stender was very special to us… He was very good to the Nelson family at a time when we were a poor farm family.'

Cross-Document Connections: Anna Barbara Keller (Annebäbbi) — see Briener and Keller story in this series. Erastus Bingham connection via Trenton-Clarkston Mill shareholders — see Erastus Bingham and Lucinda Gates story in this series. Julia Stratford Budge and Charles W. Penrose in Logan — see George Stratford and Eliza Barwell story in this series.